

HUMAN RESOURCES POLICY (HR POLICY) MANUAL

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Issued By:



Sameer Pande
Managing Director
DIN 00143616

PREFACE

Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Ltd.'s ("**MKCL**"/"**the Company**"/"**the Organization**") Human Resources Policy Manual ("**the HR Manual**") has been designed to help new and current employees to familiarize themselves with MKCL's policies, procedures, principles, value system and work ethos. Other aspects of employment with MKCL which do not appear herein, should be addressed with the immediate Appraiser or HR Officer.

MKCL may change, suspend, delete, add, remove or otherwise modify any or all content in this HR Manual. In addition, any provision in this HR Manual is found to be unenforceable and invalid, such finding will not invalidate the entire HR Manual, but only that particular provision. If a particular Policy/norm (or any part thereof) becomes inconsistent with the provision of any applicable Statute, then the provisions of the concerned Statute shall prevail.

This HR Manual will apply to all employees of MKCL unless stated otherwise or excluded/exempted by designation, Group, Program, status, level or other un-biased method. Any Appraiser shall not make promises to employees in regard to modifying or exempting them from abiding by Policies, norms specified in this HR Manual.

This HR Manual is not a contract for employment. No employee of the Company shall have an employment contract unless authorized in writing and signed by the Managing Director or Officer authorized by him/her.

The Chief Executive Officer (CEO) is responsible for ensuring the maintenance and compliance of this HR Manual and revising the same from time to time as required. Access to Soft Copy of the HR Manual shall be given to every Employee in his Employee login on a central portal as informed from time to time.

The Policies, norms in this HR Manual shall apply *mutatis mutandis* (with the respective differences having been considered) to those engaged by MKCL as Consultants, Interns, Trainees, Fellows and similar such categories who are not considered as employees as per the terms of offer and appointment/engagement.

We appreciate for taking the time to learn about your Company's Policies and encourage you to reach out to HRD (hrd@mkcl.org) to seek any clarifications and suggestions, if required.

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TERMINOLOGY

1. This Manual will be called as **“MKCL’s Human Resources Policy Manual”/ “HR Manual”**.

2. Definitions

Without limiting any other terms defined elsewhere herein as used in the HR Manual, the following terms shall, unless the context otherwise require, have the following respective meanings:

- 2.1 **“Appraiser”** means the authority to whom an employee should report as per the organizational chart announced from time to time and who is responsible for the employee’s (Appraisee) performance, the systematic evaluation of his performance as well as for his further growth and development.
- 2.2 **“Board”** means the Board of Directors of the Company as defined under Section 2 (10) of the Companies Act, 2013.
- 2.3 **“CEO”** means Chief Executive Officer of the Company as designated and appointed by the Board of Directors of the Company.
- 2.4 **“Code”** means the MKCL’s code of conduct.
- 2.5 **“Employee”** means person who is engaged as employee by MKCL as per terms of his/her appointment.
- 2.6 **“Family”** means family of an employee consisting of spouse, dependent children and dependent parents.
- 2.7 **“F & A Head”** means officer entrusted with the responsibilities of accounts, finance, taxation, costing, audit and other allied functions of the Company by the Board.
- 2.8 **“HRD” or “HR”** means Human Resources Development Program of MKCL.
- 2.9 **“Human Resources”/“Staff”/Personnel** include employees, consultants, fellows, trainees, interns.
- 2.10 **“KMP”** means ‘Key managerial personnel’ as defined in section 2(51) of the Companies Act, 2013
- 2.11 **“KMT”** means the Key Management Team constituted/reconstituted by the Board of Directors from time to time.
- 2.12 **“MD”** means, Managing Director of MKCL as defined under Section 2 (54) of the Companies Act, 2013 (“the Act”) as appointed/re-appointed by the Board of Directors from time to time and who is a Key Managerial Personnel (“KMP”) as defined in section 2(51) of the said Act.
- 2.13 **“MKCL”/ “the Company”/ “the Organization”** means, Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Limited.
- 2.14 **“Program Coordinator”/“PC”** means employee specified as PC in the organization structure from time to time.
- 2.15 **“Program Leader”/“PL”** means employee specified as PL in the organization structure from time to time.
- 2.16 **“Senior Program Coordinator”/“SPC”** means employee specified as SPC in the organization structure from time to time.

3. Interpretations, amendments, supersession

3.1 Manual interpretations -In this HR Manual unless otherwise specified:

- All words/terms denoting the singular shall include the plural and vice-versa;
- All words/terms denoting any gender shall include all genders.

3.2 Headings - The Headings used under this HR Manual for a group of terms and conditions are meant to serve only as a convenience. The Headings are not to be considered for the interpretation of terms or conditions in the HR Manual.

3.3 Amendment of Policies - The MD may amend any Policies specified in this HR Manual from time to time in the overall interest of the organization. All Policies contained herein and as amended from time to time are a part and parcel of MKCL's Human Resource Policy Manual.

3.4 Discretionary powers of MD - The MD has discretionary powers to approve/disapprove exceptional cases.

3.5 Superseding effect - This HR Manual shall supersede and replace existing policies, if any, regarding the subject matter.

1. WORK ETHOS AND CONDUCT

A. Human Rights Policy

Policy:	Human Rights Policy
Date of issue:	March 05, 2018
Effective Date:	April 01, 2018
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
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Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Limited (MKCL) is committed to respecting the Human Rights of its employees, communities and those affected by its operations, as guaranteed by the Constitution of India, and embodied in the United Nations Global Compact.

2. Norms:

- (a) MKCL respects Human Rights and nurtures an internal working environment which respects Human Rights without prejudice. It is committed to identify, prevent, and mitigate adverse Human Rights impacts resulting from or caused by its business operations before or if they occur, through Human Rights due diligence and mitigation processes. Likewise, it expects its business partners to establish a human rights compliant business environment at the workplace.
- (b) MKCL values and respects the diversity of its employees and the invaluable contributions they make. MKCL is committed to equal opportunity and is dedicated to maintaining workplaces that are free from discrimination (based on age, gender, marital status, differently abled, race, national/ regional origin, ancestry, indigenous status, personal beliefs, religion and spiritual practice, political affiliation, sexual orientation, HIV/AIDS or any other status protected by applicable statutes). MKCL maintains positive legal compliance with applicable constitutional and regulatory Human Rights requirements.
- (c) MKCL does not tolerate disrespectful behavior, unfair treatment or retaliation of any kind. Harassment is unacceptable in the workplace and in any work-related circumstances outside the workplace. MKCL provides access to remedy by resolving grievances in a timely and culturally appropriate manner.
- (d) MKCL is dedicated to maintaining a productive workplace by minimizing the risk of accidents, injury and exposure to health risk. MKCL is committed to engaging with its employees to continually improve health and safety in its workplaces.
- (e) MKCL is committed to maintaining workplaces that are free from violence, harassment, intimidation and other disruptive conditions due to internal and/or external threats. Security safeguards for employees are provided as needed and will be maintained with respect for employee privacy and dignity.
- (f) MKCL prohibits the use of all forms of forced/bonded labour and any form of human trafficking. MKCL does not employ any person below the age of eighteen years in its workplaces.
- (g). MKCL is committed to developing a culture which inculcates respect and support for human rights and seeks to avoid connivance in Human Rights abuses.

B. Code of Conduct

Policy:	Code of Conduct
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Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

The main objective in establishing the 'Code of conduct' is to promote ethics, honesty and professionalism within the Company and among its employees. The Company believes in being an integrated organization and that the action of every employee affects its entire organization and reputation. Every employee is obligated to strive for extension of Company's interest within the legal limits, and responsible of preventing damages or loss of the Company's interests. The Company expects its Human Resources to abide by this code in carrying out their duties and functions so as to preserve public trust and to ensure Company's sustainable growth and development. The Company also expects its employees to be vigilant and always commit to highest standards of honesty and integrity.

2. Definitions:

- (a) 'Relative' means anyone who is related to another, if -
 - (i) they are members of a Hindu Undivided Family;
 - (ii) they are husband and wife; or
 - (iii) one person is related to the other as father (including step-father)/ mother (including step-mother)/ son (including step-son)/ son's wife/ daughter/ daughter's husband/ brother (including step-brother)/ sister (including step-sister).
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C. General Code of Conduct

Policy:	Code of Conduct
Sub-Policy:	General Code of Conduct Policy
Date of issue:	March 05, 2018
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General standards of Conduct:

All employees, consultants, fellows, interns, trainees and Directors (to the extent applicable) of MKCL are required to adhere to Code of Conduct as stated below:

1. Scope and application:

The Company expects its Staff to exercise conscious judgement to ensure safety and welfare of the Company's Human Resources and to maintain a cooperative, efficient, positive, harmonious, and productive work environment and business conduct. These standards apply while working on MKCL's premises, off site locations where our business is being conducted, at Company sponsored business and social events, or at any other place where the employee is representing the Company.

2. Honest and ethical Conduct:

The Company dedicates itself to abide by commercial ethics and firmly believes in the values of an organization governed by legal ethics and governance. Ethical standards shall not be confined to legal compliances. The Staff shall be obligated to conduct all businesses ethically and to avoid any conflict of interest.

The principles governing honesty and ethics comprises as follows:

- (a) Exhibiting high standard of personal and professional integrity, moral and ethical standards in work and personal life.
- (b) Maintaining cordial and cohesive relationship with customers, business partners, co- employees and maintain ethical dealings with job, organization and society.
- (c) Displaying complete loyalty towards the Organization.
- (d) Following MKCL's policies, rules, regulations, guidelines announced from time to time.

Following work instructions given by the Appraiser/s and achieve mutually agreed plan, deliverables, targets. Refusal to obey the instructions of the concerned Appraiser shall be a serious case of misconduct, except where it is established by the employee to the satisfaction of the Disciplinary Committee that following of specific instructions of the Appraiser would have harmed organizational interests.

- (a) Conducting all business legally by complying to all applicable Statutes and honestly by abiding genuine processes in all the business dealings and not conducting any business for personal interest and benefits
- (b) Ensuring adequate confidentiality of all commercial transaction when executing any business and retaining complete commercial and operational records as well as the commercial assets and intellectual properties of the Company, each client and partner of the Company.
- (c) All accounting ledgers, invoices, records, accounting entries, capital and assets must be

secured and safeguarded to ensure that all Company transactions and business dealings can be fairly and accurately reflected.

- (d) It is strictly forbidden to fabricate, falsify or create misleading claims or to fabricate any accounting detail, records, financial reports or any other related documents, or to intentionally hide or cover the state of the Company's transactions.
- (e) It is forbidden to destroy, alter or forge any pertinent records that may likely be linked to an investigation, litigation or legal settlement proceeding.
- (f) No personnel shall access/share objectionable content. "Objectionable Content" includes, but is not limited to: (i) sexually explicit materials; (ii) obscene, defamatory, libelous, slanderous, violent and/or unlawful content or profanity; (iii) content that infringes upon the rights of any third party, including copyright, trademark, privacy, publicity or other personal or proprietary right, or that is deceptive or fraudulent; (iv) content that promotes the use or sale of illegal or regulated substances, tobacco products, ammunition and/or firearms; and (v) gambling, including without limitation, any online casino, sports books, bingo or poker.
- (g) When discovering incidents involving alleged unethical conduct or suspicious of violation of any Code of Conduct, the personnel shall inform his/her Appraiser.

3. Avoidance of Conflict of interest:

- (a) Prior to engaging into any business, contract, investment or related activity that may lead to conflict of interest between personal and professional relationships, the personnel must fully disclose such conflict of interest and report it to the KMT, and such conflict may be reviewed by the KMT.
- (b) Any Appraiser shall not be a relative of the Appraisee. In case there is an existing relation as 'Appraiser-Appraisee', and they become relatives later, then the said personnel shall disclose this immediately to the HRD. The Company shall make necessary changes in the reporting structure such that the concerned related personnel is no longer 'Appraiser-Appraisee'.
- (c) In any recruitment process, it is essential that all personnel and interview panel members remain unbiased and exercise independent judgment. To uphold fairness and transparency, any personnel who becomes aware that an appraisee, relative, friend, or acquaintance (hereinafter referred to as "**the acquaintance**") is participating in the recruitment process must adhere to the following mandatory guidelines:
 - Disclosure: Immediately inform HRD in writing upon realizing that an acquaintance is a candidate, regardless of the recruitment stage.
 - Neutrality: Ensure impartiality in all aspects of the recruitment process, including the formulation of eligibility criteria in job advertisements.
 - Confidentiality of Tests: Maintain strict confidentiality regarding test questions, assignments, and other evaluation materials.
 - Interview Panel Conduct: Refrain from providing ratings, comments, or recommendations for an acquaintance candidate.
 - Committee Leadership: If an acquaintance is involved, do not Chair the interview committee.
 - Confidentiality of HRD Findings: Do not disclose HRD's due diligence findings or background verification details, as these are strictly for internal use.
 - Professional Communication: Avoid informal discussions with HRD recruitment team members regarding candidates in general and acquaintance candidates in particular.

Similarly, disclosure in writing be made to HRD incase any of the Panel Members is an acquaintance.

The Company is committed to a fair, transparent, and merit-based selection process. Any personnel found engaging in undue influence to favour an acquaintance candidate will be considered in violation

of Company Policies, leading to disciplinary action for misconduct as determined by the Disciplinary Committee.

- (d) Personnel should avoid incidents that may involve a probable conflict of interest for instance personnel negotiating or conducting business transaction with the Company which would benefit such personnel or the employee's family or relatives personally. Personnel are prohibited to (a) take to themselves personal opportunities that are discovered using corporate property, information or identity, (b) use corporate information/property/position for personal gains and (c) compete with Company or engage in competing activities to the business of the Company.
- (e) All personnel are forbidden to engage in any of the aforesaid activities through an agent, partner or any representative only to circumvent the intent of the guidelines.
- (f) All employees that participate in the review, evaluation and selection of the vendors should avoid any circumstance that has the potential to bias a fair decision.
- (g) Unless for Company's business/official reasons, advanced authorization shall be sought prior to accessing any of the Company's services, equipment, facilities, properties or any other form of resources. All personnel should protect the Company's Assets and ensure their efficient use. The Company's assets whether tangible or intangible are to be used only for the legitimate business purpose of the Company.

4. Gifts and business gratuities:

All personnel are prohibited to accept from or give gifts (in cash or kind) to any customer, supplier, network partner or any other party related to the Company, for any illicit gain.

- (a) Personnel are not permitted to use their jobs, to solicit, to demand, accept, obtain or be promised advantages. This does not apply to the acceptance of occasional gifts of purely symbolic value or meals reasonable in value that are consistent with local customs and practices and MKCL's policies. Any other gifts or meals must be refused.
- (b) For the purpose of maintaining healthy business relations, gifts can be presented to business counterparts with prior approval of MD.
- (c) Personnel shall unconditionally follow the 'Corporate Anti-Bribery Code' in its entirety throughout their employment /association with the Company.

5. Outside Employment or directorship:

- (a) In consideration of employment with the Company, personnel shall devote full attention to the business interest of the Company.
- (b) Personnel are prohibited from engaging in any activity, especially during working hours, that interferes with their performance of responsibilities in the Company or is otherwise in conflict or prejudicial to the Company.
- (c) A personnel in full-time employment of the Company is restricted from engaging in any other employment/business for consideration (in cash/kind) directly/indirectly on his/her own/with any other person (including relative). In case of such engagement, it will amount to breach of Code of Conduct Policy and appropriate disciplinary actions will be taken including termination from services of the Company. Any personnel is free to engage in humanitarian and other social work as a volunteer and/or engage in a hobby (without consideration in cash/kind) outside office hours.
- (d) An employee on Maternity Leave or Paternity Leave shall not engage in any other employment/business for consideration (in cash/kind) directly/indirectly on her/his own/with any other person (including relative). In case of such engagement, it will amount to breach of Code of Conduct Policy and appropriate disciplinary actions will be taken including termination from services of the Company.

- (e) An employee may accept position of a non-executive director/non-managing Trustee in any Company/Trust which is not in competing business with MKCL, subject to prior approval of such appointment/s by the KMT. The employee may, in such a case accept 'sitting fees' for participating in Board/Trustees meeting. The KMT may disapprove incase it feels such appointment may hurt the business interests/goodwill of MKCL. An employee can be appointed as a non-executive director/Trustee in any associate/subsidiary companies/Trust of MKCL by the Board of MKCL. An employee can be appointed as an executive director in other Company only if sent on deputation by MKCL for such position and such appointments/recommendations are approved by the Board of Director of the Company.

6. Anti-bribery and Anti-corruption:

- (a) The Company has zero tolerance policy for bribery and corruption in any form. All personnel shall abide with the Corporate Anti-Bribery Code.

7. Political Contributions, Charitable Donations And Sponsoring:

- (a) The Company does not have any specific political affiliation and/or inclination. As such, the Company shall not make political contributions (donations to politicians, political parties/ political organizations). The Company as a Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) may make monetary or product donations for education, science, art and culture, social, humanitarian and compassionate grounds/projects/purposes. As CSR contribution, the Company may make donations to permitted Funds, Organizations, etc. All donations must be transparent i.e. among other things, that the recipient's identity and planned use of the donation must be clear and the reason and purpose of the donation must be justifiable and documented. The Company may give donation to Trust promoted by it and/or to a Company promoted by it as a Section 8 Company under the Companies Act, 2013 as authorized by its Board of Directors from time to time. Sponsorships for which the Company can give advertisements, participate in events are not considered donations, nor are contributions to industry associations or fees for memberships in organizations that serve business interests.
- (b) Any personnel should ensure that he/she does not give an impression of representing or being the spokesperson of the Company while getting associated with any political party or political activities in his/her personal capacity or expressing any political views.

8. Equal Opportunity Workplace free of discrimination or Harassment:

- (a) The Company is committed to providing a work environment free of discrimination and harassment. The Company believes in equal opportunity and makes all employment decisions based on merit and business requirements. All employees shall abide with the Company's Human Rights Policy.

9. Protection of Information of Personnel and Customers:

- (a) The Company respects the privacy of every individual and upholds strict standards of privacy and confidentiality of individual personal data. Principle of confidentiality and privacy shall be applicable to all customers, employees, commercial and other data of the Company subject to provisions of the Right to Information Act, 2005.
- (b) Each personnel should endeavor to deal fairly with confidential information of customers, vendors, contractors, competitors and other personnel of MKCL obtained during his/her course of employment and protect it like he/she would protect own information.
- (c) No personnel should take unfair advantage of anyone through manipulation, concealment, abuse of privileged information, misrepresentation of material facts or any other information that may primarily affect the individual.
- (d) All personnel are prohibited to disclose or provide openly any Company confidential information

without securing proper authorization from the concerned authority. It is strictly prohibited to trade confidential or insider information for individual gain, or to benefit others or put the Company's interest in jeopardy.

- (e) All personnel are prohibited to divulge, communicate and disclose to any other person not concerned with MKCL any information such as source code, information on production and data servers, routers, firewalls, Utility Programs and peer systems etc. either directly or indirectly through any communication media such as e-mails, Social media, chat, through Pen drives, CDs, DVDs, wi-fi or any other media including verbal communications.

10. Conduct on social media:

- (a) Only Employees authorized by MKCL may post information about MKCL on Social Media Platforms. Further, authorized employees should not publish, post or release any Company information which is considered 'confidential' or not within public domain. If there are doubts about what is considered 'confidential', employees should confirm with the Company Secretary of MKCL prior to posting of such information.
- (b) Personnel should not engage in prohibited social media conduct including posting commentary, content, or images that are defamatory, pornographic, proprietary, harassing, libelous, or which could create a hostile environment. While using social media, if personnel encounter a situation which may escalate to become hostile, the personnel should immediately disengage from the dialogue in a polite manner.
- (c) Employees should get appropriate permission before they refer to or post images of current or former employees, members, vendors or suppliers. Additionally, employees should get appropriate permission to use a third party's copyrights, copyrighted material, trademarks, service marks or other intellectual property.
- (d) For personal online posts, personnel are not allowed to include their association or designation in the Company in their identity on social media.
- (e) The Company shall not be liable and responsible for any direct and/or indirect costs and consequences arising out of the content posted by a personnel on social media. The concerned personnel is solely responsible for any such costs and consequences.

11. Full, fair, accurate, timely and understandable disclosure:

- (a) It is crucial that all books of accounts, financial statements and records of the Company reflect the underlying transactions and dispositions of assets in full, fair, accurate and timely manner.
- (b) All personnel who are involved in the Company's disclosure process are required to know and understand the disclosure requirements applicable to the Company that are within the scope of their responsibilities, and must endeavor to ensure that information in documents that the Company files with or submits to the Government, stakeholder, any customer or otherwise disclosed to the public, is presented in full, fair, accurate, understandable and timely manner.
- (c) It is critically important that the financial statements and related disclosures be free of material errors. Employees are prohibited from knowingly making or causing others to make a materially misleading, incomplete or false statements to an auditor or attorney in connection with an audit or any filing with any Government or Regulatory Authority.
- (d) No personnel or any person acting under his/ her direction, shall directly and indirectly take any action to coerce, manipulate, mislead or fraudulently influence any of the Company's Auditors.

12. Company Brand and Logo:

- (a) Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Limited (MKCL) name and logo of the Company is a registered trademark of the Company in India, personnel using the trademark must use the trademark reasonably for official documents.
- (b) B. The accurate trademark must be diligently used in all official presentations, documents or any other promotional context.
- (c) C. The Company has various other registered trademarks in the name of the Company, the use of correct logo for each of its product must be ensured by the personnel prior to usage of the same.

13. Software Usage:

- (a) All software used by the personnel to conduct the Company's business must be licensed/authorized. Personnel are strictly prohibited to use unauthorized copy of software/codes/other intellectual property of third party since doing so may result in intellectual property infringement and may expose the personnel and Company to civil and criminal liability.

14. Protecting the Intellectual property of the Company:

- (a) The personnel shall at all times safeguard the intellectual property of the Company and not disclose or share the same with any third party unless permitted under any contract or arrangement.

15. Drug/Alcohol abuse, Smoking:

- (a) The personnel shall be free from the influence of illegal drugs or controlled substances, or the abuse of prescribed/over-the-counter drugs/alcohol. Reporting to work under the influence of any illegal drug/alcohol, improperly using medication, or using, possessing, buying, or selling illegal drugs or controlled substances while on the job, on premises, operating property (including Company vehicles), or engaging in Company business is forbidden and may result in summary dismissal.
 - (b) The harmful effects to health of tobacco smoke, mainly due to increased risk of contracting lung cancer and heart disease is of concern to MKCL and the Company encourages those people who wish, to quit smoking. All Company premises, offices are designated 'Smoke Free'. Smokers are instructed not to smoke immediately outside the entrances to the Company premises. Further, at any functions, meetings, workshops, etc. conducted and organized by MKCL, the 'Non-Smoking' norm shall be followed. All directors, employees, trainees, interns, consultants, customers, business partners, contractors, vendors and visitors shall abide with this norm.
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Policy:	Code of Conduct
Sub-policy:	Dress Code Policy
Date of issue:	March 05, 2018
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1. Objective:

The Company recognizes that all employees act as representatives of the organization and should therefore be dressed accordingly. The way in which MKCL employees dress and present themselves plays an important part in the image that MKCL portrays to customer, business partners and the general public. For this reason, MKCL's employees should be aware of presentation of oneself and to adhere to the dress code policy at all times when representing MKCL.

2. Norms :

- (a) Discretion in style of dress is essential to the image and the safe and efficient operation of MKCL. Employees are expected to dress in a manner appropriate to their working environment and to the type of work performed. Employees, in conjunction with advice from their Appraisers, may use their judgement regarding their dress code and their schedule of activities should determine work attire.
 - (b) It is expected that the employees will apply a commonsense approach to the dress code and dress in an appropriate smart, professional manner on all working days.
 - (c) It would be expected that, on occasions when employees are meeting with external visitors from other organizations, or interviewing candidates, that they would dress in a professional manner.
 - (d) Employees may dress in traditional attires on festival days.
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E. Disciplinary Actions for misconduct

Policy:	Code of Conduct
Sub-policy:	Disciplinary Actions for misconduct
Date of issue:	March 05, 2018
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1. Objective:

MKCL strives to create a safe work environment with clear expectations that uphold accountability for individual conduct and address behaviors that disrupt that environment. When appropriate, a personnel will be given the opportunity to correct the conduct or behavior working with his/her Appraiser through informal discussions. If the misconduct continues, disciplinary action will be taken in a timely manner and in accordance with due process rights as defined in this Policy. Disciplinary action may be progressive depending on the severity of the misconduct. Disciplinary action may take the form of written warning, written warning placed in the personnel's file, disciplinary suspension without pay, or separation from employment. This Policy applies to misconduct related to violation of MKCL's policies, procedures and regulations, applicable Statutes, adherence to work schedules and attendance, appropriate standards of conduct, and ethical and professional behavior, with the exception of sexual misconduct (Please refer 'Anti-Sexual Harassment Policy'/'ASHP').

2. Definitions for the Purpose of this Policy:

- (a) **"Disciplinary action"** means an action taken to address actions of misconduct that may take the form of a written warning, written warning placed in the personnel's file, disciplinary suspension without pay, or separation from employment.
- (b) **"Disciplinary Committee"** means a committee constituted by the Board of Directors for matters regarding code of conduct, grievance redressal, suspensions, terminations, demotions and other disciplinary actions regarding employees.
- (c) **"Informal discussions"** refers to initial meetings between the Appraiser and personnel regarding an issue where there is good faith effort to resolve the issue so that initiation of a disciplinary action is not necessary.
- (d) **"Severe misconduct"** means conduct of such magnitude that an immediate response is required to prevent harm to an individual/the Company in particular and/or the Society in general.
- (e) **"Working Days"** means all days excluding Sundays, Saturday/s of every month declared by MKCL as 'weekly off' from time to time and annual holidays as declared by MKCL in the month of January each year as per its 'Leave Policy'.
- (f) **"Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)"** refers to a written directive to a personnel defining corrective measures and outcomes to address misconduct within a specified time.

3. Procedure related to misconduct:

The employees are expected to abide by Code of Conduct and other policies and procedures set forth by the Company from time to time. If personnel fail to adhere to the code of conduct, policies and procedures, disciplinary actions may be taken against the personnel depending upon the misconduct by the personnel. The procedure of disciplinary action shall be as follows:

- (a) When an Appraiser has identified an issue of alleged misconduct with a personnel that may be related to a violation of the ASHP, the issue should be discussed with the Presiding Officer of the "Internal Complaints Committee".
- (b) When an issue of alleged misconduct that is not covered by the ASHP has been identified, and it is not of a severe nature, the Appraiser should engage in informal discussions. The Appraiser must counsel the personnel regarding expectations and ways to correct the issue. The informal discussions may include verbal warnings related to areas of concern.
- (c) Prior to the issuance of any disciplinary action, the personnel shall first be provided with due process protections consisting of the following personnel's rights:
 - 1. Notice of the alleged offense;
 - 2. An explanation of the evidence available at the time, and
 - 3. An opportunity to respond to the allegations.
- (d) When informal discussions do not resolve the concern and/or the alleged misconduct is not of a severe nature, the Appraiser must take any of the following disciplinary actions:
 - 1. Issue a written warning to the personnel which specifies the violations, what changes in behaviour are necessary, and the consequences. The written warning will only be provided to the personnel and placed in the Appraiser's and personnel's file with the HRD.
 - 2. Issue a written warning to be placed in the personnel's file which specifies the violations, what changes in behaviour are necessary, and the consequences. The personnel will be asked to sign a document, indicating that the written warning has been received. The personnel may write a rebuttal, which will be attached to the document. A copy of the document(s) will be provided to the personnel and filed in the personnel's file with HRD.
- (e) When the alleged misconduct is of a severe nature or progressive discipline has not corrected the misconduct, the Appraiser must immediately notify the Chairperson of the Disciplinary Committee i.e. the Managing Director. Personnel may be placed on paid administrative leave during an investigation of allegations. For severe misconduct or misconduct that progressive discipline has not corrected, the following disciplinary actions may be taken:
 - 1. Disciplinary suspension without pay which has been approved by the Disciplinary Committee. If the Disciplinary Committee approves the suspension without pay, a letter notifying the personnel of the suspension will be issued by HRD and will be filed in the personnel's file. If the Disciplinary Committee does not approve the suspension without pay, alternative disciplinary action may be taken.
 - 2. Separation from employment may be recommended to the Disciplinary Committee for approval. Separation from employment disciplinary action would follow the **Separation from Employment Policy** and Appeal Procedure for **Involuntary Separation from Employment**.

- (f) When warranted, throughout any steps of these procedures, the Appraiser may place the personnel on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP).

4. Personnel Rights:

- (a) The personnel shall have the following post-disciplinary rights:
- (b) The personnel has the right to submit a written rebuttal to a written warning which will be placed in the personnel's file.
- (c) The personnel has the right to appeal disciplinary suspension without pay/separation from employment. Within seven (7) working days following the receipt of the letter notifying the personnel of the suspension without pay/ separation from employment, the personnel may submit an appeal in writing to the Disciplinary Committee. The Disciplinary Committee's decision shall be final and binding on all concerned.

4. Disciplinary Action:

Final Written Warning

- (a) A final written warning is given to the personnel at the second instance of serious mis-conduct. A final written warning is administered by the HRD, it shall state the exact nature of the offence, and indicates what future disciplinary action will be taken against the personnel if another offence occurs within a specified time limit. A copy of the written warning is placed in the personnel's record file. The personnel is required to read and sign the formal warning.

5. Further Disciplinary Action

If, despite previous warnings, personnel still fails to reach the required standards in a reasonable period of time, it will become necessary to consider further disciplinary action. The further disciplinary action will be decided by the Disciplinary Committee. The Disciplinary Committee's decision shall be final and binding on all concerned.

6. Summary Dismissal

Disciplinary Committee has right to summarily dismiss (instant dismissal without notice) a personnel without notice for serious misconduct or other conduct which justifies such dismissal. Only the Disciplinary Committee has the authority to summarily dismiss a personnel.

Summary dismissal may include cases where employees have indulged in:

- willful damage or loss to Company's property;
- willful or deliberate behavior inconsistent with the employment terms;
- conduct causing imminent and serious risk to a person's health or safety or the Company's reputation, viability or profitability;
- fraud, theft or dishonesty;
- assault;
- intoxication at work;
- bribery;
- insubordination;
- behavior where there is apprehension of risk to the security of company data, intellectual property, confidential information, assets.

In case of Summary dismissal, the personnel is neither entitled to notice as agreed in his/her contract of employment nor entitled to payment in lieu of notice.

F. Flexi Time Policy (Hours of Work Policy)

Policy:	Attendance Policy
Sub-Policy:	Flexi Time Policy (Hours of Work Policy)
Date of issue:	June 10, 2018
Effective Date:	June 11, 2018
Last revision Date:	September 19, 2024
Effective date of revision:	October 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.4

1. Objective:

The objective of this policy is to specify the hours of work and offer flexible timings to a limited extent for full-time employees. This is being done in view of significant increase in commuting time the employees have to invest in attending office due to increasing vehicular density on the roads. The objective of the policy on one hand is to ensure that Employees meet appropriate standards of punctuality and reliability in their attendance for meeting business needs and service standards at all times and avoiding any disruption of work and on other hand is to respond sensitively to Employees' personal/family exigencies and/or increasing commuting time due to heavy traffic conditions.

2. Norms:

1. Daily minimum continuous hours of work

- (a) **'Hours of Work'** means clock hours on a working day during which an employee is engaged in work-related activity that is pursued primarily on behalf of the Company, for the Company and within the Company or within the (clients'/ customers' / etc.) premises related to company's business or within the journey for official tours. 'Hours of work' include lunch and tea breaks as per Company norms.
- (b) **'Working Days'** means all days excluding all Saturdays and Sundays of every month and Annual Holidays as declared by MKCL each year.
- (c) **'Daily Minimum Continuous Hours of Work'** means all employees on all working days shall put in minimum continuous 8½ hours of work (including 6 hours of Core Timings stipulated below) inclusive of lunch and tea breaks on a full working day and minimum continuous 4 hours and 15 minutes of work (including 2.5 hours within the Core Timings stipulated below) on a half working day due to half day leave.

All Female employees to whom 'Well-being policy for Women Employees' is applicable, shall put in minimum continuous 8 hours of work (including 6 hours of Core Timings stipulated below) inclusive of lunch and tea breaks on a full working day and minimum continuous 4 hours of work (including 2.5 hours within the Core Timings stipulated below) on a half working day. Employees availing of half working day shall work either from 9:00 a.m. to 1:15/1:00 p.m. with a morning tea break or from 2:00 p.m. to 6:15/6.00 p.m. with afternoon tea break. They shall avoid a time slot of 4 hours which includes 1 hour of lunch break.

3. Work Timings:

- (a) **Core Timings:** The Core Office Timings shall be from 10:30 a.m. to 4:30 p.m. All employees, except those on approved leave (duty leave or otherwise), are required to be present in the office or at the client/ customer premises related to the Company's business, or in transit for official tours during these hours on all working days.
- (b) **Flexi Timings:** Employees will have the flexibility to come any time before 10:30 a.m., or leave any time after 4:30 p.m. However, s/he must complete 'Daily Minimum Continuous Hours of Work' per day as specified in sub-clause 1 (c) above. It be noted that as the time keeping is system driven, shortfall in minimum continuous hours of work even by 'a second', will result in half day leave deduction.
- (c) **Information Regarding Preferred Timings:** Employees shall inform in advance their preferred work timings to their Appraiser. This is essential so that the Appraiser can plan the work accordingly. Changes in preferred timings are allowed, if informed in advance and until the Core Timings (stipulated in 2(a) above) are observed by the employee. e.g.

(1) An employee who has informed the appraiser that his/her preferred work timings shall be from 10:00 a.m. to 6:30 p.m. daily, may decide to change to 10:20 a.m. to 6:50 p.m. on particular day/s with prior information to appraiser. As a result, an employee may have different 'in-time' and/or 'out-time' on all working days of the month, such that he/she is in office during the Core Timings and also completes the minimum continuous hours of work. In both cases, no leave shall be deducted.

(2) An employee who has informed the appraiser his/her preferred work timings from 10:30 a.m. to 7:00 p.m. daily, if comes at 10:30:01 a.m. on a particular day, and leaves at 7:01 p.m., then a half day leave will be deducted due to non-adherence of Core Timings. It be noted that as it is auto deduction, difference by 'a second' will also result in half day leave deduction.

- (d) **Leave deduction:** In case an employee works for less than 'Daily Minimum Continuous Hours of Work' on any day then appropriate leave will be deducted as shown below:

*Hours put in on a particular day	Leave deducted
Less than 4 hours	Full day
More than 4 hours but less than 8½ hours	Half day

* for Female employees to whom 'Well-being policy' is applicable, hours to be put in on a particular day would be as stipulated earlier.

In case, no permitted leave is available for deduction, then the same shall be treated as 'Leave without pay'.

- (e) **Late entry/early exit for Core Timings:** All employees shall follow Core Timings on every working day. Hence attendance entry after 10:30 a.m. shall result into automatic marking of half day leave. So also, the last exit before the close of Core Timings i.e. 4:30 p.m. for all shall be recorded as half day leave. The aforesaid half day leave shall be deducted from available leave balance of the concerned employee. Incase, no permitted leave is available for deduction, then the same shall be treated as 'Leave without pay'.
- (f) **Prefix and suffix leaves:** In case an employee avails full day Leave on prefixing Friday and full day leave on the following Monday, then the weekly off days i.e. Saturday and Sunday will also be considered as Leave and four days of leave shall be deducted from applicable,

available Leave balance or treated as 'Leave without Pay'. Further, in case an employee avails full day Leaves as Prefix and suffix to Optional Annual/Public Holidays, then the sandwiched Optional Holiday/s will also be considered as Leave/s and shall be deducted from applicable, available Leave balance or treated as 'Leave without Pay'.

4. Lunch Break

- (a) Employees are allowed to take up to one hour of lunch break, between 1:00 p.m. to 2:00 p.m. In order to avoid work disruptions of others, employees should normally follow the said lunch timings.

5. Daily Exercises & Tea-breaks

- (a) Daily exercises and tea-breaks shall be from 10:55 a.m. to 11:15 a.m. and 3:55 p.m. to 4:15p.m. sharp. Self-discipline to return to seat within time is expected of everyone.

6. Recording and Maintenance of Attendance

- (a) The Company shall provide appropriate facility, preferably electronic (viz. biometric attendance system), for accurate recording of attendance of employees. It is mandatory for every employee to record proper attendance on all working days. In case, any employee forgets to record in-time and/or out-time on any particular working day, then the same will be deducted as leave from available Casual/Earned Leave balance or treated as 'Leave without Pay'. Any deduction shall not be made in case, on any particular day/s such attendance recording facility was not functioning. It be noted that biometric attendance can be recorded through both fingerprints and iris scan.
- (b) The attendance record of the employees shall be maintained by HRD, till the lapse of two years after the full and final settlement of the employee relieved from service of MKCL.
- (c) The Company provides on daily basis accurate requisite information to each employee regarding his recorded 'in time' and 'out time' so as to facilitate the employee to ensure putting in the requisite minimum continuous hours of work. An email is received daily by an employee from MKCL G10 with subject line 'Din Vishesh' in which the details of "Today's In Time", "Today's Expected out Time" and "Last Working Day's Out Time" are stated. Employees should note these details and ensure the 'Daily Minimum Continuous Hours of Work' to avoid auto deductions of leaves/Leave without pay. Also, details of Program Team Members whose attendance has not been marked or who are on leave are mentioned in the same. On any particular day, due to technical issue/version update, such email is not received, then an employee can check his 'in time' by login to G10 under 'Attendance Report' and accordingly ensure the requisite minimum continuous hours of work.
- (d) No request communications be sent by an employee to allow omission on his part to mark any ODL/attendance/In-time/out-time as per specified norms. Any auto leave deductions for such omission on the part of the employee will not be withdrawn/reversed. Further, Compensatory offs should also be applied timely as per specified norms.

7. Employee Responsibility

- (a) Employees are required to adhere to their work schedules by reporting to work at the specified starting time, not departing before the specified ending time and taking lunch and tea breaks as specified. By proper work scheduling, planning and time management, an employee may strike the right work-life balance.
- (b) Employees are expected to adhere to their work schedules not merely for following the

stipulated clock hours per se but with full enthusiasm, intensity, dedication, scholarship, creativity and imagination to add ever increasing value not only to the company and its customers but also to their own career profile and professional standing.

- (c) Employees are expected to notify their appraisers as soon as possible, if they expect to arrive to work later than their informed preferred daily timings.
- (d) In order to avoid complaints from neighboring organizations, noisy chats over tea be avoided in public areas.
- (e) Frequent and lengthy personal mobile phone calls be suitably curtailed. Official emails, chats and meetings may be kept minimum in number, short, constructive and focused on actual business results for optimum resources utilization, time management, positive energy and enthusiasm.

8. Working beyond normal office hours

- (a) This clause specifies the norms for working beyond (before and after) normal office hours (8/8.5 hours inclusive of core timings within the window from 8.15 am to 6.45 pm) due to business exigencies.
- (b) It would be the responsibility of respective Appraisers to plan their work properly so that normally no employee has to come early and/or wait beyond normal office hours.
- (c) In case any employee has to work after 8.00 p.m. on any working day, then prior approval of the appraiser must be taken. In such case, an employee may order for food, water and non-alcoholic beverages up to Rs.650/- (Rupees Six Hundred & Fifty only) and submit the reimbursement claim with requisite bill within 10 working days.
- (d) An Employee should not normally work in the office beyond 10.00 p.m. unless warranted in extreme conditions.
- (e) Normally the lady employees should leave office at the close of their normal work timings. If a lady employee has to work in office beyond her normal working hours, prior approval of her appraiser is necessary. All lady employees must leave the office latest by 8.00 p.m. under any circumstances and shall not report to work before 8.00 a.m.

9. Exceptions

- (a) Notwithstanding the core timing requirements mentioned above, employees are permitted one late 'In-Time' per calendar month, with a maximum delay of up to 15 minutes (i.e., until 10:45:00 a.m.) without incurring a half-day leave deduction. However, the daily minimum requirement for continuous hours of work must still be adhered to.
- (b) In exceptional cases, an Appraiser may require an employee to work in different time shifts due to organizational requirements. For such requirements, the concerned Appraiser should obtain approval of the Managing Director. In such cases, norms concerning 'Core Timings' in this policy shall not be applicable.
- (c) An Appraiser reserves the right to ask any team member to come at 9:30 a.m. with a prior notice of 24 hours.
- (d) As a general condition of employment, however, employees are required to adhere to the work schedule specified by MKCL in case of organizational exigencies.

- (e) Notwithstanding anything stated above, this policy is not applicable incase the employee has applied for and received approval from his/her concerned Appraiser for 'On Duty Leave' (ODL). ODL may be applied when an employee has to attend to some official work outside his normal place of work or attend meetings, approved conferences, seminars, trainings, etc.
- (f) Incase an employee is 'On Duty Leave' for outstation official travel and returns back to his/her city of posting after 8.00 p.m., then such employee may report to work the following day by 11.30 a.m. and in such case the 'Daily Minimum Continuous Hours of Work' and/or the 'Core Office timing' of 10.30 a.m. for start of the day, will not be applicable, provided such employee applies for ODL stating the said reason and the same is recommended by concerned Appraiser. The concerned employee should necessarily record through the attendance system 'entry' and 'exit' timing for availing such facility.
- (g) Incase an employee is 'On Duty Leave' for outstation official travel and returns back to his/her city of posting after 8.00 a.m. on a working day, then such employee may work from home/remotely on that day, provided such employee applies for ODL stating the said reason and the same is recommended by concerned Appraiser.
- (h) Incase of heavy rains and flooding in rainy season, the Managing Director can declare 'Remote Working' for affected office/s.
- (i) The norms hereunder are not applicable incase an employee is availing any permissible leaves (viz. Casual leave, Sick Leave, Earned Leave, Maternity Leave, Paternity Leave, Compensatory off, Leave Without Pay) as per MKCL's 'Leave Policy'.
- (j) In case of general elections to the Lok Sabha and/or Vidhan Sabha and/or in case of any by-election/s, if the employee wishes to exercise his/her vote, then he/she shall prior inform so to the concerned Appraiser. MKCL offices remain open 24*7. An employee may, therefore, attend the office either before or after voting. It may be desirable to first vote and then come to office. Topmost priority should be given to voting. No one should miss voting due to office work. No late entry or early exit marking shall be made for anyone on the Election Day. Though, the norms regarding minimum hours of work and work timings shall be waived off for the Election Day, an employee shall mark attendance i.e., 'in' and 'out' timings through biometric.
- (k) Reporting to work on election day has been made considering that declaration of public holiday on Election Day (especially when Election Day is connected to some other holiday or non-working day) has normally adversely affected voting percentage among educated urban population in India.
- (l) In case any employee's voting registration is in town/city other than his/her work location and/or is on different date and he/she wishes to cast vote, then for travelling to such other place, prior application of full day 'On Duty Leave' (ODL) for the election day citing reason '*hometown voting*' be made in the employee portal. Such employee shall share soft copy of his/her voting card to hrd@mkcl.org which mentions the hometown address different to work location. ODL can be applied in such case only for the election day. The concerned appraiser should be kept informed of such ODL. It is suggested that employees change the address of voting registration to city/town of place of work location in case it is different. Further, to avoid work disruption, it is advised to not apply pre-fix and/or suffix leave to voting day.
- (m) In case of women employee(s) who have opted for "Half Day Work from Home/at Office" this policy would not be applicable. Such women employee(s) shall work either from 9.00

am to 01:00 p.m./01:15 p.m.* with a morning tea break from 10.55 a.m. to 11.15 a.m. or from 02:00 p.m. to 06:00 p.m. /6.15 p.m.* with afternoon tea break from 03:55 p.m. to 04:15 p.m. To those whom 'Well-being policy' is not applicable, will work for 15 minutes more on every working day.

NOTE: Flexi timings is a facility provided by the Company to the employees, it is not a right of the employee. Further, in case of an employee observed/reported to be misusing / taking undue advantage of this policy, appropriate disciplinary action shall be taken.

G. Well-being Policy for Women Employees

Policy:	Attendance Policy
Sub-Policy:	Well-being Policy for Women Employees
Date of issue:	April 01, 2017
Effective Date:	April 01, 2017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.2

1. Applicability:

This Policy is applicable to the women employees of MKCL belonging to Staff Type 'Member' in all 'Categories'.

2. Objective & Norms:

The Sixth and Seventh Central Pay Commission, with an objective to ensure more participation of women in professional careers and keeping in view the facilities extended to women employees in other countries, has made certain recommendations for welfare of the women employees.

In recognition of the spirit of social sensitivity and empathy for the working women as reflected in the recommendations of the Sixth and Seventh Central Pay Commission and in recognizing the vital need of self-care, regular rest and well-being of the working women shouldering professional responsibilities in addition to home making and/or child care and child development, the women employees were allowed weekly holiday on all Saturdays as 'Well-being leave' in addition to the weekly holiday on all Sundays. In order to compensate for the resultant shortfall of working hours beyond the one implied in these recommendations, these women employees were required to put in 30 minutes of extra work on all working days.

However, w.e.f. July 01, 2022 MKCL implemented 5-day working Week for all employees. As such, the extra 30 minutes applied to these women employees was withdrawn. As such, women employees appointed under Staff Type 'Member' will, on all working days, put in minimum continuous 8 hours of work instead of 8½ hours of work applicable to all male employees and non-member women employees.

H. MKCL's Corporate Anti-Bribery Code

Policy:	Anti-Bribery Code
Date of issue:	March 05, 2018
Effective Date:	April 01, 2018
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

As stated by the Central Vigilance Commission, the Company believes that corruption has been one of the major obstacles to economic, political, and social progress of our Country. It believes that all stakeholders such as Government, citizens and private sector need to work together to eradicate corruption. Every citizen should be vigilant and always commit to highest standards of honesty and integrity and support the fight against corruption.

The Company has formulated this "MKCL's Corporate Anti-Bribery Code" ("**the Code**") based on the 'Corporate Anti-Bribery Code' issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India, to ensure that neither the Company nor any of its personnel, directors or authorized representatives indulge in bribery in any of their actions taken for and on behalf of the Company in the course of economic, financial or commercial activities of any kind.

2. Scope:

1. The Code shall be applicable to the Company and its
 - (i) Board of Directors,
 - (ii) Employees (full time/part-time/temporary/contractual/employed through any third-party contract),
 - (iii) Interns, Trainees, Fellows
 - (iv) Network Partners, Business Partners, Agents, Associates, , Representatives and Intermediaries,
 - (v) Auditors, Advisors, Consultants, Bankers
 - (vi) Customers
 - (vii) Contractors, Sub-contractors, Vendors and Suppliers of goods and/or services.
2. All the above persons shall-
 - follow probity and rule of law in all walks of life;
 - neither take nor offer bribe;
 - perform all tasks in an honest and transparent manner;
 - be accountable for their actions;
 - act in public interest;
 - lead by example exhibiting integrity in personal behavior;
 - report any incident of corruption to the Disciplinary Committee.

3. Definitions:

For the purpose of this Code, unless the context otherwise requires,

- (a) **'Bribery'** includes giving or receiving bribe and third-party gratification. The act of giving bribe is when committed intentionally in the course of economic, financial or commercial activities and when it is established that there is a promise, offering or giving, directly or indirectly, of an undue advantage to any person who directs or works, in any capacity, for a commercial entity, for the person himself or for another person, in order that he in breach of his duties, act or refrain from acting.

The act of receiving bribe is when committed intentionally in the course of economic, financial or commercial activities and when it is established that there is solicitation or acceptance, directly or indirectly, of an undue advantage by any person who directs or works, in any capacity, for a commercial entity, for the person himself or for another person, in order that he in breach of his duties, act or refrain from acting.

- (b) **'Facilitation payment'** means a payment made to government or private official that acts as an incentive for the official to complete some action or process expeditiously to the benefit of the party making payment.
- (c) **'Foreign public official'** means any person holding a legislative, executive, administrative or judicial office of a foreign country, whether appointed or elected, whether permanent or temporary, whether paid or unpaid and includes a person who performs a public function or provides service for a foreign country.
Words and expressions used and not defined in this Code shall have the meaning assigned to them in their respective Acts.

4. The Code:

Adherence to Anti-Corruption Laws

The Company shall follow all anti-corruption laws applicable in India.

- (a) **Bribery in Private Sector**
The Company or its employees, directors, agents, associates, consultants, advisors, representatives or intermediaries and others mentioned in clause 2(1) above shall not be involved in bribery.
- (b) **Facilitation Payments**
No facilitation payment shall be made by the Company either directly or through its employees, directors, agents, associates, consultants, advisors, representatives or intermediaries.
- (c) **Bribery to Foreign Public Officials**
The Company, either directly or through its employees, directors, agents, associates, consultants, advisors, representatives or intermediaries in the conduct of international business shall not offer, promise or give any undue pecuniary or other advantage, to a foreign public official, for that official or for a third party, in order that the official acts or refrains from acting in relation to the performance of official duties, in order to obtain or retain business or other improper advantage.

(d) **Policy for Gifts, Hospitality & Expenses**

The Company shall follow a Policy for gifts, hospitality and expenses as mentioned in Annexure A.

(e) **Policy on purchases through suppliers and other service providers**

The Company shall follow a Policy for purchases through suppliers and other service providers as mentioned in Annexure B.

(f) **Whistle Blower Mechanism**

The Company shall set up a Whistle Blower mechanism as mentioned in Annexure C, to enable its employees or others to raise concerns and report violation(s) of The Code.

(g) **Monitoring Mechanism for Anti-Bribery Code**

The 'Disciplinary Committee' constituted by the Board shall regularly monitor the adherence to the Anti-Bribery Code.

(h) **Sanctions for Non-Compliance**

For non-compliance of any part of the Code, the same shall be referred to the 'Disciplinary Committee' constituted by the Board and the disciplinary mechanism as specified in the 'Disciplinary Actions for misconduct' under the 'Code of Conduct Policy' shall be followed.

5. Supremacy of applicable laws

This Code does not seek to substitute or supplant any existing laws. If any of the parameters of this Code are or become inconsistent with the applicable laws, provisions of related applicable laws shall prevail.

POLICY ON GIFTS, HOSPITALITY & EXPENSES

A. Receipt of Gifts and Hospitality

(a) When offered a business courtesy, personnel should determine whether it is appropriate to accept

the courtesy on behalf of the Company after considering why is it being extended and possible

repercussions of acceptance.

(b) A personnel can accept a gift and business courtesy:

- When the courtesy is usually associated with customary business practices;
- Which promotes successful working relationships and goodwill with persons or firms with whom the Company maintains or may establish a business relationship. Such courtesies include infrequent business meals that are shared with the person who has offered to pay for the meal. However, personnel are expected to use good judgment and decline invitation for meals that are inappropriately lavish or excessive and are of such nature or magnitude that cannot be reciprocated;
- Which conforms to the reasonable and ethical practices of the marketplace, such as flowers, fruits baskets, and other modest presents, that commemorate a special occasion;
- Which does not create conflict of interest or divided loyalty, such as placing the interests of the person or firm that offered the courtesy above the interests of the Company, including the Company's interest in conducting business fairly and impartially;
- Which does not create the appearance of an improper attempt to influence business decisions, such as accepting courtesies from a supplier whose contract is expiring in the near future; and
- Novelty advertising or promotional items of nominal value, such as calendars, pens and mugs may generally be retained.

(c) Personnel shall neither seek nor accept for themselves or others any gifts, favours, business courtesies or entertainment without a legitimate business purpose, or loans (other than conventional loans at market rates from lending institutions) from any person or business organization that does or seeks to do business with, or is a competitor of the Company.

(d) The following actions of a personnel shall be completely unacceptable:

- Asking for a business courtesy.
- Accepting a business courtesy when:
 - An attempt is being made by the giver to offer the courtesy in exchange for or to influence, favorable action by the Company.
 - An attempt is being made to motivate a personnel to do anything that is prohibited by law, regulations, or Company's policy.

- An attempt is being made to gain an unfair competitive advantage by improperly influencing an employee's discretionary decisions.
- Using a Company position as a means of obtaining business courtesies, such as personal discounts (on products, services/ or other items). Employees may accept Company approved discounts or discounts available to all employees of the Company.
- Accepting offers of expense-paid trips for pleasure from persons or firms with whom Company maintains or may establish a business relationship.
- Accepting a gift in cash or cash equivalents of any amount.
- If it is not appropriate to accept or retain a courtesy, the personnel should either politely refuse the business courtesy at the time it is offered or return it to the giver with a polite explanation that Company's policy prohibits retention of the business courtesy.

B. Gifts, Hospitality and Expenses

- (a) Employees may offer business courtesies to customers, provided the following four conditions are met:
 - The business courtesy does not violate any law or regulation or policy of the Company;
 - The business courtesy is customary and consistent with the business practices of the marketplace in which it is offered;
 - Approval of the concerned Appraiser is obtained; and
 - The business courtesy is properly reflected on the books and records of the Company.
- (b) An employee should never use personal funds or resources to do something that cannot be done with Company's resources.
- (c) If any doubt exists as to the impact of an offer of a business courtesy on the reputation of the Company or of those involved, the business courtesy shall not be offered.

Annexure B

POLICY ON PURCHASES THROUGH SUPPLIERS AND OTHER SERVICE PROVIDERS

- (a) A supplier's or potential supplier's proprietary information and resources must be protected by employees in accordance with confidentiality policy of the Company. Personnel s are responsible for complying with supplier- imposed limitations governing use of supplier information, including such items as documents and computer software.
- (b) Company's proprietary or sensitive information must not be disclosed to a supplier or potential supplier unless disclosure is authorized by the Company.
- (c) Purchase decisions must be made purely on the basis of quality, service, price, delivery, best value or other similar factors. Extraneous or personal interest/advantage shall not be criteria for arriving at purchase decision.
- (d) All Company personnel, contract labour, representatives, agents and others acting for the Company are prohibited from soliciting, accepting, or attempting to accept any bribe including, directly/indirectly, the amount of any bribe in the price charged under a contract, either as prime contractor or sub-contractor.
- (e) Suppliers/service providers shall be required to ensure that their actions in no way contravene any provisions of Company's Code of Conduct Policies. The overarching principle that the supplier/vendor ought to keep in mind is that their actions should not result in any direct/indirect personal advantage or gain for any employee or his relatives. Any supplier or vendor found to be violating any of the such policies shall subject himself to the possibility of termination of his contract and the payment of liquidated damages.
- (f) All the payments made or commissions paid in connection with the Company's purchases of goods and services shall:
 - be supported by documentation that is complete and clearly defines the nature and purpose of the transaction;
 - be consistent with trade practices and in conformity with applicable laws;
 - bear a reasonable relationship to the value of goods delivered or services rendered; and
 - be directly to the Company and not to individual officers, employees or agents of such entity or a related business entity.
- (g) Commission, rebate, credits, waivers, discounts or allowances that are paid or granted by the Company may in conformity with normal standard procedures need not be documented in a written agreement.

WHISTLE BLOWER POLICY

1. Objective:

The "Whistle Blower Policy" provides a mechanism to employees to bring to the Company's attention, instances of unethical behavior, actual or suspected incidents of fraud or violation of the Company's Code of Conduct or Corporate Anti-Bribery Code, that could adversely impact the Company's operations, business performance and/or reputation. The Company will investigate such reported incidents in an impartial manner and take appropriate action to ensure that the requisite standards of professional and ethical conduct are always upheld.

2. Principles:

It is MKCL's Policy:

- (a) To create an environment where every personnel feels free and secure to report specific incidents of unethical behavior, actual or suspected incidents of fraud or violation of the Company's Code of Conduct or Corporate Anti-Bribery Code;
- (b) To investigate such reported incidents in a fair manner;
- (c) To take appropriate disciplinary action against the delinquent employee(s);
- (d) To ensure that no employee is victimized or harassed for bringing such incidents to the attention of the Company.

3. Reporting Mechanism:

A. Personnels may bring to the attention of the Disciplinary Committee incidents pertaining, inter alia, to:

- (i) Illegal or unethical conduct including that which adversely affects investors, shareholders, customers, suppliers, business partners, other employees, or the business performance or image or reputation of the Company;
- (ii) Violation of any law or regulation including actual or suspected fraud;
- (iii) Conflict of interest with the Company;
- (iv) Leaking of confidential or proprietary information of the Company;
- (v) Any other violation of the Company's Code of Conduct;
- (vi) Any other violation of the Corporate Anti-bribery Code.

B. "A Whistle Blower" is the employee making a protected disclosure under this policy. "Protected disclosure" means any communication made in good faith that discloses or demonstrates information that may provide evidence of unethical or improper activity. Complaint should be made to the Disciplinary Committee with copies to the HRD (hrd@mkcl.org) and the Managing Director (md@mkcl.org). Anonymous complaint will not be entertained. If the Whistle Blower has reasons to believe that any member of the Disciplinary Committee is involved in the suspected violation, the complaint may be addressed directly to the Managing Director.

C. Complaint shall be made in writing in English with the Whistle Blower clearly mentioning his/her full name, employee code, Program name, place of posting. Anonymous or pseudonymous complaints shall not be entertained. Complaint shall be signed and dated. Complaint must include as much information about the suspected violation as the Whistle

Blower can provide. It should describe:

- (i) the nature, period of commission and details of the alleged violation;
- (ii) the identities of the persons suspected to have committed the alleged violation; and
- (iii) a description of the documents that would prove or relate to the suspected violation.

- D. Employees are encouraged to report such incidents as early as possible, in any case within 30 days of the suspected violation / breach noticed by him / her, so that timely action can be taken.

4. Investigation:

- (a) Upon receipt of a complaint, the procedure as specified in the 'Disciplinary Actions for misconduct' under the Code of Conduct Policy shall be followed.
- (b) All employees have a duty to cooperate in an investigation.
- (c) All information disclosed during the course of an investigation, including the identity of the Whistle Blower, will be kept confidential, except as necessary or appropriate to disclose for the purposes of the investigation or where required to be statutorily disclosed.
- (d) If the Disciplinary Committee determines that a violation has occurred, then appropriate disciplinary action will be taken against the violator as specified in the 'Disciplinary Actions for misconduct' under the Code of Conduct Policy.

5. No Retaliation:

- (a) This Policy is intended to encourage and enable employees to raise bonafide concerns. No personnel who reports a violation shall suffer any harassment, retaliation or adverse employment condition as a consequence of such reporting.
- (b) Any personnel who retaliates against a person reporting a violation will be subject to disciplinary proceedings.

6. Complaint to be made in good faith:

- (a) A Whistle Blower must act in good faith and have reasonable grounds for forming a belief that his or her complaint constitutes a violation.
- (b) This Policy must not be used as a tool for victimization, making false allegation or acting malafide.
- (c) Any person who is found to be making baseless, reckless, malicious or deliberately false allegation, shall be subject to disciplinary proceedings, which may extend to termination of employment.

This Policy shall be in compliance and in line with any statutory requirements, if applicable.

I. Anti-Sexual Harassment Policy

Policy:	Anti-Sexual Harassment Policy
Date of issue:	March 05, 2018
Effective Date:	April 01, 2018
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.2

1. Objective:

Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Limited (MKCL) is committed to promoting a work environment that is conducive to the professional growth of its employees and encourages equality of opportunity. MKCL is also committed to providing work environment that ensures that every employee is treated with dignity and respect. MKCL believes in providing non-hostile safe working environment without fear of prejudice, bias, and sexual harassment to all its employees.

This policy is meant to educate the employees about what conduct constitutes sexual harassment, measures that MKCL will adopt to prevent occurrence of any such event, and in the event of such an occurrence, to enable a fair mechanism for dealing with such conduct.

2. Definitions:

- Complaint - Information given in writing made by the victim or on his/her behalf against sexual harassment attempted or perpetuated.
- Complainant - The person reporting an incident of sexual harassment.
- Victim - The person subjected to sexual harassment.
- Alleged Harasser - A person who is alleged or reported to have committed an act of sexual harassment.
- Employee – As per The Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 ("the Act"), "employee" means a person employed at a workplace for any work on regular, temporary, ad hoc or daily wage basis, either directly or through an agent, including a contractor, with or, without the knowledge of the principal employer, whether for remuneration or not, or working on a voluntary basis or otherwise, whether the terms of employment are express or implied and includes a co-worker, a contract worker, probationer, trainee, apprentice or called by any other such name..

3. Scope:

3.0 Applicability of this Policy:

- The Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 and as amended, replaced from time to time is the governing Act for this Policy.
- Notwithstanding that the Act is applicable to only women, this policy is applicable to all genders and in case/instance of -
 - Every employee across the Company -;
 - Every Director of the Company;
 - An alleged act of sexual harassment that has occurred during or beyond office hours;
 - An alleged act of sexual harassment, which has taken place within or outside the Company premises;
 - An alleged act of sexual harassment, which has taken place at any social, business or other

events where the conduct may have an adverse impact on the workplace or workplace relations;

- An alleged act of sexual harassment, which has taken place whether in the office premises or outside while on assignment.
- (c) Where sexual harassment occurs to an employee as a result of an act by third party or outsider while on official duty, MKCL will take all necessary and reasonable steps to assist the affected person in terms of support, redress and preventive action.
- (d) This policy is only applicable when either or both the alleged harasser and the victim are employees/agents of the Company. It is not applicable when both the alleged harasser and the victim are third parties.
- (e) The definition of sexual harassment shall include harassment caused to any gender and to or by any gender.

3.1 What is Sexual Harassment?

- (a) Sexual harassment includes any one or more of the following unwelcome acts or behavior (whether directly or by implication) namely-
 - i. physical contact and advances;
 - ii. a demand or request for sexual favours for implied/explicit promise of preferential treatment in employment;
 - iii. a demand or request for sexual favours for implied/explicit threat of detrimental treatment in employment;
 - iv. a demand or request for sexual favours for implied/explicit threat for present or future employment status;
 - v. Humiliating treatment adversely affecting physical, mental, psychological health or safety;
 - vi. making sexually coloured remarks, jokes, letters, phone calls, e-mail, sms, gestures, social media posts;
 - vii. showing pornography;
 - viii. any other unwelcome physical, verbal or non-verbal conduct of sexual nature;
 - ix. stalking in person and/or through telecommunication, electronic or other medium, including on social networking sites;
 - x. interfering with an individual's work performance or creating an intimidating, hostile or offensive work environment;
 - xi. any other conduct not included above, but having sexual colour.

3.2 What is not Sexual Harassment?

- a. Sexual harassment does not refer to normal conversation that all parties affected find acceptable. It does not refer to office relationships that are freely entered into without intimidation or coercion.

4. Preventive Actions:

- (a) State clearly and firmly to the harasser that his/her behaviour is unwelcome and that you want a particular behaviour to stop. If employees communicate by letter, then a copy must be preserved. If, after asking the harasser to stop his/her behaviour, the harassment continues, report abuse to your immediate appraiser and/or the Internal Committee (IC) formed for this purpose.
- (b) Say 'NO' emphatically and clearly when you are asked to go places, do things, and respond

to questions, or engage in situations that make you uncomfortable. Do not worry about offending the other person. Take care of yourself first. Trust your own instincts about possible danger. In an uncomfortable situation, be direct and honest, and remove yourself from the situation immediately.

- (c) Do not blame yourself. It is a violation of an individual's basic human right to work and live with dignity. Do not ignore the incident. The harasser may misinterpret a lack of response as approval of the behaviour. Do not delay. Delay in action increases the probability that unwanted behaviour will continue or escalate. Do not hesitate to ask for help. Speaking up may prevent others from being harmed as well.
- (d) Speaking about sexual harassment is an effective tool in combating it. While speaking about it, the problem becomes visible, it is acknowledged that it exists, and this leads to taking effective measures against it. Speaking about it, also gives an opportunity to clarify about it. It helps in changing attitudes of people towards this issue. It creates awareness among the employees which makes it difficult for a potential harasser to misbehave.
- (e) All Program Leaders and key managerial personnel (KMPs) have an obligation to provide a work environment free from sexual harassment and to take preventive and corrective actions. Employees may discuss the situation with their immediate appraiser or with another person in a position of authority.

5. Complaint Mechanism:

- a. An appropriate compliant mechanism in the form of 'Internal Committee' (IC) has been created in the Company for time-bound redressal of the complaint made by the victim.

6. Internal Committee:

- (a) The Board of Directors has constituted an Internal Committee ("IC") for redressal of sexual harassment complaint (made by the victim) and for ensuring time-bound treatment of such complaints.
- (b) The IC shall consist of at least 5 (five) members. At least one-half of the total members of IC shall be women. One member of the IC shall be from a non-governmental organization (NGO) or a lawyer. The IC shall be headed by Presiding officer who shall be a woman employed at a senior level. The Presiding Officer and every Member shall hold office for a period of three consecutive years from the effective date of his/her first nomination on the IC, subject to the condition that in case any of them cease to be in employment with MKCL (not applicable to NGO/lawyer Member), then he/she shall automatically cease to be a member and the vacancy such caused shall be filled by the Managing Director. The members of the IC shall be decided by the Board of directors of the Company from time to time and the same shall be communicated to the Employees by notice issued by the Managing Director. A person shall be disqualified for being appointed, elected, nominated or designated as, or for being continued as, a member of the IC if there is any complaint concerning sexual harassment pending against her/ him or if she/he has been found guilty of sexual harassment/ serious misconduct.
- (c) The IC shall meet at least once in a financial year even if there is no live case, and review the strict implementation of this policy. The meeting of the IC shall be convened by the Presiding Officer as and when required and that a formal notice of meeting of the said Committee shall be necessary. The Presiding Officer may invite other officers, persons s/he feels necessary. The quorum for the meeting of the said Committee shall be 2/3rd members. The Presiding Officer shall be responsible for recording minutes of the meeting and maintaining finalized duly signed minutes of the meetings and various documents, records concerning the said Committee meetings.

- (d) The IC shall have a permanent email id as specified in the Notice of constitution of the IC, for employees to register their grievances, complaints or concerns via email.
- (e) The IC is responsible for-
- Investigating every formal written complaint of sexual harassment.
 - Taking appropriate remedial measures to respond to any substantiated allegations of sexual harassment.
 - Discouraging and preventing employment-related sexual harassment.

7. Procedures for resolution, settlement or prosecution of acts of sexual harassment:

The Company is committed to providing a supportive environment to resolve concerns of sexual harassment as under-

A. Informal resolution option:

- a. When an incident of sexual harassment occurs, the victim of such conduct can communicate disapproval and objections immediately to the harasser, state clearly and firmly to the harasser that his/her behaviour is unwelcome and that a particular behaviour should stop immediately. If the harassment does not stop or if victim is not comfortable with addressing the harassment directly, the victim can bring her/his concern to the attention of the IC for redressal of her/his grievance. The IC will thereafter provide advice or extend support as requested and will undertake prompt investigation to resolve the matter.

B. Complaints:

- (a) An employee with a harassment concern, who is not comfortable with the informal resolution option or has exhausted search options, may make a formal complaint to the Presiding Officer of the IC. The complaint shall be made in writing within a period of three months from the date of incident and in case of a series of incidents, within a period of three months from the date of last incident, submitted in a sealed envelope marked as 'Confidential'.
- (b) Alternatively, the employee can send complaint through an email.
- (c) The complainant employee is required to disclose -
- her/his name,
 - program name,
 - location s/he is working in,
 - date and time of the incident,
 - the place/s where it occurred,
 - name and contact information (if possible) of the accused,
 - name and contact information (if possible) of witnesses (if any),
 - detailed description of the incident/s

to enable the Presiding Officer to contact her/him and take the matter forward.

- (d) The Presiding Officer shall convene and hold meeting of the IC, preferably within 30 days from the receipt of the written complaint. The IC will determine whether the allegations (assuming them to be true only for the purpose of this determination) made in the complaint fall under the purview of sexual harassment.

- (e) In case, the allegation does not fall under the purview of sexual harassment or allegation does not constitute an offence of sexual harassment, the IC will record this finding with reasons and communicate the same to the complainant.
- (f) If the IC determines that the allegations constitute an act of sexual harassment, it shall conduct and complete the inquiry within a period of ninety days.
- (g) Where such conduct, on the part of the accused, amounts to a specific offence under the law, the Company shall initiate and/or help in initiating necessary action in accordance with law by making a complaint with the appropriate authority.
- (h) Where both the parties are employees, the parties shall, during the course of inquiry, be given an opportunity of being heard and a copy of the findings shall be made available to both the parties enabling them to make representation against the findings before the IC.
- (i) The IC shall submit a written report containing the findings and recommendations to the Managing Director within a period of ten days from the date of completion of the inquiry. The copy of the Report will be made available to the concerned parties.
- (j) Where the IC arrives at the conclusion that the allegation against the respondent has not been proved, it shall recommend to the Managing Director that no action is required to be taken in the matter.
- (k) Whether IC arrives at the conclusion that allegation against the respondent has been proved, the Managing Director shall act upon the recommendation made by the IC, within sixty days of its receipt by him/her.
- (l) In case of conclusion being drawn that the allegation has been proved, possible disciplinary actions arising out of the recommendations by the IC may include –
 - Written apology.
 - A letter of warning may be placed in the HR records.
 - Immediate transfer or suspension without pay or both.
 - Stoppage of increment or promotion or both.
 - Reduction in pay level.
 - Curtailment of perquisites, facilities and employee benefits.
 - Termination from the services of the Company.
 - Filing a complaint before the relevant police station/ court/ other appropriate authority.
 - Action for misconduct in accordance with the provisions of the applicable Company policies.
 - Deduction from the salary of the respondent (harasser) as may be considered appropriate by the IC to be paid to the victim or to her/his legal heir/s.
 - Mandatory attendance in a prevention of sexual harassment workshop or counselling program.
 - Any other action which IC may deem fit.

8. Confidentiality:

- (a) The Company understands that it is difficult for the victim to come forward with a complaint of sexual harassment and recognizes the victim's interest in keeping the matter confidential.
- (b) To protect the interest of the victim, the alleged harasser and others who may report incidents of sexual harassment, confidentiality will be maintained throughout the inquiry process to the extent practicable and appropriate under the circumstances.

9. Access to reports and documents:

- (a) All records of complaints, including contents of meetings, findings of inquiry and other relevant information will be kept confidential by the Company except where disclosure is required under disciplinary, statutory or other remedial processes.

10. Protection to complainant/ victim:

- (a) The Company is committed to ensuring that no employee who brings forward harassment concern is subjected to any form of reprisal. The Company will ensure that the victim or witnesses are not victimized or discriminated against while dealing with complaints of sexual harassment.

11. Complaints made by malicious intent:

- (a) If, on inquiry, it is found that a complaint was made with a malicious intent or the complainant has produced any forged or misleading document, evidence, etc., strict action will be taken against the complainant.
- (b) In the event that the formal request for inquiry is proved to be malafide, the IC shall recommend to the Managing Director that the person found guilty of such a fraudulent act be required to issue a written public apology to the person who has been so falsely accused, which is to be displayed prominently on all notice boards in the Company.
- (c) Insufficient evidence to support a complaint does not necessarily mean that the charge was intentionally false. Material, circumstantial, and factual evidence needs to be produced which could prove the complaint made was with malicious intent.

12. Possible disciplinary actions for filing complaint with malicious intent:

- A letter of warning may be issued.
- Immediate transfer or suspension without pay or both.
- Stoppage of increment.
- Reduction in pay level.
- Mandatory attendance in a sexual harassment workshop or counselling program.
- Any other action which IC may deem fit.

The intent of this policy is to create a harmonious and safe working environment. To ensure that this is upheld in both letter and spirit, we urge the employees to desist from lodging wrongful allegations. This would apply to third parties also.

13. Administration of this policy:

- (a) Notwithstanding that the Sexual Harassment Of Women At Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition And Redressal) Act, 2013 ("the Act") is applicable to only women, this Policy shall be administered as per provisions of the said Act (including any Statutory modification(s) and re-enactment thereof for the time being in force), and provisions of other applicable Statutes, irrespective of the gender of the complainant.
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Policy:	IT Assets Policy
Date of issue:	April 01, 2024
Effective Date:	April 01, 2024
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.0

1. Objectives:

Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Limited (MKCL) is committed to provide appropriate enabling technological ("IT") resources to its employees for proper discharge of their official responsibilities. This IT Assets Policy ("**the policy**") aims to specify minimum norms to personnel about judicious handling and use of IT assets allocated to them by the Company for discharge of official responsibilities. Each user of the MKCL's IT assets should realize the fundamental importance of these assets and is responsible for the safekeeping of the assets allotted to him/her.

2. Applicability:

This Policy applies to all the persons engaged by the Company as employees / consultants/ fellows/trainees (hereinafter referred as "**the Personnel**") to whom the Company has allocated IT Assets for official work of the Company.

3. Norms:

IT assets allocated to the Personnel is the property of MKCL and shall be strictly used for official purpose only. Following minimum norms shall be observed by all those personnel who have been allocated IT Assets owned by MKCL:

- (a) Due and reasonable care of the assets in regards to handling and use of the same shall be taken as an ordinarily prudent and rational person would use in the circumstances.
- (b) At the time of allocation of any IT asset, an e-mail shall be sent to the concerned personnel. In case, such IT Asset has not been received by him/her, he/she should reply within 2 working days accordingly.
- (c) Lending/hypothecating/allowing use of allocated IT Asset to any other person is prohibited.
- (d) In case the IT asset/s allotted is/are misplaced, lost or stolen (outside MKCL's office premises), its replacement shall be done by the concerned Personnel, with a new one of same or higher specifications at his/her own cost with remaining warranty/guarantee coverage. Full ownership of such replaced asset/s would belong to MKCL. If the misplaced, lost, stolen asset was insured by MKCL, MKCL would try to claim the insurance amount from the Insurance Company. If the claim is accepted by the Insurance Company, the amount paid by the Insurance Company would be passed to the concerned Personnel.
- (e) In case of physical damage (not caused by normal wear and tear/normal use) of the IT asset caused by the Personnel, the concerned Personnel shall be responsible for repairing of the asset at his/her own cost or its replacement with a new one of the same or higher specifications at his/her own cost with remaining warranty/guarantee coverage. If required by

the Personnel, MKCL may assist the Personnel in getting the asset repaired/replaced. However, in such cases also, the repair/ replacement cost would be fully borne by the concerned Personnel. This sub-clause is applicable only when the IT Asset is less than 3 years old. In case the IT Asset is more than 3 years old then MKCL will bear the expenses for the same. If any damage is observed, then the concerned Personnel should communicate via email about the specific damage along with photo image of the same within 2 working days of IT asset allotment/observing the damage.

- (f) The IT asset/s allotted shall be returned to the Company in a proper working condition (subject to normal wear and tear) without deleting any official software and/or official data as and when asked by MKCL or on conclusion of employment with MKCL, whichever is earlier.
- (g) Installation of unlicensed/pirated/illegal software is prohibited and in case such software is found to be installed then he/she will be solely responsible for the cost and consequences and further the said act will be considered as misconduct inviting disciplinary actions.
- (h) It is understood that any Personnel is not responsible in case of repairable/irreparable damage to the asset/s due to normal wear and tear and/or product malfunctioning **not** due to negligence/misuse by him/her and/or loss/theft at workplace (including during official duty travel). However, in such cases, the decision of the Key Management Team (KMT) shall be final and binding on all.
- (i) Every quarter, the Company shall send mailers to the Personnel which would contain the list of IT Assets allotted to the Personnel. The Personnel would have to verify and confirm that the IT Asset allotment data is correct by return mail within 2 working days, else it would be assumed that the asset allotment data is correct.
- (j) MKCL reserves rights to access or monitor IT asset and data thereon at any time for verification/ examining of data without any intimation to the personnel but subject to prior written approval of the CEO.
- (k) The IT Assets assigned to a Personnel who is separating from MKCL, shall be handed over to the specified IT Team member and written acknowledgement for the same should be given. The copying of data from the IT Asset of the separating Personnel will be the responsibility of the respective appraiser. If required, the assistance of IT Team member can be sought while copying the data.
- (l) Preferably, the Company shall provide its own IT assets for discharge of official responsibilities. In exceptional cases, in case a Personnel desires to use personal laptop or similar device ("the device") for official use, then he/she can use it after taking prior approval from the concerned Program Leader. In such case, only software support will be provided by the Company. To ensure security, corporate antivirus and other security software / updates would be installed on such device. The Company will have full access rights to monitor such personal device/s. Further, the Company shall not be responsible directly and/or indirectly for any activity unrelated to the official responsibilities done by the concerned Personnel using the personal device.
- (m) Misuse/inappropriate/unauthorized/improper usage of MKCL's IT asset by any Personnel shall amount to misconduct and appropriate actions will be taken in case of such Personnel under the Disciplinary Actions for Misconduct Policy.

K. Software and Data Security Policy

Policy:	Software and Data Security Policy
Date of issue:	June 01, 2021
Effective Date:	July 01, 2021
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

The Software and Data Security Policy aims at safeguarding confidentiality and integrity of software, user data and information of the Company. This policy specifies the basic norms to be followed to protect the Company, its personnel, and its customers from threats whether internal or external, deliberate, or accidental.

In order to ensure this protection, it is necessary to-

- Keep the information confidential by protecting it from unauthorized personnel;
- Maintain the integrity of the information by ensuring it's reliability and accuracy by preventing unauthorized alteration or modification;
- Control the accessibility of the information so that only authorized personnel has access to confidential documents;
- Monitor the employees' systems to which they have access under specific circumstances and with prior approval of the Chief Technology Officer (CTO).

2. Applicability:

This Policy is applicable to all personnel of the Company in general and Software Development and IT Infrastructure Development & Management (IT Infra-DMP) Teams in particular. The IT Infra-DMP has responsibility for implementing this Policy, ensuring its adherence and offering advice and guidance on its implementation.

3. Norms:

I. MANDATORY NORMS

A. Access to Code and Data

(a) Business Development Teams shall understand and enlist risk of known data security issues and plan for mitigation in their service/product with regards to:

- Team member's access to data
- Using old version of technology
- Using vulnerable technologies
- Tools having access to data and servers
- Keeping client's data on MKCL servers
- Archival of data
- Taking the access of the data residing at employee's systems under specific circumstances
- Taking direct access of data residing at client premises.

- (b) Business Development Teams shall enlist Sensitive Data fields which should be protected, encrypted, and need to log for each change and ensure that the same is implemented and tested in software.
- (c) Every team shall create an Access Matrix which specifies 'who' in their team has 'what' access to 'which' part of the code and which part of the data and review and revise as per changes in the Organizational Structure.
- (d) Concerned Program Leaders and Sr. Program Coordinators /Program Coordinators shall ensure that any team members are normally not given production data access. Such access can be given only for exceptional reasons if approved by the CTO.
- (e) Concerned Teams shall submit Access matrix details to the Internal/external ISMS Auditor, Security Team to CTO every year.
- (f) Business Development Teams shall prepare an Archival Plan for all the projects handled by them and ensure its implementation. This is to ensure that the performance of the software is optimum, and the security footprint of the software is minimized. The Archival Plan shall be sent to CTO and shall be reviewed at least every 6 months.
- (g) Technical Team Members shall be given access to specific branch of code concerning their project/s only.
- (h) Only Program Leader, Program Coordinator / Sr. Program Coordinator and Architects shall be given access to the full code concerning their project/s.
- (i) Requests for access shall be made afresh in the month of March every year to the Program Leader who shall consider the same grant access if felt appropriate. Accordingly, Production access shall be reset every year in the month of April (No access to production Data).
- (j) Requests to provide access to code/data shall be initiated only by the concerned Program Leader/Sr. General Manager/Sr. Program Coordinator.
- (k) Re-allocation of manpower from one project to another shall be informed vide monthly organization structure and/or through office order and the CTO shall take requisite actions for maintaining access to code / data.
- (l) Concerned Program Leader/ Program Coordinator shall inform vide email regarding closure of any project to concerned SDP and IT Infra-IDMP to revoke access rights from code / application / server.
- (m) Periodic review of overall security of the IT infrastructure and software frameworks shall be done by concerned Program Leader and Sr. Program Coordinator/ Program Coordinator every 6 months.

B. Software Security:

- (a) Password complexity shall be implemented for all logins along with hashing of password. Maintain log of logging related details.
- (b) Password expiry and Password lockout shall be implemented.
- (c) 'User' shall be deactivated in case it is not used for a continuous period of three months.

- (d) It can be reactivated only on recommendation by concerned Program Coordinator and with written approval.
- (e) All sensitive data fields shall be encrypted in the database.
- (f) There shall be an alerting mechanism for any sensitive data change / user creation.
- (g) Multiple copies of sensitive data shall be kept with change log (like user / location / PIP / date and time).
- (h) There shall be a specified 'Approval' protocol for any change in data categorized as 'Sensitive' with appropriate record in database/ framework.
- (i) Business teams shall provide Security requirements during the 'planning phase'. As and when a new project is launched or the architecture is being conceived, designed, planned, the Security shall be a part of the development process.
- (j) Developers shall regularly review and audit their code for security. Report be submitted to concerned Appraiser.
- (k) Each team shall have a 'Quality Assessor' who will check the quality and security of the development done before staging and production deployments.
- (l) All Program Coordinators shall ensure that the code developed by their team is properly backed up.
- (m) At regular intervals, Business teams shall give requirements to clean up old websites to reduce risk of hacking old code.
- (n) Relevant Checklist for Secure Code Programming in applications specified by the National Informatics Centre (NIC), Government of India (as enclosed and as announced from time to time) be preferably followed. In case any action point is felt to be not implementable, written explanation be given to the Security Group and approval thereto be sought from the Security Group.

C. Deployments:

- (a) Urgent deployments shall be allowed after seeking permission from the concerned Program Head. The respective Program Coordinator shall maintain a record of such urgent deployments and prepare Root Cause Analysis reports to avoid such instances. If the pattern of deployment goes beyond the suggested limits of urgency, concerned Program Leader shall give reasons to the CTO. This excludes automated deployments.
- (b) UAT (User Acceptance Tests) shall be done by the Business Teams before the deployment is done on Production and records of such UAT shall be maintained.
- (c) For projects expecting high user volumes, load testing shall be completed before the deployment is done on Production and reports of the same needs to be shared before deployment.
- (d) For new projects / new client planning and execution documents with a timeline shall be prepared by the business head and shared among related teams well in advance. Important points like data space required and archival of data should be considered and planned.

D. IT Infra Security:

- (a) As soon as someone resigns from IT Infra-IDMP team, the passwords of important servers, applications and databases shall be changed.
- (b) Important passwords shall be stored in a secure central vault, access code for which shall jointly be with the CTO, the MD and CEO.

E. Software Architecture Details:

- (a) Concerned Teams must ensure the maintenance of software architecture diagram and documents with all server details and data flow and should review and update the same after each major deployment in case needed.
- (b) This diagram / documentation shall be stored at a secure central vault as this will be needed to identify the dependencies in case anything is to be shifted to another IDC.
- (c) The architecture shall be reviewed by the Security Group (SG) formed by the CTO before start of the project and/or prior to major architectural change.

F. Human aspects in Security:

- (a) If an employee resigns or is issued notice of termination, full access shall be revoked for concerned employee on expiry of 2 months from date of notice of resignation for technical staff and on expiry of 10 days, for non-technical staff. This would ensure that proper Knowledge Transfer is done.
- (b) If an employee resigns/terminated, all logins present on various portals/ applications shall be disabled for that user.
- (c) Concerned Appraiser shall ensure that the IT Asset (e.g. Laptop) is handed over to IT Infra Team on the last working day of the resigned/terminated employee.
- (d) There shall not be any generic login on any portal / application which is being used for official purpose.
- (e) No Remote session shall be allowed with any client system for data related work.
- (f) User's credentials viz. login, password or sensitive data shall be shared with concerned in a secured manner viz. vide password protected file where password is conveyed on personal/registered mobile number.
- (g) In case of cessation of employment for reasons other than resignation/termination by Company e.g. retirement, above norms to the extent applicable shall be implemented.

II. DESIRABLE NORMS:

A. Software Security:

- (a) All public websites should be on HTTPS protocol.
- (b) Wherever possible, two factor authentication should be implemented.
- (c) Code Source for software versioning should be changed to GIT.
- (d) If required, Sprint tool can be implemented.
- (e) Developers should periodically check for the new versions of the technology used in any

project and patch / upgrade as and when available.

B. Deployments:

- (a) Major deployments should be done once a week / fortnight.
- (b) All Deployments should be automated so that manual intervention is avoided as far as possible.
- (c) It is recommended to shift to Core Studio for quick development and deployments.
- (d) A proper timeline must be planned for deployment and after deployment testing should be done before updating the client.

C. Human Angle in Security:

- (a) Team members should be rotated amongst different teams at least every 2 years.
- (b) Program Coordinators should ensure that there is no dependency on a single employee regarding domain or software development. Each Program should prepare a Competency Matrix to ensure such non-dependency.
- (c) Anonymous reporting of security breach incidents can be done by any employee to ceo@mkcl.org and md@mkcl.org
- (d) Every team member should learn secure coding practices.
- (e) Every quarter, at least one security audit of the whole software framework should be done by one software team member and reports should be kept. The task of security audit should be rotated amongst team members.
- (f) Officers heading Software Teams, should review the security audit report and resolve the issues within 2 months from the date of reporting. In case any issue cannot be resolved in the specified period, it should be reported to the Security Group, CTO, and guidance, advice sought for addressing the areas of concerns.

D. Cloud Services Security:

- (a) Preferably, all the cloud services account should have two factor authentication enabled.
- (b) Ideally cloud services API keys should not be shared with the development team.
- (c) If someone has access to APIs (like SMS), the key/password should be changed immediately after tendering of resignation by concerned officer.
- (d) Follow the Principle of Least Privilege for giving access to cloud services to employees.
- (e) Ideally, use micro-segmentation technique in the cloud to isolate individual workloads.

E. Data and IT Asset (Desktop/Laptop) Privacy norms:

- (a) All Systems/Laptops acquired for employees by the Company are property of the Company.
- (b) Each employee issued with a laptop shall be responsible for the security of that laptop, regardless of whether the laptop is used in the office or at any other location viz. residence, hotel, conference room, car, airport, etc.
- (c) Employees are expected to ensure the security of the data within their laptops. Every personnel shall adhere to the following:
 - (i) Is personally accountable for all network and systems access under his user ID, so shall keep his password secret. Never share it with anyone, not even with family members, friends or IT Infra-DMP staff.
 - (ii) Corporate laptops are provided for official use of employees. As such, should not loan or allow it to be used by others including family and friends.
 - (iii) The breach of company data/code may lead to legal action against the employee.
- (d) In case of BYOD (Bring Your Own Device), the implementation on Anti-virus and Backup Process in the employees System/ Laptop is not Companies responsibility.
- (e) Employees will be personally responsible for storing the data at the location shared by the

Company on a regular basis.

- (f) MKCL reserves all rights to access the data present on the Company's system/laptops provided to the personnel or the personnel's private system/laptops in case of 'Bring your own device' (BYOD) and the same can be accessed whenever required, without any obligation of intimation to the employee.

F. API Security:

- (a) All the Public APIs should be protected with TLS encryption.
- (b) APIs should use some form of authentication, maybe through API key or access authentication.
- (c) If feasible, use Authorization Framework authentication and authorization mechanism.
- (d) Preferably allow access to the APIs only from the restricted applications or list of approved IP addresses.
- (e) Data validation should be used and all incoming data should be validated against permissible inputs.
- (f) All production APIs should be tested for vulnerabilities and different attacks.
- (g) If any API expects to receive a high number of requests, load testing should be done before deploying it on production.

4. Exceptions:

- (a) Any exceptions to be allowed, should be done after written approval of CTO only. The request note should mention the exceptional situation and required duration.

5. Acknowledgements:

- (a) Checklist for Secure Code Programming in applications specified by the National Informatics Centre (NIC), Government of India has been referred to as the Company is a Government of Maharashtra promoted Company and several of its customers are Government Departments, Governmental Agencies, Universities, Educational Institutions etc.
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Checklist for Secure Code Programming in Applications

S.No.	Action Item(s)	Is implemented?		
1	Implement CAPTCHA on all entry-forms in PUBLIC pages. Implement CAPTCHA or account-lockout feature on the login form. [Alpha-numeric CAPTCHA with minimum 6 characters]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
2	Implement proper validations on all input parameters in client and server side (both). [White-listing of characters is preferred over Black-listing]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
3	Use parameterized queries or Stored-procedures to query output from databases, instead of inline SQL queries [Prevention of SQL Injection]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
4	Implement proper Audit/Action Trails in applications	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
5	Use different Pre and Post authentication session-values/Authentication-cookies	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
6	Implement proper Access matrix (Access Control List-ACL) to prevent un-authorized access to resources/pages/forms in website [Prevention of Privilege escalation and restrict in of access to authorized/authenticated content]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
7	Donotreferencecomponents(suchasjavascripts,stylesheetsetc.) directly third-party sites. [They may be downloaded and self-referenced in website]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
8	Use third-Party components from trusted source only. [Componentswithknownvulnerabilitiesarenot recommended.]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
9	Store critical data such as PAN number, Mobile Number, Aadhar Card number etc. in encrypted form in the database. [Hashing of sensitive information is preferred over encryption, unless required to be decrypted]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
10	Preventcriticalinformationfrompublicaccessbyanymean [Criticalinformationlikecreditcardnumber,accountnumber, aadhar number etc. should be restricted to authorized persons only. If such information is stored in static files such as excel,pdf etc., sufficient measures should be taken so that is it not accessible to unauthorized persons or in public.]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
11	Hash the password before it is relayed over network, or is stored in database. [During login, password should be salt-hashed using SHA-256/512. However, it should be stored as plain hash (SHA-256/512) in database. Oneveryloginattempt,newsaltshouldbeused,andit should be generated from server-side only]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
12	ImplementChangePasswordandForgotpasswordmodulein applications [not required in applications, using LDAP for authentication]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
13	Comply with Password Policy, wherever passwords are being used.	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐

14	Use Post methods to pass parameters as values from one-page/website to another. [GET methods should be avoided]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
15	Implement proper error-handling. [System/application errors should not be displayed to viewer]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
16	Implement token-based system that changes on every web-request in application, to prevent CSRF. [CSRF Guard or Anti-forgery tokens can be implemented in non-critical applications. Websites using payment-gateways etc. are categorized in critical websites.]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
17	Do not implement File upload in public modules	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
18	Store uploaded files in database, rather than storing them in file-system [Files, stored in database cannot be executed directly, hence this is more secure than storing them in file system.]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
19	Generate unique, un-predictable and non-sequential receipt numbers/acknowledgement numbers/application numbers/roll numbers/ File-names etc. It is preferable that strong algorithm be used to generate such numbers.	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
20	Implement proper Session Timeout [Logged-In user should be logged-out after a specific period (say 20 minutes) of inactivity]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐
21	Assure admin/Super-Admin URL's is/are accessible from restricted IP's only [For this, segregate public URL from Admin/Super-Admin module. Public modules and Admin/Super-Admin modules should be deployed on separate URL's. Admin/Super-Admin URL's should be accessible from restricted IP's only. It is preferable to allow access for Admin/Super-Admin modules through VPN]	YES ☐	NO ☐	Not Applicable ☐

Other Action Item(s)		
1	Assure third-Party links/page(partial/full) open in different tab, with a disclaimer.	YES ☐ NO ☐ Not Applicable ☐
2	Disable Trace/PUT/DELETE and other non-required methods in application/web-server.	YES ☐ NO ☐ Not Applicable ☐
3	Assure that Email addresses, where ever used, are in form of an image. [Alternatively, replace “@” with [at] and “.” with [dot] in email addresses]	YES ☐ NO ☐ Not Applicable ☐
4	Disable directory listing	YES ☐ NO ☐ Not Applicable ☐
5	Set “Auto Complete” off for textboxes in forms	YES ☐ NO ☐ Not Applicable ☐
6	Prevent pages from being stored in history/cache. [Each time that the user tries to fetch a page, it should request server to serve with a fresh copy of the page]	YES ☐ NO ☐ Not Applicable ☐
7	Implement Logout buttons in all authenticated pages	YES ☐ NO ☐ Not Applicable ☐
Implementation Guidelines		
1	Restrict each application for minimum access (only required access) [Allow access of application for restricted network access. Websites, those are to be used in local-network, should not be accessible from any other network. For exceptional cases, VPN may be used. Websites, those are required to be accessed from within the country, should be restricted for access on Indian ISP's ONLY .]	YES ☐ NO ☐ Not Applicable ☐
2	Use the latest and non-vulnerable versions of Application Server (IIS/Apache etc.), JQuery etc.	YES ☐ NO ☐ Not Applicable ☐
3	Enable audit-trails and system logs on server [e.g. :Web-Access logs, Application Logs, Security Logs etc.	YES ☐ NO ☐ Not Applicable ☐
4	Take regular backups of data and application [Sufficient arrangements should be made to take proper and regular backups of database, application and other related objects/components, for retrieval on undesirable circumstances. It is preferable to maintain a set of last 5 backups. It is advised to store backups on hard-drive/tape-disks/SAN-storage. Networked servers/machines should be avoided for this activity]	YES ☐ NO ☐ Not Applicable ☐

L. Environment Protection Policy

Policy:	Environment Protection Policy
Date of issue:	March 11, 2019
Effective Date:	April 01, 2019
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.0

1. Objective:

The Company acknowledges a responsibility to the environment, and we express our commitment towards implementing practices which will promote environmental sustainability. We recognize that our business activities have varying direct and indirect impacts on the environment. We commit to integrate environmental protection into the Company's business philosophy, believing that sound practice and performance in this area can help mitigate environmental risks while contributing to a sustainable future.

2. Principles:

This policy relates to how all operations in our company will be continually reviewed and improved, so that we will truly be able to integrate environmental and social considerations into our everyday practices. The Company shall-

- (a) Ensure compliance with applicable legislations and regulations concerning environment protection.
- (b) Promote environmental awareness throughout all operations of the Company.
- (c) Raise awareness amongst the employees and in the society about the environment.
- (d) Regularly review its business practices and determine whether each practice is suitable in an environmental context.
- (e) Strive to better understand both the direct and indirect impact that our practices may have on the environment.
- (f) Work towards the conservation of energy, water and other natural resources in all its operations.
- (g) Improve its working environment by gradual greening of business processes and services, or purchased technologies, and active protection of the environment and its components.
- (h) Develop, use new technologies, focus on devices with maximum energy efficiency and assess potential impact of these facilities on the environment.
- (i) Lessen environmental impact by preferably purchasing environment-friendly products

and services.

- (j) Promote waste reduction and environmental preservation activities to help mitigate and adapt to climate change.
 - (k) Dispose-off waste and scrap thoughtfully and develop an attitude of "reducing consumption of natural resources, recycling and reusing."
 - (l) Ensure continuous safe handling of waste at points of waste collection and management.
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2. WELFARE

A. Women Welfare Policy

Policy:	Women Welfare Policy
Sub-policy:	Half Day Work from Home/at Office Policy for women
Date of issue:	April 16, 2018
Effective Date:	April 01, 2018
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.2

1. Objectives:

The National Policy for Women Empowerment (2001) stated that the goal is to bring about the advancement, development and empowerment of women. Specifically, one of the objective of this Policy is 'Creating an environment through positive economic and social policies for full development of women to enable them to realize their full potential'. Further, The Maternity Benefit (Amendment Act), 2017 introduced a new welfare measure of allowing the women employee to work from home at the discretion of the employer.

Way back in the year 2011, MKCL felt that there are situations peculiar to a woman, which may adversely affect her professional career. A woman employee upon attaining the motherhood has to attend to her young child and nurture it for its wholesome development. It is desirable that she pays proper personal attention to the child and dedicates quality time with the child in the first few years after its birth.

The priorities of her full-time role and responsibilities at the workplace, however, may prevent her from properly fulfilling her responsibilities towards the child, if she resumes the duty immediately after the expiry of the maternity leave in absence of a dependable assistance in childcare either at home or elsewhere.

Therefore, MKCL as an employer, is offering some facilitation to such a woman employee during this period of profound change in her life and in the life of her baby so that she can balance her work and career progression on one hand and childcare and its wholesome development on the other simultaneously.

In this context, 'Half Day Work from Home/at Office Policy' is for such women employees so as to enable them to nurture their child while pursuing their professional career with MKCL. This policy may not be able to fully address all the peculiar situations faced by a working woman but attempts to create a more supportive ecosystem for her.

Further, it is expected that as MKCL provides a supportive ecosystem, so should the family of the new mother provide her a supportive, compassionate and caring ecosystem viz. sharing household chores, rendering childcare support, emotional support, etc. The goal is to create a supportive environment where the working new mother can thrive in both her work and family life.

2. Applicability:

- (a) A woman employee working as Member Staff and who has completed at least one year of uninterrupted service in the Company and who is desirous of using this facility for her first or second child is only eligible to apply for this scheme.
- (b) Those employees satisfying the above mentioned criteria and are working full time or are on leave without pay may also avail this facility.

3. Approval:

- (a) The woman employee desirous of availing this Policy shall apply to Human Resource Development (HRD) with a cc to her Appraiser specifying choice from the below mentioned options in clause 4.0 and the period for which she desires to avail this facility. She should clearly explain in detail what portion of her work can be justifiably performed from home without the loss of quality and without cost or time overrun.
- (b) HRD shall verify the eligibility of her candidature after the proper scrutiny of records and forward the comments to the Managing Director (MD) with a cc to the Appraiser and concerned Program Leader/Head.
- (c) The concerned Appraiser shall in consultation with concerned Program Leader/Head draft his/her recommendations based on his/her assessment of suitability of the applicant's work profile for work for half day from home or at office and forward them to the MD with a cc to HRD and the Program Leader/Head.
- (d) MD shall, upon the consideration of the recommendations of the Appraiser and comments of the HRD, may accord his/her approval to the application for full or part of the period applied.
- (e) HRD shall communicate MD's decision to the applicant, her appraiser and the Program Leader/Head.
- (f) The MD reserves the discretion not to accord approval or curtail the earlier approval of an application in view of organizational exigencies.
- (g) HRD will ensure that the whole process of approval does not exceed 10 working days from the date of receipt of the application by the woman employee.

4. Policy and Norms:

- (a) During pregnancy and upon the birth of the child, the woman employee is entitled to Maternity Leave as per the Maternity Leave Policy of the Company. Upon exhaustion of her Maternity Leave, she has to either choose to rejoin the duty on full time basis at the workplace after making suitable arrangement of childcare at home or elsewhere or has to proceed on leave without pay, subject to approval, for not exceeding till the child turns three years.
- (b) While both these options are still available to her, under this Policy, such Employee may work for half day either from home or at office based on her suitability as follows:

A	B	D	E
Option No.	Child's Age*	Work for Half Day** from Home	Work for Half Day** at Office
1	0-1 year	Not Permitted	Permitted
2	1-2 years	Permitted	Not Permitted
3	1-2 years	Not Permitted	Permitted
4	2-3 years	Permitted	Not Permitted
5	2-3 years	Not Permitted	Permitted

* Child's Age shall be computed w.e.f. the first date of the month succeeding the month in which the child is born. Example: If the DoB is 15.11.2017, it will be taken as 01.12.2017 for this scheme.

** Work for Half Day means:

- Uninterrupted work and accessibility for either of the two slots: 09.00 a.m. to 01.00 p.m. with a morning tea break from 10.55 a.m. to 11.15 a.m. or 02.00 p.m. to 06.00 p.m. with afternoon tea break from 03.55 p.m. to 04.15 p.m. on all working days either at home or at office.

5. Exclusions:

- (a) This Policy cannot be availed during the period of pregnancy in order to avoid risks and uncertainties. The pregnant employees may work full-time till such time as advised by their physician. During that period, if circumstances on medical grounds so demand, they may avail of various types of leaves as are permissible to any employee or proceed on Maternity Leave as per the norms of the Maternity Leave Policy.
- (b) This Policy also cannot be availed by those who do not want to work on all working days.
- (c) This Policy also cannot be availed by those who want to work on all working days but for less than half day or on all working days but for a half day slot not matching with any one of those mentioned above.
- (d) This scheme does not permit a woman employee to work for full time with half day from home and remaining half day at office as it contradicts the very purpose of the scheme.

A woman employee availing this scheme if engages in any other employment/business for consideration (in cash/kind) directly/indirectly on her own/with any other person (including relative), then it will amount to breach of Code of Conduct Policy and appropriate disciplinary actions will be taken on her, including termination from services of the Company.

- (e) This Policy cannot be availed after the child attains the age of three years. The woman employee shall resume full time work after that.

6. Terms and Conditions of Service:

1. Choice of Option:

- (a) An option once chosen from the above-mentioned Table in clause 4.0 should not be changed till the expiry of the ongoing calendar month.
- (b) The employee is permitted to switch options in consecutive months based on her suitability.
- (c) At least seven days' notice should be given by the concerned woman employee for change of option by an email addressed to HRD with a cc to her Appraiser so that the seating arrangements and other resources in the offices can be optimally utilized.

2. Salary:

- (a) The woman employee shall be entitled to 50% of her current salary and benefits excluding transport allowance for the period she works half day from home or half day at office.
- (b) The transport allowances payable in both cases are mentioned below in pt. no.4.
- (c) The insurance covers shall be same as those applicable to the full-time employee.
- (d) The employee availing the benefits of this scheme has to submit the performance plan of the next month and performance report of the current month before the 25th of each month to her appraiser with a cc to HRD. Upon satisfactory deliverables and the favorable recommendation of the appraiser, the pay of the current month would be released before 10th working day of the next month.
- (e) The appraiser may decide to recommend deduction of certain percentage of pay subject to unsatisfactory performance or inadequate delivery.
- (f) Revision in basic pay shall be considered after the employee resumes full time employment and upon review of overall performance during the entire period of half day work.

3. Infrastructure at Home:

- (a) The personal computer/laptop with MKCL prescribed configuration and peripherals and telephone/mobile phone and broadband Internet access will have to be arranged at home by the employee at her own cost before availing this facility to work from home.
- (b) Requisite laptop, software licenses will be provided by MKCL. However, the employee should first handover her laptop to concerned IT-Infra Member before proceeding on Maternity leave and on re-joining work under this policy, either she or her authorized family member will be re-issued laptop with her data.
- (c) The employee working from home shall be responsible for ensuring the confidentiality and security of Company's laptop, data, information and intellectual property.

4. Transport Allowance:

- (a) The employee working at office for half day shall be entitled to draw 100% of the transport allowance.
- (b) The employee working half day from home shall also be entitled for 100% of the transport allowance so as to compensate for the costs incurred by the employee on space, infrastructure and computing infrastructure created and maintained by her at her home including electricity and telephone/mobile phone bills and Internet bandwidth charges. No separate telephone/mobile phone bills and Internet bandwidth charges can be claimed under 'Mobile Phone and Internet Charges Reimbursement Policy'.

5. Leave Credits:

- (a) The employee working for half day from home shall be entitled for 4 Casual Leave (CL), 4 Sick Leave (SL) credits on prorata basis for each calendar year but no Earned Leave (EL) for that period.

- (b) The employee working for half day at office shall be entitled for CL, SL as mentioned above and also for 50% of EL credits for that period.

6. Appraisals, ratings, increments and promotions:

- (a) The appraisals, ratings, increments and promotions in case of half day working shall be as per the Appraisal Policy of the Company.
- (b) In case of the woman employee opting for 'Leave without pay' till the child turns three years, on re-joining, for any promotion and/or increments, the Pay structure level and ratings at the date of proceeding on such leave shall be considered and no weightage shall be given for period during such leave.

7. Notice Period:

- (a) The notice period for resignation/termination as per Separation Policy shall be applicable.

8. Accessibility:

- (a) Employee is required to always remain contactable over phone or chat, etc. during decided working hours and incase is not going to be available for some specific time, she should inform her appraiser in advance regarding such unavailability.
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B. Workplace Health, Safety and Welfare Policy

Policy:	Workplace Health, Safety and Welfare Policy
Date of issue:	October 15, 2019
Effective Date:	October 15, 2019
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objectives:

Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Limited (MKCL) is committed to provide, so far as is reasonably practicable, safe conditions of work and safe workplaces. The Company aims to ensure that workplaces meet the health, safety and welfare needs of its personnel and contractual staff.

Further, the objective of this Policy is also to ensure compliance as an employer of applicable work health and safety legislation/s including the Maharashtra Shops and Establishments (Regulation of Employment and Conditions of Service) Act, 2017 ("the Shop Act") and the Rules framed thereunder, as amended from time to time.

2. Definitions:

Notwithstanding anything stated anywhere in other MKCL's policies, for this policy-

- (a) **"Health"** means physical, mental and social well-being of a person.
- (b) **"Office premises"** means a building or part thereof in possession of the Company on ownership basis or rental basis which is used by it for business purposes.
- (c) **"Workplace"** means office premises which is made available by the Company to its personnel as a place of work.

3. Applicability:

The Workplace Health, Safety and Welfare Policy (**"the Policy"**) applies across all workplaces of the Company and to all persons engaged by the Company as employees, trainees, interns, consultants and contractual staff.

4. Principles:

This policy reflects the Company's utmost importance and commitment to ensuring that health, safety and welfare at workplace. The Company shall-Identify workplace health and safety hazards and will inform as appropriate, of these workplace hazards;

- (a) Assess the risks associated with health and safety hazards in the workplace and stakeholders shall be informed of the health and safety hazards and risks that affect their

work;

- (b) Take action to prevent, reduce or control risks to an acceptable level and reduce the potential for incidents and accidents;
- (c) Demonstrate a continuous commitment to improving health, safety and welfare at workplace;
- (d) Ensure the health, safety and welfare at workplace and will comply with the requirements of applicable health and safety legislations;
- (e) Ensure that:
 - a) adequate resources are provided for health and safety;
 - b) health and safety is adequately assessed, controlled and monitored; and
 - c) all stakeholders are actively involved on matters that affect health and safety;
- (f) Ensure that all stakeholders are adequately instructed and trained on the health and safety issues that affect them, and the safe working practices that should be followed;
- (g) Ensure that Systems are in place and stakeholders can raise health and safety concerns with the Health, Safety and Welfare Committee;
- (h) Report and investigate accidents, incidents and near misses to improve health and safety management. Root Cause Analysis will be carried out and corrective actions will be taken to prevent recurrences;
- (i) Encourage periodical health check-ups to prevent, reduce or control health risks to an acceptable level and to reduce the potential for ill health.

5. Health, Safety and Welfare Guidelines

- (a) The Health, Safety and Welfare Guidelines shall be issued by the Health, Safety and Welfare Committee from time to time.

6. Health, Safety and Welfare Committee

- (a) The Board of Directors shall, pursuant to Maharashtra Shops and Establishments (Regulation of Employment and Conditions of Service) Rules, 2018 as amended from time to time, constitute a Health, Safety and Welfare Committee (**"the HSW Committee"**).
- (b) The HSW Committee shall consist of equal number of Company and Staff Representatives. These representatives shall include -
 - (i) Senior official who by her/his position in the organization can contribute effectively to the function of the HSW Committee and s/he shall be the Chairman.
 - (ii) Program Leaders and/or officers in-charge of functions of the Company.
 - (iii) Staff Representatives.
 - (iv) Sufficient number of representatives of women staff.
- (c) The tenure of Member of the HSW Committee will be three years and s/he can be re-appointed for another tenure up to further three years.
- (d) The duties, functions and responsibilities of the HSW Committee shall be as follows:
 - (i) To survey the work premises and to examine whether there is any accident prone

- spots in the premises or defects or hazardous object or hazards in the premises.
- (ii) To follow and pursue to get such spots, defects, objects or hazards rectified.
 - (iii) To conduct health care or wellness camps once in a year in the Company.
 - (iv) To create awareness about any contagious disease or epidemics or any natural calamities or any calamities due to accident, fire, etc.
 - (v) To conduct recreation, cultural, sports activities annually.
 - (vi) To conduct social and educational awareness programmes like Swaccha Bharat Abhiyan, Tree Plantation, Family Welfare, Beti Bachao-Beti Padhao, etc.
 - (vii) It shall be the duty and responsibility of the HSW Committee to organize above events with due care and diligence.
- (e) The HSW Committee shall meet at least once every quarter and review the health, safety and welfare measures in accordance to this policy. The meeting of the HSW Committee shall be convened by the Chairman as and when required and that a formal prior notice of at least 7 days of the said meeting shall be necessary. The Chairman may invite other officers, persons, if s/he feels necessary. The quorum for a HSW Committee meeting shall be one third of its total strength or three Members, whichever is higher, and the participation of the Members by video conferencing or by other audio visual means shall also be counted for the purposes of quorum. The Chairman shall record and maintain duly signed minutes of the meetings and various documents, records concerning the said Committee Meetings.

Explanation—For the purposes of this sub-clause 5—

- (i) any fraction of a number shall be rounded off as one;
 - (ii) “total strength” shall not include members whose places are vacant.
-

Policy:	Sports Policy
Date of issue:	June 28, 2024
Effective Date:	July 01, 2024
Last revision Date:	-----
Effective date of revision:	-----
Version no.:	1.0

1. Objective:

The Company recognizes the importance of sports in promoting physical fitness and fostering teamwork and in furtherance of promoting a culture of physical fitness and encouraging sportsmanship within.

2. Eligibility:

All employees, consultants, interns (for internship exceeding one year), fellows (for fellowship exceeding one year), contractual staff for house-keeping, electrical maintenance, transport are eligible to participate. The participation in all events shall be at the own responsibility of the participants and each person shall ensure his/her own health fitness prior to participation.

3. MKCL's Sports Committee (MSC):

The Managing Director will constitute Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Limited (MKCL), MKCL's Sports Committee (MSC) and re-constitute the same from time to time as required. The MSC shall have Chairman and Member-Secretary. The term of each Member will be for a period of three (3) years from the date of appointment or further change by the Managing Director, whichever is earlier.

The meeting of the MSC be convened by the Chairman and/or the Member-Secretary of the MSC as and when required and that a formal notice of the meeting shall not be necessary. The quorum for the meeting of the said Committee shall be any three members and members may participate in the meeting through electronic mode. The Member-Secretary shall be responsible for recording minutes of the meeting and maintaining finalized duly signed minutes of the meetings and various documents, records concerning the said Committee meetings. The Member-Secretary shall also take actions on decisions taken in the meetings.

The scope of MSC will be as follows –

- Prepare annual budgets, revise, if necessary, seek requisite recommendations and approvals.
- Purchase requisite sports equipment, submit necessary claims, with supporting documents in accordance with approved Budget.
- Facilitate access to sporting facilities and equipment within the Company.
- Organize company-wide sporting events such as tournaments, leagues, fitness challenges, etc.
- Make necessary bookings and arrangements for outdoor sport events.
- Encourage employees' participation in various sports and fitness activities.

- (g) Maintain sports equipment, facilities, and ensure their proper upkeep, maintenance and custody.
- (h) Coordinate, schedule and manage sports events without disrupting regular work routines.
- (i) Uphold fair play, sportsmanship, and inclusivity among participants in all sports events and activities.
- (j) Encourage and recognize employee achievements in sports.
- (k) Undertake all requisite incidental and ancillary actions.

The MSC, if required can seek support from Center Managers for conducting the events.

MKCL's personnel shall extend their full cooperation, support to the MSC in its endeavors to promote a healthy and active work environment and participate enthusiastically.

D. Aid in case of Total Permanent Disability (TPD) while in services of the Company Policy

Policy:	Aid on Compassionate Grounds Policy
Sub-policy:	Aid in case of Total Permanent Disability (TPD) while in the services of the Company
Date of issue:	November 19, 2018
Effective Date:	November 19, 2018
Last revision Date:	March 06, 2025
Effective date of revision:	April 01, 2025
Version no.:	1.2

1. Objective:

The objective of this Policy is to render aid on compassionate grounds to an employee who suffers Total Permanent Disability (TPD) while in the services of the Company. An employee will be considered 'totally and permanently disabled', if the concerned employee has become completely disabled due to accidental bodily injury, adverse sickness (physical or mental condition) or fatal disease and is incapacitated for all work in his/her own or any occupation for which he/she is suited by training, education, or experience. TPD means that an individual will never be able to work again due to sickness or injury.

2. Applicability:

- (a) This policy is applicable to an Employee whose staff type is 'Member' under any category and who is not serving under notice period of resignation/termination. This policy is also applicable in case such Employee has been sent on deputation to other organization by the Company and is currently serving there on deputation.

3. Norms for aid in case an employee suffers Total Permanent Disability (TPD) while in the services of the Company:

- (a) In case an employee suffers TPD while in service of the Company, to avail the aid under this policy, requisite medical certificate specifying the disability as 'total permanent', requisite medical reports, an application in Form E as specified in Annexure I by the affected employee for receiving the aid and other documents as required by the Company shall be submitted by the employee within three months from the date of the medical certificate specifying the disability as 'total permanent'. In case the employee is incapacitated due to physical/mental condition (including on life support/in a coma) and cannot sign on the application Form E, then such employee can use his/her thumbprint. If s/he can't give a thumb impression, then can use a mark (it can be a toe impression or a mark which anybody can put on behalf of the employee who has to sign). There must be a physical contact between the employee who is to sign and the thumb impression/mark put on the Form E. In both cases, the thumbprint or the mark should be identified by two independent witnesses, one of whom should be member of the Company's Key Management Team.
- (b) On verification of submitted documents, the employee suffering from TPD, shall cease to be in employment of the Company and financial aid of Rs.18,000/- per month will be provided to the affected employee (hereinafter referred as "Beneficiary ex-employee")

from the month following his/her such cessation. The said amount of Rs.18,000/- will be reconsidered by the Board in case of revision of basic pay scales specified in the “MKCL’s Remuneration Policy for its employees”.

- (c) Each year, in case the Company pays Annual Special Allowance (ASA) to its employees, it shall be also paid to the Beneficiary ex-employee and the ASA in this case will be calculated considering Rs.18,000/- per month (or revised amount as mentioned above) as the basic pay, irrespective of the pay tables applicable to the employees from time to time.
- (d) The aforesaid aid will be provided till the age of retirement of the Beneficiary ex-employee had he/she been in the services of the Company.
- (e) Further, in case the Company pays ASA and/or Organizational Performance Linked Award (OPLA) to its employees, it will make one-time payment of ASA and/or OPLA (as applicable) to the Beneficiary ex-employee for the period of services rendered by the Beneficiary ex-employee in the previous financial year, which the Beneficiary ex-employee would have been eligible to receive had he/she been in the services of the Company.
- (f) The financial aid amount/s will be paid directly in the Bank Account of the Beneficiary ex-employee. Every year, in the month of April, the employee (or his/her family member) shall submit to the Company ‘Existence Certificate’ in the form F as specified in Annexure ‘II’ to this Policy. In case such certificate is not received, the Company will put on hold any further payments.

In case, the requisite ‘Existence Certificate’ is not received /any intimation of demise of the Beneficiary ex-employee is not received till the month end of June in any year, then the Financial Aid under this Policy shall cease and no longer be paid/be payable by the Company.

- (g) The Beneficiary ex-employee can inform the Company anytime to discontinue the financial aid under this policy and on such discontinuation, the aid cannot be requested to be re-started.
 - (h) In case of death of such Beneficiary ex-employee, prior to attainment of age of retirement as per Company norms, provisions of the policy ‘Aid in case of demise of employee while in services of the Company’ shall become applicable to the extent relevant and apply as if the Beneficiary ex-employee has died while in the services of the Company.
 - (i) Aid under this policy is not a vested right which can be exercised any time by the Beneficiary ex-employee, as the purpose behind such an aid is to provide immediate relief to the Beneficiary ex-employee.
 - (j) Notwithstanding anything stated above, since the aid under this policy is under compassionate grounds, any amount will be paid subject to availability of sufficient free funds with the Company and giving of such aid is not mandatorily binding on the Company.
 - (k) No employment on compassionate grounds will be given to any family member/s of the Beneficiary ex-employee in the Company.
-

Annexure I

Form E - APPLICATION FOR AVAILING BENEFIT UNDER 'AID ON COMPASSIONATE GROUNDS POLICY'

To,

**Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Ltd. (MKCL) ICC Trade Tower, 'A' Wing, 5th Floor,
Senapati Bapat Road, Shivajinagar, Pune 411 016**

I, Mr./Ms. _____ (full name)
having employee code _____, PAN _____, Aadhaar _____
_____ am suffering from Total Permanent Disability (TPD) as medically
certified and request to be relieved from the services of the Company. I hereby apply for availing
benefit under 'Aid in case of Total Permanent Disability' Policy of MKCL. My contact details and
Bank Account details are as below –

1. Permanent residential/communication address : _____

_____ City : _____ Pin : _____ State : _____

2. email id : _____ 3. cell no. : _____ 4. Aadhaar No. _____

4. Bank A/c details in which I would like to receive the Aid amount under aforesaid policy -

a) Name of Account holder: _____

b) Bank Name : _____

c) Branch Name: _____

Branch Address: _____

d) IFSC Code: _____

e) Account type (Savings/Current) : _____

f) Account No. as appearing on the cheque book : _____

Please find attached below documents –

1. One cancelled cheque of above Bank Account
2. Self- Attested Copy of PAN card
3. Self-attested copy of Passport / Aadhaar Card
4. Original medical certificate specifying the disability as 'total permanent' with notarized certified true copy.
5. Original medical reports with notarized certified true copies.

Place :

Date :

(Name & Signature of applicant employee)*

****In case the employee is incapacitated and cannot sign, then thumb impression/mark identified by two independent witnesses be put, one of whom should be member of the Company's Key Management Team.***

Annexure II

Form F - EXISTENCE CERTIFICATE

To,
Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Ltd. (MKCL) ICC Trade Tower, 'A' Wing, 5th Floor,
Senapati Bapat Road, Shivajinagar, Pune 411 016

This Certificate of existence is being submitted for availing/continue to avail benefit under the
'Aid in case of Total Permanent Disability' Policy of MKCL.

Full name of Beneficiary ex-employee : _____
Ex-employee code _____

This is to certify that Mr./Mrs. _____
(full name)

having PAN _____ Aadhaar no. _____ whose specimen
signature/thumb impression/mark is given below, is alive today, the _____ day of
_____.

(Signature/thumb impression/mark of beneficiary ex-employee)

Certified by :

Signature : _____

Name : _____

Address & Seal : _____

P.S. This Certificate has to be completed and signed by a Registered Medical Practitioner with name, Registration No. and seal or the Beneficiary ex-employee's Bank Manager with name and Bank Seal.

E. Aid on Compassionate Grounds Policy

Policy :	Aid on Compassionate Grounds Policy
Sub-Policy:	Aid in case of demise of an employee while in services of the Company
Date of issue:	June 20, 2013
Effective Date:	June 20, 2013
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

The objective of this Policy is to render aid on compassionate grounds to eligible and fully dependent family member/s of an employee of the Company, who has died while in services of the Company.

2. Applicability:

1. This policy can be availed by eligible and fully dependent family member/s of a deceased Employee who was under staff type 'Member' under any category and who was not serving under notice period of resignation/termination. This policy is also applicable in case of such Employee who was sent on deputation to other organization by the Company and was currently serving there on deputation.

3. Definitions :

1. **Family** - Notwithstanding anything stated anywhere in other MKCL's policies, for this policy, 'family' in relation to an employee, shall be deemed to consist of his/her spouse, legitimate children (including stepchildren, legally adopted children), mother, father (including step mother, step father).
1. **'Fully dependent family member' or 'fully dependent beneficiary'** – For this policy, a 'fully dependent family member' or 'fully dependent beneficiary' means a member of an employee's family who is sustained by the employee and is specified latest by him/her in a duly filled in and signed Form A as submitted to the Company as the potential beneficiary for receipt of aid under this policy in case of his/her demise.

4. Norms for aid in case of demise while in the services of the Company:

- (a) Every employee, shall submit a duly filled in and signed declaration in Form A (*as specified in Annexure I*) to the Company, specifying the details of the fully dependent family member/s who in case of the demise of the employee will be the beneficiary/ies for receipt of aid under this Policy. In case, the nominated potential fully dependent beneficiary is a minor i.e. below 18 years of age, then details of the adult guardian be provided by the employee. An employee can nominate maximum three potential fully dependent beneficiaries. The employee can change the nomination/s anytime by submitting a revised

declaration in Form A to the Company. A duly filled in and signed Form A shall be submitted by the Employee to the Company in April every year. In case, in any year/s, Form A is not received by the Company from any employee, then in case of demise of such employee, the Form A which is dated last as per records of the Company, shall be considered valid.

- (b) To avail aid under this policy, a notarized certified true copy of Death Certificate, an application in Form B as specified in Annexure II by the nominated potential fully dependent beneficiary/ies for receiving the aid and any other documents as required by the Company shall be submitted within three months from the date of demise of the employee.
- (c) The total aid provided by the Company to fully dependent beneficiary/ies will be Rs.18,000/- per month in the proportion specified in Form A. The said amount of Rs. 18,000/- will be reconsidered by the Board in case of revision of basic pay scales specified in the “MKCL’s Remuneration Policy for its employees”.
- (d) Each year, in case the Company pays Annual Special Allowance (ASA) to its employees, it shall be also paid to the fully dependent beneficiary/ies in the proportion specified in Form A and the ASA in this case will be calculated considering Rs.18,000/- per month (or revised amount as mentioned above) as the notional basic pay, irrespective of the pay tables applicable to the employees from time to time.
- (e) Also, additionally, in case the Key Management Team (KMT) feels appropriate, it may disburse a one-time lumpsum amount not exceeding Rs.2.50 Lacs to the fully dependent beneficiary/ies in the proportion specified in Form A. This amount of Rs.2.5 lacs may be cumulatively revised every year on October 01 as per the ASA rate made applicable from time to time and decided by the KMT.
- (f) In case of demise of the sole beneficiary/all beneficiaries, the Aid under this Policy shall cease. In case of demise of any of the fully dependent beneficiaries, the amount of aid which was being paid to such beneficiary, shall be re-allocated equally to the surviving beneficiary/ies.
- (g) In case the sole beneficiary/any beneficiary ceases to be fully dependent (e.g. incase of remarriage/marriage, getting employment), then aid under this policy shall be discontinued to such a beneficiary and shall not be reallocated to other dependent beneficiaries, if any.
- (h) The aforesaid aid will be provided till the age of retirement of the employee had he/she been alive or till the fully dependent sole beneficiary/all fully dependent beneficiaries cease to be ‘fully dependent/s’ or till the demise of the sole fully dependent beneficiary/all fully dependent beneficiaries, whichever is earlier.
- (i) Further, in case the Company pays ASA and/or Organizational Performance Linked Award (OPLA) to its employees, it will make one-time payment of ASA and/or OPLA (as applicable) to the fully dependent beneficiary/ies in the proportion specified in Form A for the period of services rendered by the employee in the previous financial year, which the deceased employee would have been eligible to receive had he/she been alive.
- (j) The financial aid amount/s will be paid directly in the Bank Account of the fully dependent beneficiary/ies.

- (k) Every year, in the month of April, the fully dependent beneficiary/ies (surviving fully dependent beneficiary) shall submit to the Company 'Existence Certificate' in Form C as specified in Annexure III to this Policy. In case such certificate/s is/are not received; the Company will put on hold any further payments regarding the concerned fully dependent beneficiary/ies. In case, the requisite 'Existence Certificate' is not received till the month end of June in any year, then the Financial Aid under this Policy shall cease and no longer be paid/be payable by the Company to such fully dependent beneficiary/ies.
 - (l) Every year, in the month of April, the fully dependent beneficiary/ies (surviving fully dependent beneficiary) shall submit to the Company 'Dependent Declaration' in Form D as specified in Annexure IV to this Policy. In case such declaration/s is/are not received; the Company will put on hold any further payments regarding the concerned fully dependent beneficiary/ies. In case, the requisite 'Dependent Declaration' is not received till the month end of June in any year, then the Financial Aid under this Policy shall cease and no longer be paid/be payable by the Company to such fully dependent beneficiary/ies.
 - (m) The fully dependent beneficiary/ies can inform the Company anytime to discontinue the financial aid under this policy and on such discontinuation, the aid cannot be requested to be re-started.
 - (n) The fully dependent beneficiary/ies may undertake any of MKCL's educational courses, course fees of which will be borne by MKCL for a maximum period of one year. This benefit can be availed within a period of 2 years of the death of the employee.
 - (o) No person, who has not been specified in Form A as fully dependent family member by the employee, can claim any benefit under this Policy as legal heir or for any other reason whatsoever.
 - (p) Aid under this policy is not a vested right which can be exercised any time by the fully dependent beneficiary/ies, as the purpose behind such an aid is to provide immediate relief to the family of the deceased employee.
 - (q) Notwithstanding anything stated above, since the aid under this policy is under compassionate grounds, any amount will be paid subject to availability of sufficient free funds with the Company and giving of such aid is not mandatorily binding on the Company.
 - (r) No employment on compassionate grounds will be given to any family member/s of the demised employee in the Company.
-

Annexure I
Form A - DECLARATION

Nomination of fully dependent Beneficiary for 'Aid on Compassionate Grounds Policy'

To,
Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Ltd. ICC Trade Tower, 'A' Wing, 5th Floor,
Senapati Bapat Road, Shivajinagar, Pune 411 016

I, Mr./Ms. _____ (full name)
having employee code _____, permanent residential address at _____

having PAN _____, hereby nominate the person(s) mentioned below to receive aid as fully dependent beneficiary/ies under the Aid on Compassionate Grounds Policy, in case of my demise while in service of the Company. Nomination made herein automatically invalidates my previous nomination/s -

Name in full with full address of nominated fully dependent potential beneficiary/ies and PAN, Aadhaar no. details	Relationship of nominated fully dependent potential beneficiary with employee	Age of nominated fully dependent potential beneficiary in years	Details (i.e. full name, relationship with employee, full address) of guardian, in case nominated fully dependent beneficiary is a minor	Proportion by which the Aid will be shared in case of more than one nominee.
1.				
2.				
3.				

Place: Date:

(Name & Signature of employee)

Annexure II

Form B - APPLICATION FOR AVAILING BENEFIT UNDER 'AID ON COMPASSIONATE GROUNDS POLICY'

**Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Ltd. (MKCL) ICC Trade Tower, 'A'
Wing, 5th Floor,
Senapati Bapat Road, Shivajinagar, Pune 411 016**

Photo of the
applicant with
cross signature
i.e. half on paper
& half on
photograph

I, Mr./Ms./Mst. _____ (full name)
having PAN _____, Aadhaar _____ being _____ (relationship with
employee) of _____ (full name of demised employee)
having employee code _____, hereby declare that I was fully dependent on
_____ and hereby apply for availing benefit under 'Aid in case of demise of
employee while in services of the Company' Policy of MKCL. My contact details and Bank Account details
are as below –

1. _____ Permanent
t residential/communication address: _____

_____ City: _____ Pin: _____ State: _____

2. _____ email id: _____
3. cell no.: _____

3. Bank A/c details in which I would like to receive the Aid amount under aforesaid policy -

- a) Name of Account holder: _____
- b) Bank Name: _____
- c) Branch Name: _____
Branch Address: _____
- d) IFSC Code: _____
- e) Account type (Savings/Current): _____
- f) Account No. as appearing on the cheque book: _____

Please find attached below documents –

- 1. One cancelled cheque of above Bank Account
- 2. Self- attested Copy of PAN card
- 3. Self-attested copy of Passport / Aadhaar Card
- 4. Notarized certified true copy of death certificate of demised employee

I also undertake that (a) I shall inform the Company in case I cease to be a 'dependent' (b) I shall submit to the Company an 'Existence Certificate' in Form C and 'Dependent Declaration' in Form D every year in the month of April.

Place:

Date:

(Name & Signature of applicant nominated fully dependent beneficiary)

Annexure III

Form C - EXISTENCE CERTIFICATE

To,
Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Ltd. (MKCL) ICC Trade Tower, 'A' Wing, 5th Floor,
Senapati Bapat Road, Shivajinagar, Pune 411 016

This Certificate of existence is being submitted for availing/continue to avail benefit as 'fully dependent beneficiary' under the 'Aid in case of demise of employee while in services of the Company' Policy of MKCL.

Full name of demised employee: _____
Relation with demised employee : _____

This is to certify that Mr./Mrs./Mst./Miss

(full name)

having PAN _____ Aadhaar no. _____ whose specimen
signature/thumb impression is given below, is alive today, the _____ day of _____.

(Signature/thumb impression of beneficiary)

Certified by:

Signature: _____
Name: _____

Address & Seal: _____

P.S. This Certificate has to be completed and signed by a Registered Medical Practitioner with Registration No. or the Beneficiary's Bank Manager with Seal.

Annexure IV

Form D – DEPENDENT DECLARATION

To,
**Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Ltd. (MKCL) ICC Trade Tower, 'A' Wing, 5th Floor,
Senapati Bapat Road, Shivajinagar, Pune 411 016**

I _____ [full name] of _____

_____ [full address]

related to _____ (full name of demised employee)
as _____ (relation) do solemnly and sincerely affirm that I am a 'fully dependent
beneficiary' and eligible to receive aid under the 'Aid in case of demise of employee while in
services of the Company' Policy of MKCL. I hereby further declare and affirm that I am dependent
on the aid provided by MKCL under the said policy for my sustenance. I also, affirm that I shall
inform the Company immediately in case I cease to be 'Dependent'.

Place:

Date:

(Name & Signature of nominated dependent beneficiary)

3. RECRUITMENT

A. Policy for Recruitment & Selection Process

Policy:	Policy for Recruitment & Selection Process
Date of Issue:	June 28, 2024
Effective Date:	July 01, 2024
Last revision Date:	----
Effective Date of revision:	---
Version no.	1.0

1. Objectives:

Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Limited's (MKCL) employment philosophy is enshrined in its 'Human Rights Policy'. Further, MKCL values commitment, contribution, provides space for creative thinking, creates leaders and recognizes and rewards results. MKCL is dedicated to the cause of bridging the Knowledge Divide and thereby bridging the Development Opportunity Divide faced by the common people in general and youth and school students in particular. MKCL's agenda is, therefore, focused on creating knowledge-based and value-based paradigm of Transformations in Education, Development, Governance, and Empowerment **(Transformative EDGE)** of common people leading to creation of individual and social wealth and ensuring individual and social welfare. Thus 'Creating A Knowledge Lit World' is at the core of being a MKCL Team Member.

MKCL understands the critical role its employees play in its journey for accomplishment of its goals and therefore has a process of recruitment that hires individuals solely on the basis of his/her merit, competencies and suitability. All appointments, whether from internal or external sources, are made on the basis of position availability/vacancies, individual suitability and merit. The recruitment process is designed to ensure that every applicant is treated equally with dignity and respect. The selection process is transparent, and merit based, with weightage given to factors that suit organizational needs.

2. Manpower Requirement:

- (a) Program Leaders/ Senior General Managers may submit the manpower requirement for their concerned Program to Human Resource Development ("HRD"). Please refer *Annexure A 'Requisition for Manpower' (RFM)* for format to kmt@mkcl.org. KMT will consider the same and finalize the approximate manpower requirement.
- (b) The MD/KMT may, considering business exigency and organizational requirement, directly initiate recruitment as felt appropriate from time to time.

3. Internal Recruitment:

- (a) In case new vacancy or replacement vacancy is created at any level, the KMT shall first review the internal resources with required skill sets and if found suitable, give appropriate recommendations to the Managing Director (MD). The KMT may also conduct an internal competitive process if felt necessary and give recommendations to the MD.

- (b) The MD shall consider the recommendations of the KMT and allocate roles and responsibilities as felt appropriate.
- (a) In case of new vacancy or replacement created at Key Management Personnel (KMP) positions, the Board may decide to conduct an internal/external process as felt appropriate, give directions to the Nomination and Remuneration Committee (“NRC”), the NRC will conduct the process accordingly and give recommendations to the Board and the Board may make appointments as felt appropriate by it.
- (b) Based on the previous role and the new role entrusted, it may or may not result in a ‘level’ change and/or change in pay package.

4. External Recruitment:

- (a) In case the required skill set is not available internally, then a combination of external channels shall be used to recruit requisite manpower as given below.
- (b) The MD will constitute requisite Committees to undertake the Recruitment & Selection Process and give appropriate directions to invite applications through any or all of the below modes -
 - Company Web-site
 - Available Database
 - Job websites
 - Placement Organizations
 - Software Development Organizations (SDO)
 - Manpower Provisioning Organizations (MPO)
 - Company’s Recruitment Email id.
 - Print Media Advertisement
 - Electronic Media Advertisement
 - Advertisements to concerned Educational Institutions viz. Engineering Colleges, Management Institutions, etc.
 - Known References
 - Employee References
 - Campus Recruitment
- (c) A number of checks and other verification procedures will be undertaken by HRD. These could include background verification, police verification, medical check-up, series of aptitude and technical test on the basis of their experience, interview/s, etc. In case the applicant is found suitable, s/he will be recommended by the Committee for offer of appointment. HRD shall prepare Minutes, the same shall be recommended by the CEO and on approval by the MD, HRD shall issue offer letter to the selected candidate. On acceptance of the offer in specified period, HRD shall initiate joining procedural formalities.
- (d) In case of a ‘tie’ situation between candidates, MD shall conduct interview of the concerned candidates and final decision shall rest with MD and binding on all concerned.
- (e) MKCL may recruit Engineer Trainees/Project Trainees (ETs/PTs) and/or Management Trainees (MTs) as per schemes announced from time to time.
- (f) Incase requisite suitable candidates are not identified inspite of all the efforts, the positions shall be kept vacant till such time, suitable resources are identified.

5. Induction & Training:

- (a) To familiarize the new entrant with the organization and its culture, practices, policies, processes, systems, etc. induction program shall be arranged by HRD and conducted by Teams entrusted for the same.
- (b) To ensure optimum productivity and clear understanding of expected work output, performance, requisite Trainings will be provided by the Company, especially in case of 'Fresher Recruits'.

6. Probation Period and Employee Confirmation:

- (a) Normally, the new entrant may not have to undergo any probation period but may be immediately confirmed. In some cases, new entrant or probationer may be kept on probation for period mentioned in letter of appointment which may vary based on the entrant's number of years of experience, qualifications, organizational requirement, etc.
- (b) 'Probation Confirmation' email shall be sent to the concerned Appraiser by HRD 30 days before the due date of confirmation and the concerned Appraiser shall reply to with necessary remarks at least 15 days before the due date of confirmation. Probationers shall be confirmed subject to performance of the probationer being adjudged satisfactory by respective Appraiser i.e. the rating should be 'Very Good' or above.
- (c) If recommended by concerned Appraiser, the probation period may be extended further with duration as felt appropriate by the MD in case of rating 'Good'/'Poor'.
- (d) Non-confirmation of probation shall be communicated in writing at least 7 working days in advance before the completion of the probation period. In case of non-confirmation of probationer, Probationer's services shall terminate at the close of office hours on the last day of probation.

7. Consultants:

- (a) MKCL with a view to forge a collaborative endeavor with domain experts, may empanel consultants as per norms specified from time to time. Such consultants shall not be employees of MKCL. Terms and conditions as mentioned in the letter for consultancy shall be applicable to such consultants.
- (b) Concerned Program Leader/Heads may also recommend to HRD to offer appointment on consultancy basis to persons with Software Development Organization ("SDO") or Manpower Provisioning Organization ("MPOs") or Educational Content Development Organization ("ECDO") who have worked/are working on Projects of the Company and the recommendation shall be based on domain skills, experience, expertise, performance and requirement of the Company. Further, the concerned Program leader/Head shall obtain a 'No objection Certificate' (NOC) in writing from the concerned MPO regarding recruitment of any manpower on its payroll so as to ensure long term mutually beneficial business relationship with the MPO and to ensure anti-poaching culture in the organization.

ANNEXURE A - Requisition For Manpower (RFM)

 Requisition For Manpower (RFM)		
Program name		
Temporary/Permanent basis		
Period of requirement if temporary		
Proposed Staff Category (for fitment)		
Proposed Staff Type (for fitment)		
Requirement Number		
Minimum Total Years of relevant experience		
Necessary Educational Qualifications		
Additional Preferred Educational Qualifications, if any		
Details of requisite Technical Skills, Domain Skills, Competency		
Preferred Place of posting/location		
Work Mode (WaW/WFH)		
Preferred Requirement date		
Role/Job Description:		
Desirable Qualities:		
Any other specific details:		

Requested by:	Recommended By:	Approved by Key Management Team (KMT) on
Name & Designation: Sr. Program Coordinator (or above)	Name: Program Leader	For KMT (Chief Executive officer)
Date:	Date:	Date:

B. Policy for Staff Type/Category Change

Policy:	Policy for Staff Type/Category Change
Date of issue:	March 31, 2025
Effective Date:	April 01, 2025
Last revision Date:	--
Effective Date of revision:	--
Version no.:	1.0

1.0 Objective:

This Policy defines a transparent and structured process for Staff Type/Category changes within the organization. As outlined in the MKCL's Employee Remuneration Policy (MERP), the Company classifies staff into three types: Development, Support, and Facilitation. Further, the MERP classifies Staff into five Categories: Management, Technical, Business, Academic, Artistic. This policy ensures fairness, clarity, and alignment with organizational goals while maintaining equity in the transition process.

2.0 Staff Category broad role and Responsibilities:

(a) Facilitation Staff

- Provide essential facilitation to Program Members, ensuring smooth execution of activities.
- Assist in coordinating and organizing program-related events, meetings, and sessions.
- Serve as a point of contact for participants, addressing queries and providing necessary information.
- Execute tasks as directed by senior Members.
- Ensure compliance with program guidelines, protocols, and quality standards.
- Support documentation and reporting of program activities as needed.
- Follow established workflows and assist team members in meeting deadlines and deliverables.
- Address routine concerns of Program Members and escalate unresolved issues to the concerned Senior Program Coordinator.

(b) Support Staff

- Offer essential logistical and operational support to both Program Members and customers.
- Assist in the coordination and execution of daily activities, ensuring seamless program operations.
- Manage scheduling, resource allocation, and administrative functions.
- Provide technical and administrative assistance where required, including data management and record-keeping.
- Facilitate communication and collaboration between different teams and stakeholders.
- Carry out assigned duties as per program requirements and leadership directives.
- Handle inquiries, provide information, and facilitate smooth interactions between stakeholders.

- Track the progress of operational activities and report any discrepancies or potential areas for improvement to the concerned Senior Program Coordinator.

(c) Development Staff

- Provide strategic leadership and direction to Program initiatives, fostering growth and innovation.
- Identify and address challenges, implementing effective solutions to enhance program efficiency.
- Mentor and guide team members, fostering skill development and professional growth.
- Establish and optimize processes to improve workflow, productivity, and overall program impact.
- Drive innovation by initiating and implementing new ideas, strategies, and best practices.
- Collaborate with stakeholders to ensure continuous improvement and alignment with organizational goals.
- Establish guidelines, best practices, and benchmarks to ensure continuous improvements in the offerings of the concerned Program.

3.0. Eligibility Criteria

The Key Management Team (KMT) will float advertisement (normally in January each year) for positions covering multiple staff type, categories (viz. for support and development).

4.0 Staff Type Change Plan

- The KMT will periodically review roles, responsibilities, and vacancies, including new positions created due to evolving organizational requirements.
- The frequency of staff type changes will be determined annually, and if applicable, will be made effective from April 1 of the corresponding year.

5.0 Staff Type Change Process

- The staff type change process will be competitive, ensuring the selection of the most suitable candidate.
- Eligible candidates will undergo a rigorous evaluation, which may include a hands-on test, domain-based assessment, interview, or a combination of these methods.
- An open advertisement will be released, allowing eligible employees to participate in the selection process.
- External candidates will also be considered for the vacancy, ensuring a fair and merit-based selection process.

The above norms shall apply *mutatis mutandis* to staff 'Category' changes, ensuring consistency and fairness in the process.

MKCL reserves the right to amend this Policy from time to time.

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4. REMUNERATION

A. MKCL Employees Remuneration Policy

Date of Issue:	April 01, 2017
Effective Date:	April 01, 2017
Last Revision Date:	March 06, 2025
Effective date of revision:	April 01, 2025
Version no.:	1.6

Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Ltd. (“MKCL”) has from time to time modelled its salary structure on the pattern of recommendations of the Central Pay Commission. MKCL, being a self-financed Joint Sector Company, has to incorporate, though marginal, but appropriate customizations in the recommended revision of pay structure in view of its own customized pay policies prevailing in the past and for ensuring long-term sustainability of the organization while inducing quality performance of employees in the years ahead.

The Seventh Central Pay Commission has stated that, in general, the level and structure of compensation should aim to achieve four objectives:

1. Pay should be sufficient to attract and retain high quality staff.
2. Pay should motivate staff to work hard.
3. Pay policy should induce other human resource management reforms.
4. Pay should be set at a level to ensure long term fiscal sustainability.

The Seventh Central Pay Commission has also stated that, the real challenge is to provide a pay structure which is competitive yet affordable, attractive yet acceptable, forward looking yet adaptable, simple yet rational, and one which matches with the current socio-economic and political conditions as well as the changing perception of the overall administrative machinery and the public governance system.

The “**MKCL’s Remuneration Policy 2017 for its Employees**” (hereinafter referred as “**Policy 2017**”) was formulated to address the objectives and challenges enlisted above.

Before implementing this Policy 2017, each member belonging to one of the then existing categories of staff was suitably placed into one of the new categories and new staff types with retrospective effect from April 01, 2017, based on the nature of then existing skills, competencies, and work of that employee:

Soon after suitable placement of all employees into new categories of staff and new staff types, ‘Policy 2017’ came into effect from April 01, 2017. Later Policy 2019 and 2022 were issued. The Policy 2022 was amended by the Board from time to time.

This “**MKCL Employees’ Remuneration Policy 2024**” (MERP) incorporates some further changes required considering dynamically changing employment conditions and shall supersede all previous Remuneration Policies.

The “MKCL Employees’ Remuneration Policy” is as follows:

A. Employee Categories and Staff Type:

Based on the nature of existing skills, competencies and work of that employee, each employee shall be placed into one of the below categories and staff types. The same may be changed by the Company in case of change in skills, competencies, and work of that employee:

Category	Staff Type
Management	Member Management Development Staff
	Member Management Support Staff
	Member Management Facilitation Staff
Technical	Member Technical Development Staff
	Member Technical Support Staff
	Member Technical Facilitation Staff
Business	Member Business Development Staff
	Member Business Support Staff
	Member Business Facilitation Staff
Academic	Member Academic Development Staff
	Member Academic Support Staff
	Member Academic Facilitation Staff
Artistic	Member Artistic Development Staff
	Member Artistic Support Staff
	Member Artistic Facilitation Staff

B. PAY PRINCIPLES

1. Pay Table

- The Pay Matrix Table (for Civilian Employees) as recommended by the Seventh Central Pay Commission and approved by the Cabinet vide its notification dated July 25, 2016, has been suitably used for arriving at the Company’s Pay Table as specified in Annexure I and employees shall be accordingly paid remuneration as per Basic Pay mentioned in Annexure I.
- Each Level of Basic Pay will be associated with a qualitatively distinct role. The job-roles for each level shall be reviewed and revised every year considering the expertise and experience required by the organization and the parity with prevailing Industry trends.
- Employees shall not be promoted automatically to the next higher Level by mere elapse of years of service and accumulation of annual performance ratings in the current Level. While better annual performance ratings may attract increments and greater OPLA, the promotions, however, shall be given based on availability of vacancies in the next Level based on business demands and suitability of the employee in terms of his/her relevant qualifications, expertise, and experience.

(d) The Annual increment in the next financial year shall be normally given @ about 3% of the Basic Pay in the current year.

2. **Monthly Allowances:** In addition to the Basic Pay, the following Monthly Allowances will be also paid-

Particulars	Monthly Allowances
House Rent Allowance	20% of Basic Pay for all places of posting within India.
Transportation Allowance	Rs.3,600/- per month for below staff types: • Member Management Facilitation Staff • Member Technical Facilitation Staff • Member Business Facilitation Staff • Member Academic Facilitation Staff • Member Artistic Facilitation Staff Rs.3,600/- per month for below staff types: • Member Management Support Staff • Member Technical Support Staff • Member Business Support Staff • Member Academic Support Staff • Member Artistic Support Staff Rs.7,200/- per month for below staff types: • Member Management Development • Member Technical Development • Member Business Development • Member Academic Development • Member Artistic Development

3. **Annual Allowances:** The below annual allowances will be paid as per Company norms-

Particulars	Annual Allowance
Leave Travel Allowance (LTA)	One Month's Basic Pay to be paid annually
Medical Allowance	One Month's Basic Pay ÷ 12 to be paid monthly

4. **Earned Leave Encashment:** The below will be paid as per Company norms. Earned Leave can be accumulated maximum up to 300 days.

Particulars	Amount
Earned Leave Encashment (Subject to balance)	Maximum One Month's Basic Pay only as on date of encashment in a financial year.

5. **Statutory Payments:** The below statutory payments will be made to concerned authorities-

Particulars	Statutory Payments
Provident Fund	12% of Basic Pay only
Gratuity	4.81% of Basic Pay only

C. Annual Special Allowance (“ASA”):

- (a) MKCL will decide to pay ASA based on scrutiny of its ‘Profit Before Tax’ (PBT) position for the current Financial Year (FY). The ASA shall be calculated on the Basic Pay component only as per Dearness Allowance (DA) rate declared by the Central Government w.e.f. January of the previous Financial Year (FY) and July of the current FY. No other component viz. Transport Allowance/DA component in Provident Fund contribution, Gratuity, Earned Leave Encashment will be considered.
- (b) The ASA shall be the first component to be set aside from the Profit Before Tax (PBT). In case the PBT amount is insufficient to cover the ASA fully, then the ASA shall be paid to the extent PBT is available. e. g. in case calculated ASA in a year is Rs.50 Lakhs and PBT for the said year is Rs.1 Crore, then ASA shall be fully paid. However, if ASA is Rs.1 Crore while PBT is Rs.50 Lakhs, then only ASA aggregating to Rs.50 Lakhs shall be paid to the eligible employees.
- (c) In order to make the salary budget more predictable and advance tax calculations more accurate, known DA rates will be considered for calculation - e.g.
 - ASA for April 2024 to June 2024 → To be calculated in June 2024 based on DA rate applicable w.e.f. January 2024.
 - ASA for July 2024 to December 2024 → To be calculated in December 2024 based on DA rate applicable w.e.f. July 2024.
 - ASA for January 2025 to March 2025 → To be calculated in February 2025 based on DA rate applicable for January 2025, if notified, else DA rate applicable w.e.f. July 2024 shall be considered.
- (d) The ASA in case due and payable, will be disbursed to employees eligible as per MKCL Norms in the month decided by the Key Management Team (“KMT”). The ASA amounts not paid for the concerned Financial Year (FY), will not be carried forward to the next financial year. e.g., ASA is Rs.1 Crore while PBT is Rs.50 Lakhs, then only ASA aggregating to Rs.50 Lakhs shall be paid to the eligible employees and unpaid ASA of 50 Lakhs will not be carried forward for payment in future. This allowance, therefore, each year may be given fully/partially or not at all, depending on the PBT position and the decision regarding the same will be taken by the KMT. Employees who shall not be considered eligible for payment of ASA at the time of disbursement are:
 - a. Individuals who have resigned/have been terminated during the concerned FY or during the current FY till the date of actual disbursement;
 - b. Individuals serving under notice period of resignation or termination;
 - c. Individuals serving under probation period or traineeship;
 - d. Engineer Trainee/Project Trainee, Project Associate (I and/ or II), Senior Project Associates (I and/ or II).
- (e) This will establish a direct relation between company performance and Allowance. Therefore, a performance-based allowance culture will percolate at all levels in the organization, rather than a DA based auto-rise culture.

D. Annual Organizational Performance Linked Award (“OPLA”):

1. The Key Management Team (KMT) will decide to pay OPLA based on careful analysis of Company’s profitability of concerned Financial Year. This award, therefore, may not be mandatorily given every year. If payable, it will be disbursed to employees eligible as per MKCL Norms in the month decided by the KMT.

Employees who shall not be considered eligible for payment at the time of disbursement of OPLA are:

- (a) Individuals who have resigned/have been terminated during the concerned FY or during the current FY till the date of actual disbursement;
- (b) Individuals serving under notice period of resignation or termination;
- (c) Individuals serving under probation period or traineeship;
- (d) Engineer Trainee/Project Trainee, Project Associate (I and/ or II), Senior Project Associates (I and/ or II) who have not completed 12 working months of their association with the Company as on March 31 of the concerned financial year.

The parameters used while computing OPLA will be:

- (a) Number of working days put in by the eligible individual during the concerned financial year;
- (b) His/her Total Pay i.e., Basic Pay/stipend + Applicable Allowances (HRA) during the concerned financial year;
- (c) Relative Ratings (with a minimum of "Good" rating) for the respective individual in the concerned financial year or average of relative ratings given by multiple appraisers, if applicable, and relative ratings as rationalized across programs and teams.
- (d) The turnover and profitability of the organization for the concerned financial year.

Exception: Notwithstanding anything stated in Clause C and D above, in case an employee who has resigned or is serving under notice period of resignation -

- (a) requests for withdrawal of his/her resignation within 15 days of disbursement of ASA and/or OPLA to eligible employees; and
- (b) assures of uninterrupted diligent services for minimum period of Twelve Months from the date of withdrawal of resignation; and
- (c) the said request is accepted by the Managing Director,

then, ASA and/or OPLA will be paid to such employee which will be same as what s/he would have received had s/he not resigned. Further, to deter misuse of this special consideration, in case of separation for any reasons whatsoever (excluding demise/permanent disability) from services of the Company, before expiry of Twelve months from the date of withdrawal of resignation, the Company shall have full rights to recover disbursed ASA and/or OPLA (as applicable) from any amounts payable/due to the employee including salary, earned leave, gratuity, etc. In case, there is a shortfall in recovery of the said ASA and/or OPLA amounts, the concerned employee shall pay such shortfall to the Company within 7 days of communication to her/him, failing which appropriate action will be taken.

E. Annual Increments and Promotion:

- 1. The Annual 'Appraisal Rating' shall be considered for -
 - a. Annual increment @ about 3% of the Basic Pay in the current year. In case of 'Poor' Performance, no annual increment will be given.
 - b. Accumulation of rating points making an employee eligible for promotion i.e., 'level up-gradation' subject to certain conditions mentioned in point no. (3) below; and
 - c. Weightage in computing OPLA.
- 2. The Performance of each employee will be evaluated by the concerned Appraiser giving an employee an Absolute Rating every quarter. These ratings will then be rationalized annually by the respective Program Head giving each employee a Relative Rating as per table given below:

Sr. No.	Performance Rating	Relative Rating Points
1	Outstanding*	4.5
2	Excellent + **	4
3	Excellent	3
4	Very Good	2.5
5	Good	2.0
6	Poor	0

*The outstanding rating is given only to about 5% of staff who top among those nominating themselves for an organizational level annual review by a Review Committee constituted by the Managing Director for this purpose.

**Excellent + rating can be given only at the discretion of and by the Managing Director.

3. Level up-gradation will be awarded only if below necessary conditions are fulfilled -
 - a. If the employees belonging to Staff Types Member Management Development, Member Technical Development, Member Business Development, Member Academic Development and Member Artistic Development attain 12 rating points cumulatively in the current level or
 - b. If the employees belonging to Staff Types mentioned below attain 20 rating points cumulatively in the current level,

Staff Type
• Member Management Support Staff • Member Technical Support Staff • Member Business Support Staff • Member Academic Support Staff • Member Artistic Support Staff • Member Management Facilitation Staff • Member Technical Facilitation Staff • Member Business Facilitation Staff • Member Academic Facilitation Staff • Member Artistic Facilitation Staff

- c. If there exists a position in the higher level, and
- d. If the concerned employee possesses the requisite relevant qualifications, expertise and experience to discharge the responsibilities commensurate with the position in the higher level.

Additional sufficiency conditions for specific pay levels/categories:

Notwithstanding anything stated above-

(i) in case of members, after level 5, the next level up-gradation will be given, if the concerned employee participates and is selected for the higher pay level through a competitive process

(ii) in case of the Key Managerial Personnel (KMP), excluding the Managing Director*, each level up-gradation shall be awarded on attaining of 12 rating points and such up-gradation shall be

given till level 5. After level 5, the next level up-gradation in such cases would be on attaining of 12 rating points and as per below specified process-

- Concerned officer shall make presentation to the Nomination and Remuneration Committee (NRC) of the Board regarding 'Significant contributions made during the existing level'.

NRC shall review the concerned officer's performance based on the synopsis of contributions made during the existing level as well as his/her performance track record and accordingly decide whether the next level upgradation be awarded.

(*For the Managing Director, the Terms of Agreement with the Company shall apply).

4. After the employee is promoted to the next level, his/her accumulation of rating points shall start afresh. Further, in case 12/20 rating points are not accumulated within a continuous period of 6/10 years, then the accumulation of rating points shall start afresh.
5. The level up-gradation will be awarded for various staff types as per Tables specified in *Annexure / hereto*.
6. In case an employee has been promoted during a financial year, if such employee completes six months or more period of residency for the basic pay step in the concerned year on March 31, then increment will be awarded to the employee, otherwise same basic pay shall be maintained for the ensuing financial year.

Regarding Female Member staff who have re-joined full-time work in the concerned Financial Year after availing 'Half Day Work from Home/at Office Policy for women' for New Mothers ("the Policy") and have completed six months or more period of residency for the basic pay step in the concerned year on March 31, increment shall be awarded, otherwise same basic pay shall be maintained for the ensuing financial year. Further, due to half day working for the previous years, if any increments are due but kept on hold due to availing the said Policy, then in such case, minimum twelve month's residency (full time working) in basic pay step is required in all the previous financial years for award of increment, otherwise same basic pay shall be maintained for the ensuing financial year.

e.g., If in FY 2020-21, Ms. XYZ has completed 9 months of residency on March 31, 2021 in the basic pay step working on half-day basis, then it will be considered as 4.5 months of full time working. Further, in FY 2021-22, she has completed 12 months of residency on March 31, 2022 in the same basic pay step working on half-day basis, then it will be considered as 6 months of full time working. Therefore, on March 31, 2022, $4.5 + 6 = 10.5$ months of full time working will be considered and as such not eligible for increment. Similarly, in FY 2022-23 after working for 12 months on half-day basis, she will complete 6 months of full time working. As such, on April 01, 2024 she will become eligible for increment which will be given effect to on re-joining work on full time basis (due to accumulation of $4.5 + 6 + 6 = 16.5$ months of full time working i.e., period exceeding 12 months of full time working)

F. Other Payments / Reimbursements:

- 1. Children Education Allowance:** Applicable to employees whose children are undergoing school/college education i.e., from age 6 to 12th Standard.

Reimbursement of school/college fees and school/college transport (i.e., school bus/van services provided by service provider) fees at the rate of Rs.5,000/- per child per month subject to maximum of two children shall be against the submission of original receipts on annual basis as per the norms. In case of differently abled child, the reimbursement shall be at the rate of Rs.10,000/- per child per month subject to maximum of two children against the submission of original receipts on annual basis as per the norms.

- 2. Insurance Coverage:**

- a. Medical Coverage of Rs.4 Lakhs per annum - as per MKCL Norms.
- b. Accident Insurance Cover of Rs.10 Lakh - as per MKCL Norms.

- 3. Various Allowances, Re-imbursements:** Below allowances will be paid as per eligibility-

- (a) **Leadership Allowance** (paid annually on pro rata basis): Employees in the 'Member Development Staff' type at level 5 and above shall be paid the Leadership Allowance of Rs.1,50,000/- annually.
- (b) **Driver's Salary Re-imbursement:** Re-imbursement of driver's salary may be given to the KMT members based on the driver's experience and as per 'Policy for Reimbursement of Driver's Compensation' as applicable from time to time. However, a KMT member may choose not to avail Driver's Salary Reimbursement and instead may claim Conveyance Reimbursement (as given below) as applicable.
- (c) **Annual Reimbursement of Conveyance Expenses:** Conveyance Reimbursement up to Rs.1,20,000/- may be paid annually to the employees in the 'Member Development Staff' type in the level 5 and above for her/his to and/or fro travel between member's official residence and MKCL office at the place of posting of the member towards cab/Rickshaw rentals and/or partial Driver pay. The reimbursement shall be made subject to submission of valid supporting documents such as bills, etc. However, those employee/s who have been given and are availing Re-imbursement of driver's salary as per norms of 'Policy for Reimbursement of Driver's Compensation' as applicable from time to time, will not be paid Annual Conveyance Reimbursement.
- (d) **Project Leader Allowance:** In case the Company entrusts the role as 'Project Leader' to any of its employee and transfers him/her outside the State of his/her original posting to head a Project, then the employee shall be paid a 'Project Leader Allowance' between Rs.50,000/- to Rs.1,00,000/- per annum as felt appropriate by the Managing Director taking into account various factors like Project size, Project value, Project location, etc. The said allowance shall be paid in the month of March every year on pro-rata basis of completed number of days in capacity as Project Leader.
- (e) **Assistant Project Leader Allowance:** In case the Company entrusts the role as 'Assistant Project Leader' to any of its employee and transfers him/her outside the State of his/her original posting to head a Project, then the employee shall be paid a 'Assistant Project Leader Allowance' between Rs.25,000/- to Rs.50,000/- per annum as felt appropriate by the Managing Director taking into account various factors like Project size, Project value,

Project location, etc. The said allowance shall be paid in the month of March every year on pro-rata basis of completed number of days in capacity as Assistant Project Leader.

- (f) **Internet and Mobile Reimbursement:** For fulfilling their business, facilitation and other official responsibilities, the employees may be reimbursed for their mobile and internet dongle usage. This reimbursement shall be as per the 'Mobile Phone and Internet Charges Reimbursement Policy' issued by the Company from time to time.
- (g) **Daily Allowance:** The Company shall pay a reasonable sum of money as 'Daily Allowance' to cover food expenses that an employee incurs on a domestic official travel as per the 'Daily Allowance for Domestic Official Travel Policy' issued by the Company from time to time. In case of foreign travel, the 'Daily Allowance' shall be paid as per the 'Daily Allowance for Foreign Official Travel Policy' issued by the Company from time to time.
- (h) **Sports & Recreation Allowance (SRA):** To take care of physical and mental well-being of Employees Rs.1,433/- per month shall be paid towards SRA to all eligible employees on pro-rata basis of completed number of days without any supporting documents.
(Annually means Financial Year - April to March)

4. Training and Development Facilities:

- Training Programs arranged by the Company;
- Sponsoring to attend seminars, workshops, conferences, courses in India or abroad as prior recommended by concerned Program Leader and approved by the Managing Director;
- Reimbursement of Certification Fees as per applicable policies, norms;
- Reimbursement of Membership fees of relevant professional bodies;
- Subscription of journals and Digital Libraries as prior approved by concerned Program Heads;
- Excursions and Get-togethers arranged by the Company.

5. **Transfer Allowance (TA):** A composite amount equal to one month's basic pay as on date of transfer shall be paid as TA to an employee transferred for period exceeding continuous three months. This TA will be paid by the Company in addition to the salary as per letter of appointment. Other terms for transfer shall be as per 'Transfer Policy' issued by the Company from time to time.

Note: All the above allowances may be revised by KMT from time to time.

G. Leave Norms and Other Facilities and Benefits:

1. Leave norms and other facilities and benefits shall be as per policies announced by the Company from time to time.

H. Retirement from Services:

1. Every employee shall retire from service of the Company on the afternoon of the last day of the month in which s/he attains the age of sixty years:

Provided that an employee whose date of birth is the first of a month, shall retire from service on the afternoon of the last day of the preceding month on attaining the age of sixty years.

2. In case an employee attains the age of sixty years on a Weekly off day or on an Annual/Public Holiday, then s/he shall retire from service on the afternoon of the previous working day.
 3. Notwithstanding anything stated anywhere in this Policy, an employee who retires from the service of the Company, will be eligible to receive OPLA and/or ASA as per Company norms for the period of services rendered by the employee in the previous financial year as well as the current financial year in which s/he retired, which the retiring employee would have been eligible to receive had s/he been still in the service of the Company.
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Annexures:

- a) Annexure I (1.1) - Pay Table for Induction/Promotion Norms for Staff Type - Member Facilitation Staff
(For All Categories of Staff)
 - b) Annexure I (1.2) - Pay Table Induction/ Promotion Norms for Staff Type - Member Support Staff
(For All Categories of Staff)
 - c) Annexure I (1.3) - Pay Table Induction/ Promotion Norms for Staff Types - Member Development Staff (For All Categories of Staff)
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Approved by the Board in its Board Meeting held on June 21, 2024

Annexure I (1.1) - PAY TABLE

Induction/Promotion Norms for Staff Type - Member Facilitation Staff (For All Categories of Staff)		
Level	Year of Service for Facilitation Staff	Basic Pay (in Rupees)
1	2	3
1	5 to 6	18000
	6 to 7	19100
	7 to 8	19700
	8 to 9	20300
	9 to 10	21100
	10 to 11	22100
	11 to 12	22800
	12 to 13	23500
2	13 to 14	25200
	14 to 15	26000
	15 to 16	26800
	16 to 17	27900
	17 to 18	28800
	18 to 19	29700
	19 to 20	30600
	20 to 21	31900
3	21 to 22	33900
	22 to 23	35000
	23 to 24	36100
	24 to 25	37200
	25 to 26	38600
	26 to 27	39800
	27 to 28	41000
	28 to 29	42300
4	29 to 30	44900
	30 to 31	46800
	31 to 32	48500
	32 to 33	50000
	33 to 34	51500
	34 to 35	53100
	35 to 36	54700
	36 to 37	56800
5	37 to 38	60300
	38 to 39	62200
	39 to 40	64100
	40 to 41	66600

Annexure I (1.2)- PAY TABLE

Induction/ Promotion Norms for Staff Type - Member Support Staff (For All Categories of Staff)		
Level	Year of Service for Support Staff	Basic Pay (In Rupees)
1	2	3
1	5 to 6	25500
	6 to 7	26300
	7 to 8	27100
	8 to 9	28000
	9 to 10	29200
	10 to 11	30100
	11 to 12	31100
	12 to 13	32300
2	13 to 14	34300
	14 to 15	35400
	15 to 16	36500
	16 to 17	37600
	17 to 18	39200
	18 to 19	40400
	19 to 20	41800
	20 to 21	43100
3	21 to 22	45700
	22 to 23	47100
	23 to 24	48900
	24 to 25	50400
	25 to 26	52000
	26 to 27	53600
	27 to 28	55800
	28 to 29	57500
4	29 to 30	61000
	30 to 31	63100
	31 to 32	65000
	32 to 33	67000
	33 to 34	69100
	34 to 35	71300
	35 to 36	74000
	36 to 37	76400
5	37 to 38	81100
	38 to 39	83600
	39 to 40	87000
	40 to 41	90000

Annexure I (1.3) - PAY TABLE

Induction/ Promotion Norms for Staff Types - Member Development Staff (For All Categories of Staff)			
Level	Year of Service for Technical/ Academic/ Artistic Categories	Year of Service for Management/ Business Categories	Basic Pay (In Rupees)
1	2	3	4
1	4 to 5	3 to 4	44400
	5 to 6	4 to 5	46100
	6 to 7	5 to 6	47500
	7 to 8	6 to 7	49000
	8 to 9	7 to 8	50500
2	9 to 10	8 to 9	53600
	10 to 11	9 to 10	55800
	11 to 12	10 to 11	57500
	12 to 13	11 to 12	59500
	13 to 14	12 to 13	61300
3	14 to 15	13 to 14	65000
	15 to 16	14 to 15	67000
	16 to 17	15 to 16	69100
	17 to 18	16 to 17	71300
	18 to 19	17 to 18	74000
4	19 to 20	18 to 19	78500
	20 to 21	19 to 20	80900
	21 to 22	20 to 21	83600
	22 to 23	21 to 22	87000
	23 to 24	22 to 23	90000
5	24 to 25	23 to 24	95500
	25 to 26	24 to 25	98400
	26 to 27	25 to 26	101400
	27 to 28	26 to 27	104800
	28 to 29	27 to 28	108800
6	29 to 30	28 to 29	115500
	30 to 31	29 to 30	119000
	31 to 32	30 to 31	122600
	32 to 33	31 to 32	126300
	33 to 34	32 to 33	130100
7	34 to 35	33 to 34	138000
	35 to 36	34 to 35	142400
	36 to 37	35 to 36	146700
	37 to 38	36 to 37	152000
	38 to 39	37 to 38	156600
8	39 to 40	38 to 39	166100
	40 to 41	39 to 40	171100
	41 to 42	40 to 41	177400
	42 to 43	41 to 42	184700

	43 to 44	42 to 43	191000
9	44 to 45	43 to 44	202600
	45 to 46	44 to 45	208700
	46 to 47	45 to 46	216600
	47 to 48	46 to 47	224100
	48 to 49	47 to 48	230800
10	49 to 50	48 to 49	237700
	50 to 51	49 to 50	244900
	51 to 52	50 to 51	252200
	52 to 53	51 to 52	259800

Notes:

Applicable to Annexure I:

i. The pay tables may be extended on the same logic if it is found that employees are getting saturated at the last basic but have not turned age 60 years yet.

ii. The Company at times, as per organizational situations and/or requirements, issues Job advertisements (viz. for lateral entry). The Advertisement may mention the approximate annual cost to the company (ACTC) and/or Basic Pay Level at which fitment of selected candidate will be made for certain number of years of experience and work profile. In such cases, the 'years of service' as mentioned against a particular 'Basic Pay Level' in the above Annexures may differ from what is mentioned in the Advertisement. Where such variance happens, the remuneration mentioned in the Advertisement will be applicable.

5. LEAVE

A. Applicability of Leave Policies

Policy:	Leave Policy
Sub-policy:	Applicability of Leave Policies
Date of issue:	February 22, 2019
Effective Date:	February 22, 2019
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

MKCL believes that its personnel may have to stay away from work for genuine reasons with prior approval of the authorized officers. It may be granted for a casual purpose or a planned activity, on medical grounds or in extra-ordinary conditions. These policies should be used for the better understanding and utilization of the leave rules and norms. Also, in case of any deviation, the leave provisions laid down by applicable Statutes from time to time shall apply. This policy outlines the applicability, rules and procedures with regard to consumption and approval of leave. It must be understood that leave is not a 'Right' but a facility which may be availed by an employee subject to the approval of the Appraiser. Concerned employee who is applying for availing the 'Leave Facility' shall try to ensure that there are no major disruptions in the work during his/her absence. He /she should ideally entrust the responsibility to attend to urgent matters to some other Team member/s during his/her absence.

The Company recruits, engages individuals under different categories as employees. The terms and conditions of their employment mentions the kinds of leaves they can apply for and avail. For easy reference and understanding, applicability of different 'Leaves' for different categories have been stated in this policy.

2. Applicability:

- (a) **Casual Leave (CL)** pursuant to the CL Policy can be availed by all employees. The applicant should not be serving under notice period of resignation/termination.
- (b) **Earned Leave (EL)** pursuant to the EL Policy can be availed by an employee who is under any of the staff types enlisted below (hereinafter referred to as '**Staff Type-Member**') and who is not serving under notice period of resignation/termination -

Staff Type-Member
Member Management Development Staff
Member Management Support Staff
Member Management Facilitation Staff
Member Technical Development Staff
Member Technical Support Staff

Member Technical Facilitation Staff
Member Business Development Staff
Member Business Support Staff
Member Business Facilitation Staff
Member Academic Development Staff
Member Academic Support Staff
Member Academic Facilitation Staff
Member Artistic Creations Staff
Member Artistic Creations Support Staff
Member Artistic Creations Facilitation Staff

- (c) **Sick/Half Pay Leave (SL)** pursuant to the SL Policy can be availed by all employees of the Company. An applicant serving under notice period of resignation/termination can also avail SL.
- (d) **Maternity Leave (ML)** pursuant to the ML Policy can be availed by every woman in the Company employed, whether directly or through any agency, for remuneration and the woman should have minimum 80 working days to her credit in last 12 months counting from start of maternity leave to be eligible for maternity benefits in the Company.
- (e) **Paternity Leave (PL)** pursuant to the PL Policy can be availed by every male employee with less than two surviving children, who is under any of the 'Staff type-Member' and who is not serving under notice period of resignation/termination.
- (f) **Weekly off** All Saturdays and Sundays shall be weekly off days for all employees, Interns, Fellows and Consultants.
- (g) **Annual/Public Holidays** pursuant to the Annual/Public Holidays Policy can be availed by all employees.
- (h) **Compensatory Off (CO)** pursuant to the CO Policy can be availed by all employees.
- (i) **Leave Without Pay (LWP)** can be allowed only if recommended by the concerned Appraiser and approved by the Managing Director. Otherwise, it will be considered as 'unauthorized absence from duty' and amount to misconduct.
- (j) **On Duty Leave (ODL)** Policy is applicable to all employees.
-

B. Casual Leave (CL)

Policy:	Leave Policy
Sub-policy:	Casual Leave (CL) Policy
Date of issue:	April 01, 2017
Effective Date:	April 01, 2017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective Date of revisions	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

Casual leave (CL) may be utilized if an eligible employee wants to take leave for a day/few days for personal reasons.

2. Norms:

- (a) Casual leave (CL) is a leave which can be availed at any time for personal reasons by an employee. It be applied in advance and ideally sanctioned by concerned Appraiser in advance unless unavoidable. Pay of an employee for CL is not deducted.
- (b) CL credit of 8 days shall be given to existing employees in service on January 01 each calendar year. In case of new employees joining later, the CL credit shall be given on pro-rata basis of remaining months in the calendar year.
- (c) A minimum of 0.5 day and a maximum of 3 continuous working days of CL can be taken at a time subject to the availability of balance in his/her CL account. Incase, the CL of 8 days is consumed, while the employee requires Leave for 3 or less number of days for personal reasons, then subject to the approval of the concerned Appraiser, the employee can apply for such leave as CL, however, such leave shall be deducted from available Earned Leave balance. In case no Earned Leave balance is available then such absence can be allowed as 'Leave without Pay' only subject to recommendation by concerned Appraiser and approval by the Managing Director. Otherwise, it shall be considered as 'unauthorized absence from duty' and pay for the said day/s shall be deducted. Further, it will amount to misconduct.
- (d) In case of prefixing and suffixing the weekly off days i.e. Saturday and Sunday with CL ('Sandwich CL'), both the weekly off days shall also be deducted as CL in case of available CL balance or shall be deducted from available Earned Leave balance. In case no Earned Leave balance is available then such absence can be allowed as 'Leave without Pay' only subject to recommendation by concerned Appraiser and approval by the Managing Director. Otherwise, it shall be considered as 'unauthorized absence from duty' and pay for the said day/s shall be deducted. Further, it will amount to misconduct.
- (e) Unavailed CL balance as on December 31 can neither be encashed nor be carried forward to the next calendar year. It shall lapse.
- (f) Ideally, CL should be applied in advance, except for health reasons or unforeseen exigencies. Incase CL is disapproved by the concerned Appraiser for valid reasons, then it shall be considered as 'unauthorized absence from duty' and pay for the said day/s shall be

deducted. Further, it will amount to misconduct.

3. Exceptions:

- (a) Notwithstanding anything stated above, in case of Staff Type Trainees and Associates, the CL credit shall be for 12 days instead of 8 days. Further, the norm of 'maximum of 3 continuous working days of CL' shall not be applicable for the said Staff Type. As such, more than 3 continuous working days of CL can be applied, subject to availability of CL balance. However, the 'Sandwich CL' norm shall apply even in this case. This exception norm has been specified considering that the said staff types are not eligible for 'Earned Leave' -
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C. Earned Leave (EL)

Policy:	Leave Policy
Sub-Policy:	Earned Leave (EL) Policy
Date of issue:	April 01, 20017
Effective Date:	April 01, 20017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective Date of revision :	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

The primary purpose of Earned Leave (EL) is to allow and encourage every employee to renew his/her physical and mental capabilities and to remain a fully productive employee. Employees are encouraged to request EL during each year in order to achieve this purpose.

2. Norms:

- (a) Employees shall be eligible for earned leave of 30 days in a calendar year after having worked for atleast 240 days during the previous year. The leave account of the employee shall be credited with earned leave, in two installments of 15 days each on 30th June and 31st December of every calendar year. Employees will receive credit for number of completed months. In case of new employees joining later, the EL credit shall be given on pro-rata basis of months worked in the calendar year.
- (b) In case of employees availing Maternity/Paternity Leave, the days spent on said Leave will be taken into account for the purpose of computation of 240 days of service during the year but the concerned employee will not earn any EL during those days spent on Maternity/Paternity Leave.
- (c) EL can be availed off only after it has been earned and credited to the employee's EL account.
- (d) Earned Leave not availed during the year, will be carried forward to the next calendar year, subject to the condition that the leave so carried forward plus the credit for the current year does not exceed the maximum limit of 300 days.
- (e) The employee shall be eligible to encash unavailed EL upto 30 days during a calendar year. Such leave encashment shall be admissible only once in a calendar year. Employee encashing EL will receive amounts as specified in his/her remuneration letter.
- (f) The encashment of unavailed earned leave limited to 300 days shall be admissible to the employees in the following cases:
 - Retirement on attaining the age of superannuation
 - Voluntary / pre-mature retirement
 - Where services of the employee stand terminated by notice or by recovery of pay in lieu of notice, or for other reasons in accordance with the terms and conditions of his/her appointment

- In case of death of any employee while in service, to the family of the deceased.
 - In case of resignation from service of MKCL.
- (g) A minimum of 3 days Earned Leave can be taken at a time. The employee must give notice of at least 15 days for availing the Earned Leave. All holidays, weekly off days falling during this period shall be treated as EL. However, those falling either prefix or suffix to the EL shall not be treated as EL. Employees normally cannot avail EL for more than 30 days at a time. However, in case of valid and genuine reasons, on application by an employee, the said limit of 30 days can be extended subject to recommendation by the concerned Appraiser and approval by the MD. Further, the said limit of 30 days does not apply to a lady employee availing Maternity Leave and she can avail EL for more than 30 days in continuation of her ML.
- (h) For availing EL, it is not necessary that Casual Leave balance has to be first consumed fully.
- (i) EL encashment is taxable as per the prevalent Income Tax Rules.
- (j) EL has to be recommended by the concerned Appraiser of the employee and approved by the Managing Director or officer duly authorized by the Managing Director.

3. Exceptions:

- (a) Notwithstanding anything stated above, HRD can deduct less than 3 days EL in case of Casual Leave Balance exhausting and as per norms specified in the Casual Leave Policy.
-

D. Sick Leave (SL)

Policy:	Leave Policy
Sub-policy:	Sick Leave (SL) Policy
Date of issue:	April 01, 2017
Effective Date:	April 01, 2017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective Date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

Sick Leave (SL) can be availed by an employee if he/ she is unwell and cannot report to work due to being ill/unwell.

2. Norms:

- (a) In case of SL, the employee should at the earliest inform his/her immediate appraiser about his sickness and inability to report to work. Pay of an employee on SL is not intermitted.
- (b) There are 10 days of SL in a calendar year and shall be credited on 1st January or at the time of joining on a proportionate basis.
- (c) SL is permissible only on submission of a Medical Certificate from a Registered Medical Practitioner which is on letterhead of the Medical Practitioner, registration number is mentioned and duly dated, signed. SL should be applied in employee portal within 7 days of re-joining along with valid supporting certificate/s.
- (d) Prefixing and suffixing the weekly offs i.e. Saturday and Sunday with full day SL, shall result in treating both the weekly off days as SL. SL can be clubbed with EL only under exceptional conditions. If an employee has exhausted his/her entire SL and circumstances force him/her to extend the SL, then he/she may club his/her SL with his/her EL if recommended by concerned Appraiser and approved by the Managing Director.
- (e) SL not availed during the year, will be carried forward to the next calendar year and there is no maximum limit for accumulation of SL. Unveiled SL cannot be encashed.

3. Exceptions:

- (a) Notwithstanding anything stated in this policy-
 - (a)an employee can avail SL for Covid-19 vaccination or vaccination for any such serious infections. Maximum leave which can be availed will be the day of the vaccination and/or two additional days (in case of vaccination reaction). The employee shall submit valid certificate of vaccination to avail SL within specified period as per applicable norms.

- Medical Certificate may not be necessary in case of availing SL for short and sudden illness/unwellness upto 2 (two) days in a calendar month, subject to available SL balance and such SL without Medical Certificate should not exceed total 8 (eight) days in a calendar year. Any SL without Medical Certificate should be for 1 (one) full day and cannot be for half day. It is being clarified that half day/longer SL can be availed as per norms mentioned in clause 2.0 (3) above i.e. on submission of a Medical Certificate.
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E. Maternity Leave (ML)

Policy:	Leave Policy
Sub-policy:	Maternity Leave (ML) Policy
Date of issue:	June 19, 2017
Effective Date:	Retrospective from August 11, 2016
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

MKCL is firmly committed to protecting the rights of expectant mothers and complying with the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 and amendments made thereto from time to time. The object of maternity leave and benefit is to protect the dignity of motherhood by providing for the full and healthy maintenance of women and her child when she is not working. It is also to ensure that women working in the Company are able to balance their roles as mothers and their work. Maternity leave at MKCL shall be administered as per the prevailing Law/Act.

2. Applicability:

This policy shall be applicable to every woman in the Company employed, whether directly or through any agency, for remuneration.

3. Eligibility:

The woman employed whether directly or through any agency, for remuneration, should have minimum 80 working days to her credit in last 12 months counting from start of maternity leave to be eligible for maternity benefits in the Company.

4. Policy and Norms:

Leave period:

Incase the woman has less than two surviving children, she is entitled for maximum 26 weeks of maternity leave of which not more than 8 weeks shall precede the date of her expected delivery.

(a) Extended Leave for illness:

A woman suffering from illness arising out of pregnancy, delivery, premature birth of child, miscarriage, medical termination of pregnancy or tubectomy operation shall, on production of requisite medical certificate from a Registered Medical Practitioner, be entitled to extended leave for a maximum period of one month, in addition to the period of absence allowed to her above. This extended one month shall also be paid leave.

(b) Leave Application:

To facilitate the Company to make alternative arrangements for assigning her duties, application for maternity leave be preferably made two months prior to the date of commencement of leave. Though this is not mandatory, it is desirable to avoid operational disruptions in the Company. On receipt of such application, the Program Head- HRD shall counsel the concerned woman regarding availing and optimum utilization of other eligible leaves.

(c) Leave for miscarriage, etc.:

In case of miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy (but not threatened abortion), a woman shall, on production of a medical certificate from a Registered Medical Practitioner, be entitled to leave at the rate of maternity benefit, for a period of six weeks immediately following the day of her miscarriage or, as the case may be, her medical termination of pregnancy.

(d) Commissioning Mother and adopting Mother :

A woman who legally adopts a child below the age of three months or a commissioning mother shall be entitled to maternity benefit for a period of twelve weeks from the date the child is handed over to the adopting mother or the commissioning mother, as the case may be.

(e) Applicability incase of two or “more than two” surviving children :

Notwithstanding anything stated above, in case of women having two or “more than two” surviving children, the maximum period entitled for maternity benefit under this policy shall be twelve weeks of which not more than six weeks shall precede the date of her expected delivery.

(f) Crèche facility:

The Women in cities have to travel by public transport in crowded trains, buses or private vehicle viz. two wheelers, four wheelers to the place of work. As such it is practically not possible for them to carry the baby/child with them to/near to the place of work. Further, as the child attains 3 years of age, he/she starts to school, which may not be located near to the place of work of the mother. In view of this, a woman who re-joins full-time after the Maternity Leave or other permissible leave for reasons of childbirth and nurturance, may identify and avail crèche facility for her child at location convenient to her or make alternative child-caring arrangements at home. The Company shall pay to such woman, an annual allowance as ‘Child-caring Allowance’ in the month of March each Financial Year, equal to ‘Children Education Allowance’ as per Company norms and on pro-rata basis for each completed month after the woman re-joining full-time, till her child attains the age of six.

No ‘Child-caring Allowance’ shall be claimed by a woman, for the period she avails benefits under Company’s other ‘Child-caring’/‘Child-nurturance’ policies viz. ‘work from home’/‘part-time working’/‘permissible leave’. Further, no ‘Children Education Allowance’ shall be claimed by a woman who is paid ‘Child-caring Allowance’ and/or whose child has yet not attained the age of 6 years.

(g) Communication:

The Company shall intimate in writing and electronically to every woman at the time of her initial appointment regarding every benefit available under the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961.

Further, during the period that the woman employee is availing the Maternity Leave, incase she belongs to the 'Technical category', her concerned Appraiser and Program Head shall ensure that she is kept informed about the new technological developments and initiatives being implemented in the Company, so that when she re- joins, there is no knowledge-gap and she is able to discharge her responsibilities effectively and efficiently. Regarding other categories, the concerned Appraiser and Program Head should similarly keep the woman employee informed about necessary developments, so as to support her to discharge her responsibilities effectively and efficiently on re-joining. Further, the women employee shall be eligible to get reimbursement for completing certification/s during the period of leave, subject to prior recommendation and approval as per the 'Reimbursement Policy for Certifications, Professional Memberships, attending Professional events'. The woman employee will be required to hand over IT Infrastructure Assets viz. laptop / pen drive / hard drive etc. allotted to her while proceeding on ML, unless otherwise communicated in writing by her concerned Appraiser.

(h) Remuneration:

ML is granted on full pay.

(i) Promotion & increments:

On re-joining, a woman shall be eligible for any promotion and/or to receive increment/s which would have been paid to her, had she not been on ML.

(j) Dismissal during absence of pregnancy:

When a woman absents herself from work in accordance with the provisions of the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 (as amended or re-enacted from time to time), it shall be unlawful to discharge or dismiss her during or on account of such absence or to give notice of discharge or dismissal on such a day that the notice will expire during such absence, or to vary to her disadvantage any of the conditions of her service.

(k) Prohibition of 'Moonlighting' or dual employment:

A woman on ML if engages in any other employment/business for consideration (in cash/kind) directly/indirectly on her own/with any other person (including relative) during ML, then it will amount to breach of Code of Conduct Policy and notwithstanding sub-clause 11 above, appropriate disciplinary actions will be taken on her, including termination from services of the Company.

F. Paternity Leave (PL)

Policy:	Leave Policy
Sub-policy:	Paternity Leave (PL) Policy
Date of issue:	April 01, 2017
Effective Date:	April 01, 2017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

The purpose of Paternity Leave (PL) is to allow an eligible male employee a period of paid leave to bond with and take care of his newly-born child and spouse.

2. Applicability:

This policy shall be applicable to every male employee with less than two surviving children and who is under any of the Staff types 'Member' under all categories and who is not serving under notice period of resignation/termination.

3. Norms:

- (a) PL to be applied fifteen days before or upto six months from the date of delivery to the Appraiser. The male employee can avail a maximum of 15 days of PL. This leave may be availed upto the child being 6 months old. PL can be taken in parts.
- (b) Paternity leave shall not be debited against the leave account (CL, SL & EL) and will be recorded separately.
- (c) Employee shall submit the birth certificate of the child to avail this leave. PL shall not be refused normally.
- (d) Prefixing and suffixing the weekly offs with full day PL shall result in treating the -weekly offs as PL.
- (e) PL Salary shall be equal to last pay drawn.

An employee on PL if engages in any other employment/business for consideration (in cash/kind) directly/indirectly on his own/with any other person (including relative) during PL, then it will amount to misconduct and appropriate disciplinary actions will be taken including termination from services of the Company.

G. Annual/ Public Holidays

Policy:	Leave Policy
Sub-policy:	Annual/Public Holidays
Date of issue:	April 01, 2017
Effective Date:	April 01, 2017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

India, being a culturally diverse and fervent society, observes various holidays and celebrates various festivals. In order to honour this cultural diversity among our employees, this policy offers optional holidays for various festivals.

2. Norms:

- (a) The Company shall, by January 01 each calendar year announce a list of optional Holidays.
- (b) January 26 (Republic Day), April 14 (Dr. Ambedkar Jayanti- a social justice movement day), May 01 (Maharashtra Diwas and Labour Day) and August 15 (Independence Day) shall be mandatory public holidays for the Company. In case any of the four mandatory holiday/s fall on any bi-weekly off/ Sundays, then additional day/s will accordingly be allowed as optional holiday. October 02 is a national holiday and will be celebrated by the Company for sharing Company's Actionable Knowledge among all its employees in a Half-yearly Meet as a tribute to Mahatma Gandhi.
- (c) Employees shall be given option to choose from the announced list of optional holidays for minimum six annual holidays (plus the number out of four mandatory holiday/s that fall on any weekly offs). All employees shall apply for their optional holidays in the employee portal by January 05 each year. The chosen option may be changed by the employee with prior intimation to the concerned appraiser.
- (d) In case, any optional holidays announced by the Company falls on Friday/Monday, and an employee chooses an option/s prefixing and/or suffixing weekly off days, then no additional day of leave will be deducted. However, an employee may avoid taking continuous holidays attached to weekly off days and try to ensure that there are no major disruptions in the work during his/her absence.
- (e) Any change in the date of holidays in respect of Idu'l Fitr, Idu'l Zuha, Muharram and Id-e-Milad, if necessary, depending upon sighting of the Moon, would be declared by the Company. It may happen that the change of date of the above occasions has to be declared at a very short notice. In such a situation, announcement could be made through email communication.
- (f) The total number of holidays under this policy shall not exceed 10 in any calendar year.

H. On Duty Leave (ODL)

Policy:	Leave Policy
Sub-policy:	On Duty Leave (ODL) Policy
Date of issue:	September 27, 2018
Effective Date:	October 01, 2018
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

An employee may have to travel outside the place of his/her posting for official work. The travel for official work may be to other city or within the city (place) of posting, but outside the office premises. It is necessary that the concerned appraiser is aware of such travel. Further, an employee can claim Daily Allowance (DA) under the DA Policy in case of official travel, only if he/she has applied for 'On Duty Leave' (ODL).

2. Norms:

- (a) An employee shall apply for ODL in the Online Leave Application System for the Hours or day(s) of travel for official work at place other than his/her office of posting. 'Official work means' activity necessary to the performance of the employee's job duties. It includes attending/participating in seminars, conferences, trainings, exhibitions, events, etc. sponsored/approved by the Company.
- (b) ODL should be applied prior to undertaking such official travel, except in case of unplanned urgent business exigencies and/or exceptional circumstances. The ODL should be approved by the Appraiser of the concerned employee.
- (c) Incase ODL is disapproved by the concerned Appraiser for valid reasons, but employee has already remained absent/remains absent, then for such absence, leave/s shall be deducted from Casual Leave/Earned Leave balance, if balance is available, otherwise treated as 'Leave without Pay'.
- (d) Incase an employee travels for official work at place other than his/her office of posting, but does not apply for ODL within specified period, then for such absence, leave/s shall be deducted from Casual Leave/Earned Leave balance, if balance is available, otherwise treated as 'Leave without Pay'.
- (e) There are certain regional events such as "Anant Chaturdashi"/"Pandharichi Vari"/"Moharram" leading to traffic disruptions. Some employees face difficulties in reaching the office on such days. Hence, for upto four days in a calendar year, the affected employees, with the prior approval of the concerned appraiser, may work from home by applying for "On Duty Leave (Special)" for such day/s.

I. Compensatory Off (CO)

Policy:	Leave Policy
Sub-policy:	Compensatory off (CO) Policy
Date of issue:	April 01, 2017
Effective Date:	April 01, 2017
Last revision Date:	September 19, 2024
Effective date of revision:	October 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.2

1. Objective:

To establish norms for providing Compensatory Off (CO) to employees for working on Annual holidays/weekly off days ('holidays').

2. Norms:

- (a) As a rule, an employee should not be normally called to work on a holiday.
- (b) If an employee is required to work full day due to organizational necessity on a holiday, he/she is eligible for Compensatory off (CO) on any other working day.
- (c) Prior approval of the concerned appraiser shall be required to work on a holiday. No COs will be entertained when worked on these days without appraiser's prior approval. However, prior approval shall not be required incase the appraiser himself/herself wants the concerned employee to work on a holiday.
- (d) If an employee is required to work at workplace due to organizational necessity on a holiday for some hours (less than four hours), he/she is eligible for half-day CO on any other working day, subject to approval of the concerned appraiser. Further, if an employee is required to work at workplace for more than four hours on a holiday, he/she is eligible for full day CO on any other working day, subject to approval of the concerned appraiser.
- (e) Incase of organizational exigency, an Appraiser (subject to prior approval of the Managing Director) can require his/her Appraisee to 'work from home' (WFH) on a holiday or beyond employee's normal office hours. However, for such exceptional WFH on a holiday or beyond office hours, CO for the same can be applied only for maximum two days in a calendar year.
- (f) The CO can be availed only till the end of the concerned calendar year i.e. December 31 and incase not availed, shall lapse. CO cannot be encashed.
- (g) Other norms of Casual Leave shall apply *mutatis mutandis* ('the necessary changes having been made').

J. Leave Without Pay (LWP)

Policy:	Leave Policy
Sub-policy:	Leave Without Pay (LWP) Policy
Date of issue:	April 01, 2017
Effective Date:	April 01, 2017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.2

1. Objective:

To provide a facility where no other leave is available, and leave is required for exceptional reasons.

2. Norms:

- (a) A maximum of 3 months of LWP can be requested in a calendar year subject to prior recommendation by the Appraiser and prior approval by the Managing Director in exceptional cases.
 - (b) During the period of LWP, an employee is not entitled for any pay/allowance/increments/perquisites/other facilities.
 - (c) If the employee fails to report to duty on the specified date after the sanctioned LWP, it shall be deemed that the employee has abandoned his/her service with the Company on his/her own accord and norms regarding misconduct for 'unauthorized absence' will be invoked unless the employee is able to cite and submit sufficient evidence of exceptional circumstances.
 - (d) LWP days will not be considered for Earned Leave eligibility and EL credits. Also no increments/other remuneration and remuneration related payments shall be given for the period of LWP.
-

K. Absence From Duty

Policy:	Leave Policy
Sub-policy:	Absence From Duty Policy
Date of issue:	April 01, 2017
Effective Date:	April 01, 2017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

To specify a policy where an employee is absent from duty except on approved leave.

2. Norms:

- (a) When an employee remains absent from duty without prior leave approval or proper intimation to concerned Appraiser, then those days will be treated as 'Absence from duty'. Continued absence from duty without approved leave and proper authorization will be considered as 'misconduct' and may lead to termination of employment.
- (b) In case of continuing absence from duty for less than 7 calendar days, the employee shall report to his/her Appraiser on rejoining duty from absence and provide valid reasons for absence in writing before re-joining work again. The Appraiser, if satisfied with the reasons, will inform HRD (hrd@mkcl.org) and recommend to allow the employee to rejoin. HRD shall seek approval of the Managing Director and in case allowed by the Managing Director, the employee shall apply for available leave or for 'Leave without pay' for the days of absence. In case the Appraiser is not satisfied with the reasons, he/she shall refer the matter to HRD in writing, HRD then shall report to the Key Management Team (KMT) and take actions as directed by the KMT including pay deduction for unauthorized leave.
- (c) In case of continuous unauthorized absence from duty exceeding 7 working days, the employee shall not be entitled for any remuneration, remuneration related payments, reimbursements, perquisites and other facilities for that period.
- (d) If an employee is absent from duty continuously for more than 7 working days, the concerned Appraiser shall immediately inform vide email to HRD of such unauthorized absence. A Notice from HRD will be sent to the absconding employee at his last known address, official email id and personal email id (if available) asking to report to duty and to provide explanation for his/her unauthorized absence. The Notification to the employee should mention that his/her absence is unauthorized and that failure to report for duty or otherwise explain about exceptional circumstances of the absence by a specified date will result in the cessation of employment. The proposed date of effect for the cessation must be included in the written Notice.
- (e) In response to the written notice of unauthorized absence, the employee may explain

his/her absence in writing at any time prior to the cessation date specified in the notification. On receipt of any explanation the Key Management Team (KMT) may:

- accept the explanation and, if necessary, grant the employee leave for a further period of absence on such conditions specified; or
- reject the explanation and require the employee to return to duty by a date specified.

If the employee does not return to duty by the specified date his/her employment will automatically cease on the following day.

- (f) If there is no response from the employee within the stipulated time mentioned in the Notice, the Company is entitled to treat the employee as absconding and the employment as having been terminated by the employee at his/her initiative. In such case, no dues viz. salary, gratuity, leave encashment etc. shall be paid to the absconding terminated employee, no relieving letter issued, no experience certificate issued by the Company. Further, in case the employee does not return assets of the Company viz. laptop, then actions as felt appropriate by KMT will be taken.
 - (g) Notwithstanding anything stated above, incase an employee is prevented by sudden illness, accident, injury or other emergency from attending duty, it shall not be regarded as absent without authorization, if he/she reports the absence as soon as practicable and provides satisfactory evidence that the absence was unavoidable. In such exceptional case, the KMT shall take appropriate decision.
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L. Leave Approval Policy

Policy:	Leave Policy
Sub-policy:	Leave Approval Policy
Date of issue:	April 01, 2017
Effective Date:	April 01, 2017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

To ensure a transparent, unbiased and unambiguous process for leave approval.

2. Norms:

(a) Procedure for applying leave:

The available leave balance is to be checked by the employee in his/her individual login on the Employee Portal and the leave shall be applied thereon. The intimation of application will be forwarded to the concerned Appraiser through system who shall either approve or disapprove the applied leave within reasonable period, ideally 48 hours. Incase of disapproval, valid reasons be given. The appropriate authority shall then confirm the leave.

(b) Deemed approval:

Incuse an employee has made prior leave application, but the concerned Appraiser neither approves nor disapproves the application till the date of intended leave, then the applied leave shall be deemed to have been approved, subject to available leave balance.

(c) Cancellation of leave:

The concerned employee can apply for cancellation of leave before availing the same. The appraiser can also cancel the sanctioned leave incase of organizational necessity. Incase the attendance of an employee is recorded on day for which he has previously applied for leave, it shall not automatically result in cancellation of leave. Employee has to specifically apply for cancellation of previously applied/approved leave and concerned appraiser shall approve/reject the cancellation.

If an employee proceeds to avail the cancelled leave, then those day/s will be treated as 'unauthorized absence from duty' and will be considered as misconduct. Appropriate actions will be taken as directed by the Key Management Team, including pay deduction for such unauthorized absence.

6. REIMBURSEMENT & ALLOWANCES

A. Business Expenses Reimbursement Policy

Policy:	Reimbursement Policy
Sub-policy:	Business Expenses Reimbursement Policy
Date of issue:	June 28, 2024
Effective Date:	July 01, 2024
Last revision Date:	---
Effective date of revision:	---
Version no.:	1.0

1. Objective:

The objective of this policy is to reimburse employees as per below norms for necessary and reasonable business-related expenses. The reimbursements are for an employee's business expenses paid or incurred in the performance of services as an employee.

2. Norms:

- (a) Employees are expected to exercise prudent business judgment regarding expenses covered by this policy. No policy can anticipate every situation that might give rise to legitimate business expenses. Reasonable and necessary expenses may be incurred. Each employee must use his/her best professional judgment in determining if an expense is reimbursable under this policy and in case of any doubt, seek advice of concerned Appraiser.
- (b) "Business expenses" means –
 - there is the expectation of deriving some current or future legitimate benefit for the Company.
 - the employee is actively engaged in a business meeting or activity necessary to the performance of the employee's job duties;
 - there is a clear business purpose for travel, extending hospitality, etc.
- (c) The Company supports 'no alcohol consumption' and 'no tobacco use' initiatives, as such no reimbursements will be made towards such expenses in case incurred by the employee, if any.
- (d) Claims for reimbursement of business expenses (including any tax paid) by employee by any mode viz. Cash, Credit Card, Debit Card, etc. be submitted with original receipts, bills, requisite supporting documents in the same month or latest by the 5th day of the next month through employee portal and hard copies as well. The claims submitted shall be duly reviewed and recommended (or otherwise) by the Appraiser of the concerned employee. In case, later during scrutiny and audit, it is found that the claims are not allowable business expenses and/or not supported by requisite documents, both the employee and the concerned Appraiser shall give requisite explanation/clarification to the Chief Executive Officer (CEO). In case, the CEO is satisfied, s/he shall recommend the reimbursement, else, it will be referred to the Managing Director.

- (e) All business expenses be substantiated with adequate records. This substantiation must include information relating to -
 - (f) the name of the concerned Program (also Project if possible)
 - (g) the amount, date and place of the expenditure,
 - (h) the business purpose of the expenditure
the names and the business relationships of individuals for whom the expenditures were made.
 - (i) Corporate Credit cards may be issued to employees for official purposes from time to time, subject to approval by the Board and that requisite supporting documents for amounts expended, if any, are submitted to the Company at the end of each month by the concerned employee.
 - (j) Reimbursement for expenses that are not in compliance with this policy requires the written approval of the Managing Director.
 - (k) Re-imbursement shall be made on monthly basis by electronic payment to the concerned employee's salary Account/specified Bank Account.
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B. Mobile Phone and Internet Charges Reimbursement Policy

Policy:	Reimbursement Policy
Sub-policy:	Mobile Phone and Internet Charges Reimbursement Policy
Date of Issue:	October 07, 2019
Effective Date:	October 01, 2019
Last revision Date:	March 06, 2025
Effective date of revision:	April 01, 2025
Version no.:	1.2

1. Objective:

The objective of this policy is to facilitate the Employees in their jobs by increasing communication within the organization and especially with the customers and all other stakeholders. All eligible employees shall be reimbursed payments made for mobile phone bills and/or wireless internet USB modem as per following norms, considering that the calls are made normally for official purpose and during the course of discharge of official responsibilities.

2. Norms:

- (a) Mobile phone will be purchased by eligible employees at their own cost and as per their own choice. The Company shall not bear any expenses for the Mobile phone.
- (b) Eligible employees may purchase USB/Wifi Modem as per their own choice and will be 'one time' reimbursed up to Rs.2000/- for the same. However, some Service Providers offer free USB/Wifi Modems, if registered as Corporate Accounts and an employee may request for availing the same instead of personally purchasing the USB/Wifi Modem. In such cases, the devices will be obtained in Company name, but the monthly charges shall be paid in time by the concerned employee. In case of separation, the employee shall return back the USB/Wifi Modem to the Company and the Company shall take necessary actions for discontinuing the number in the name of the concerned employee.
- (c) Eligible employees can select service-provider of their own choice.
- (d) An employee may have several registered numbers in his/her name, however, monthly reimbursement will be made on submission of bills and proof of payments for one mobile number only which is appearing in the records of the Company. Further, monthly reimbursement will be made for one internet connection only.
- (e) Eligible employees and their respective permissible amounts for re-imbursement on monthly basis for mobile phone bills and/or internet bills are as follows-
 - Program Leader, Senior Program Coordinator, Program Coordinator - total up to Rs.3000/- per month;
 - Any other employee as recommended by the concerned Senior Program Coordinator based on role - total up to Rs.1500/- per month.

- (f) The Company shall not reimburse extra charges for late payment in case of payment by the concerned employee after due date.
 - (g) When an employee travels abroad for official purpose, the mobile number of such employee shall be activated for International Roaming during such travel period and deposit amount, if any, shall be paid by the Company. On return of employee to India, the facility shall be de-activated and refund of deposit amount obtained or deposit amount adjusted against future bills (subject to limits mentioned in pt. no.5 above).
 - (h) In case of foreign travel, HRD shall inform the upper limit of re-imbursement to the concerned employee. Any amount in excess of the specified amount shall be reimbursed only if approved by the Managing Director, otherwise will have to be borne by the concerned employee.
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C. Domestic Travel Policy

Policy:	Reimbursement Policy
Sub-policy:	Domestic Travel Policy
Date of issue:	June 28, 2024
Effective Date:	July 01, 2024
Last revision Date:	March 06, 2025
Effective date of revision:	April 01, 2025
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objectives:

The objective of this policy is to reimburse/provide necessary travel arrangements to employees as per below norms for necessary business-related domestic travel expenses. The reimbursements are for an employee's domestic official travel expenses paid or incurred in the performance of services as an employee or providing necessary travel arrangements.

2. Fuel Reimbursement:

- (a) At times, employees may use their own vehicle for official work. The Company in such cases will give fuel reimbursement to employee who uses his/her own vehicle for official work. Employees can use own two-wheeler/four-wheeler for official work (to-fro travel for place of work is excluded hereunder) within the city of place of posting.
- (b) Employees may also use own four-wheeler for inter-city travel for official work. However, employees other than Program Leaders, Senior Program Coordinators, Program Coordinators shall obtain prior approval of Senior Program Coordinator of concerned Program stating the reasons and justification for undertaking such travel instead of using public transport services.
- (c) Employee who uses own vehicle for official work as above, will be given fuel expenses reimbursement at below rate, subject to approval by concerned Appraiser.

Type	Amount in Rupees per km
Two wheeler	08.00
Four wheeler	16.00

- (d) The fuel expenses reimbursement claim should be submitted by the employee within 10 working days from use of own vehicle. Details of date and purpose of official work, start km, end km should be mentioned. The photo of the start and end km should be attached. The concerned Appraiser shall be responsible for verification of authenticity of the said claim.
- (e) In case of carpooling, claim by only the employee car owner should be submitted. The other accompanying employees may within themselves settle the shared expenses of fuel. All

fuel expenses reimbursement claims received from an employee, will be processed for payment on monthly basis.

- 3. Domestic Travel:** Domestic official travel can be undertaken by an employee as per below eligibility and the expenses will be reimbursed on actuals or the travel arrangements can be made by the Company:

Category	Travel Entitlements (On actuals)
(a) Program Leaders, Senior Program Coordinators, Program Coordinators	Economy Class by Air (prior intimation to MD)/AC first Class or below by railway (or waterway)/Any type of road public transport (including air-conditioned)/AC Taxi/ Cab/other Private mode by road.
(b) Employees other than (a) above	AC II Tier Class or below by railway (or waterway) /Any type of road public transport (including air-conditioned). For AC Taxi/Cab/other Private mode by road or Economy Class by Air, to be prior justified, recommended by concerned Appraiser and prior approved by concerned Senior General Manager vide email with c.c. to F & A Head.

D. Reimbursement Policy for Certifications, Professional Memberships, attending Professional Events

Policy:	Reimbursement Policy
Sub-policy:	Reimbursement Policy for Certifications, Professional Memberships, attending Professional events
Date of issue:	May 28, 2021
Effective Date:	June 01, 2021
Last revision Date:	September 19, 2024
Effective date of revision:	October 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.2

1. Objectives:

Maharashtra Knowledge Corporation Limited (MKCL) encourages employees to enhance knowledge and skills. MKCL recognizes that certification gives recognition of competency, shows commitment to the profession and is necessary for the organization to be in readiness to the dynamically changing world. Further, for professional development, employees may need to attend professional events like conferences, seminars, workshops, etc. (hereinafter referred to as “Professional events”). Also, for continuing to discharge professional responsibilities, it may be necessary for an employee to pay annual membership fees of certain Institutes, Bodies, etc. (hereinafter referred to as “Professional Memberships”). Thus, the purpose of this policy is to specify norms of reimbursements of expenses for all the above stated purposes.

2. Applicability:

This Policy is applicable to all full-time employees of the Company who have been in employment of the Company for at least one continuous year, who are not under probation period and/or notice period of separation and are under Staff Type ‘Member’.

3. Norms:

(1) Eligible employees will be reimbursed as per below norms:

a. Professional Memberships

- i. Where it is mandatory for an employee to continue to be a Member of certain Institutes, Bodies, etc. like The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI), The Institute of Company Secretaries of India (ICSI), The Institute of Cost & Work Accountants of India (ICWA), etc. for discharging on-job professional responsibilities, the Company shall reimburse the Annual Membership fees on submission of claim by the concerned employee along with requisite supporting document.

b. Professional Certifications

- i. In case of undertaking Certifications/Certification Courses below Rs.5000/- (excluding GST) in a Financial Year, the concerned Appraiser will give approval as felt appropriate. In case Certifications/Certification Courses aggregating above Rs.5000/- in a Financial Year and employee has been in the services of the Company for at least 03 (Three) Financial Years, this Policy shall be applicable.
- ii. The maximum reimbursement limit for Certification per eligible employee per financial year will be as per conditions specified below. Any amount above the said limit, should be borne by the concerned employee-
 - employee should have been in the services of the Company for at least 10 (Ten) Financial Years for reimbursement above Rs.25000/- upto Rs.50,000/-;
 - employee should have been in the services of the Company for at least 05 (Five) Financial Years – for reimbursement above Rs.15000/- upto Rs.25,000/-;
 - employee should have been in the services of the Company for at least 03 (Three) Financial Years – for reimbursement above Rs.5000/- upto Rs.15,000/-.
- iii. Certifications/Certification Courses do not include regular Degree/Diploma Courses. Further, reimbursement for Technical Certifications do not include training fees, but only certification fees.
- iv. The Certification selected by an employee should have a direct relationship to the work responsibilities. The employee must provide a Certification request note that outlines details of the Certification, the benefits to be gained by the Company as a result of such certification, the total Certification Fees, the period within which to be completed, and the same be submitted to the concerned Appraiser for recommendations. In case the Appraiser recommends, the Certification request Note be forwarded to the –
 - Chief Executive Officer (CEO) in case of non-Technical Professional certification for recommendation.
 - Chief Technology Officer (CTO) in case of Technical Professional certification for recommendation. Recommendation and approval can also be sought by concerned Program Leader for an Annual Plan of concerned Team Members, specifying tentative upper limit.
- v. The recommendations by the CEO/CTO will be forwarded to the Managing Director for consideration. In case of Technical Certifications, the CTO will provide a comparative analysis along with the recommendations. In case, the Managing Director gives approval, the concerned employee can undergo the Certification Course. Recommendation and/or approval can be for reimbursement of partial/full Certification Fees. The Company on receipt of reimbursement claim, reimburse the Certification fees on successful completion as per prior approval of the Managing Director. In case the request is not approved, the employee may undertake the Certification at his/her own expense without claiming reimbursement.
- vi. If, the employee who has availed reimbursement under this Policy is separated (including due to resignation, termination) from the services of the Company for whatsoever reasons (but excluding retirement)-

- in case of Software Technical Member, within two years from obtaining certification/s (latest Certification in case of multiple Certifications) ;
- within one year (in any other case) from obtaining certification/s

Then the Company shall recover the full amount of reimbursement made previously from the amounts due to such employee. In case, from such due amounts, the reimbursement amount cannot be fully recovered, then the concerned employee shall make payment to the Company for such balance amount on settlement of which only the Company will issue relieving letter and experience certificate subject to compliance of applicable relieving formalities.

- vii. The Company may at times require that employees obtain certain Certifications and accordingly instruct identified employees to undertake and complete specified Certification Courses. In such cases, all above norms specified shall be applicable.
- viii. Reimbursement will be made only in case of completion of the approved Certificate Course.

c. Professional events

- ii. For professional development, leadership development, training, knowledge updates, skill enhancement, etc. employees may need to attend professional events like conferences, seminars, workshops, etc. It is necessary that such Professional events should have a direct relationship to the work profile and work responsibilities of the employee.
- iii. The concerned employee will submit a Request Note to the concerned Appraiser specifying the details of the Professional event, its relevance to job role and responsibilities, dates of event, approximate expenses for participation fees, travel, accommodation, etc.
- iv. In case the Fees are below Rs.5000/- (excluding GST) in a Financial Year, the concerned Appraiser will give approval as felt appropriate. In case the Fees are above Rs.5000/- (excluding GST) in a Financial Year, the concerned Appraiser will give recommendations. The Request Note be then forwarded to the CEO for non-Technical Member Staff and to the CTO for Technical Member Staff. The recommendations by the CEO/CTO will be forwarded to the Managing Director for consideration. In case, the Managing Director gives approval, the concerned employee can participate in the professional event. The Company will, on receipt of reimbursement claim, reimburse the fees and other expenses accordingly.
- v. The employee shall ensure to comply with applicable norms, claim processes and policies viz. Daily Allowance, On Duty Leave, Business Expenses, etc.
 - i. Claims for reimbursement by concerned employee be submitted with receipts, bills, requisite supporting documents in the same month or latest by the 5th day of the next month through employee portal G10. The reimbursement claim will be settled as per Company's applicable accounts and audit processes.
 - ii. Employees holding Corporate Credit cards may make payments as per approvals and applicable norms of this Policy and 'Corporate Credit Card' Policy.

E. Policy for Reimbursement of Driver's Compensation

Policy:	Reimbursement Policy
Sub-policy:	Policy for Reimbursement of Driver's Compensation Policy
Date of issue:	October 31, 2017
Effective Date:	October 01, 2017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objectives:

As per "MKCL's Remuneration Policy 2017 for its Employees", re-imbursement of Driver's compensation may be given to Key Managerial Personnel, Chief Technology Officer, Vice Presidents, Senior General Managers, Senior Program Co-ordinators, General Managers as felt appropriate by the Key Management Team ("KMT") constituted by the Board from time to time.

It is necessary that reasonable compensation is paid to Drivers whose full-time services are engaged by the employees of the Company.

2. Norms:

- (a) Eligible employees can engage services of Driver of his/her own choice. Such employee should ensure that the Driver has:
 - a. valid 4 wheeler driving license,
 - b. good expertise and experience in driving a 4 wheeler vehicle,
 - c. aadhaar card,
 - d. requisite fitness,
 - e. no infectious or chronic diseases,
 - f. no smoking or alcoholic or such other addiction,
 - g. age below 60 years,
 - h. medical insurance policy and
 - i. accident insurance policy.
- (b) In order to ensure his/her own safety, it is desirable that concerned employee runs a 'background check' of the concerned individual before engaging the individual's services as a Driver. The Driver engaged by the eligible employee, will not be treated as the employee of the Company and under any circumstances, shall not claim permanency benefits in the Company.
- (c) The annual service term of the Driver shall be considered from October 01 of each calendar year to September 30 of the subsequent calendar year.
- (d) The amount of Consolidated Monthly Compensation (CMC) to be paid to the Driver shall be fixed as per the norms given below:

- a. The CMC of a Driver may be fixed based on the date of issuance of his/her driving license and number of completed years of his/her post-license 4 wheeler driving experience.
 - b. In case of 'number of completed years of post-license driving experience' falling between 0 to 4 years, CMC shall not exceed 1.2 times Rs.15000/- i.e. Rs.18000/-.
 - c. In case of 'number of completed years of post-license driving experience' is equal to or greater than 4 years, CMC shall be decided by using the Pay Table (attached herewith in Annexure 'A' with First Level Pay of Rs.18000 per month) as a broad guideline only to serve as an objective rationale and not as a basis for any claims of any allowances and/or benefits as certain percentage Level Pay.
 - d. The CMC to the Driver with 'n' completed years of post-license driving experience shall not exceed 1.2 times Level Pay at Level 'n-3' (n minus 3) in the Pay Table in Annexure 'A'.
 - e. The next revision of CMC of the serving Driver will fall due on October 01 each year and will be communicated by the concerned employee to the F & A Head .
 - f. The next revised CMC to a serving Driver may be fixed at 1.2 times the Level Pay at next Level of Pay Table after every completed year of post-license driving experience.
 - g. An amount equal to one CMC will be reimbursed every year by the Company to the eligible employee on pro-rata basis of completed number of months w.e.f. October 01 of the previous calendar year to September 30 of each year in the month of 'Diwali Festival' for annual gratuitous payment to the Driver.
- (e) In case of outstation travel, Rs.600/- per full day or Rs.300/- per half day as applicable, paid as food allowance to the driver, will be reimbursed to the concerned employee.
- (f) In case of overnight stay for outstation official travel, if the guest house facility of the Company is available, then the same can be availed free of cost by the Driver of concerned employee. However, if such facility is not available, then the concerned employee will have to make his/her own arrangements for Driver's overnight stay at his own cost. The Company will make no reimbursements for such expenses.
- (g) The concerned employee shall forward to the Company a copy of the driving license of the Driver and Aadhaar Card, communicate in writing the CMC proposed by him/her, and the same shall remain unchanged from October of each calendar year to September of the subsequent calendar year. The F & A Head shall scrutinize the documents submitted by the concerned employee, seek clarifications, if required, and approve the proposed fitment.
- (h) The employee shall ensure that the Driver obtains Medical Insurance Policy and Accident Insurance Policy for sum assured amounts of Rs. 2 Lacs and Rs. 5 Lacs respectively. The premium amounts for the same will be reimbursed by the employee to the Driver in the month of October (subject to such Driver continuing to rendering services) and the Company shall further reimburse such premium amounts to the employee in the same month.
- Such reimbursement by the employee to the Driver and further reimbursement by the Company to the eligible employee shall be subject to completion of one year from October 01 of the previous calendar year to September 30 of the current calendar year.
- (i) The supporting documents as specified below should be submitted by the concerned employee to the F & A Head for claiming reimbursements under this policy:
- a. One Time: Copy of Valid Driving License and Aadhaar Card of the proposed Driver

- b. Monthly: Monthly supporting documents in hard copy to be submitted before 5th day of the next month:
- Reimbursement Claim form duly filled in, signed and uploaded on employee portal viz. G10;
 - Copy of bank statement of Driver and MKCL's cash voucher signed by the Driver evidencing receipt of CMC;
 - MKCL's cash voucher/s signed by the Driver acknowledging receipt of food allowance.
- c. Annual: Annual supporting documents in hard copy to be submitted in the month of November:
- Reimbursement Claim form duly filled in, signed and uploaded on employee portal viz. G10;
 - Copy of medical and accident insurance policies, premium receipt/s, Bank statement of Driver and MKCL's cash voucher signed by the driver evidencing receipt of insurance premium reimbursements.
 - Copy of Bank statement of driver and MKCL's cash voucher signed by the Driver evidencing receipt of gratuitous payment on occasion of 'Diwali Festival'.

The Managing Director shall have discretion to modify the norms for specific individual cases and/or for specific events.

On behalf of the Company, the Managing Director reserves the right to use at no extra cost the driving services of the Driver of the eligible employee for Company exigencies/emergencies in consultation with the employee and after taking utmost care to cause minimal inconvenience to the employee.

The Managing Director shall have the discretion to amend this policy from time to time in the overall interest of the organization.

Annexure A -Pay Table

Level	Year of Post-License Driving Experience	Level Pay (in Rupees)
1.	4 to 5	18000
2.	5 to 6	19100
3.	6 to 7	19700
4.	7 to 8	20300
5.	8 to 9	21100
6.	9 to 10	22100
7.	10 to 11	22800
8.	11 to 12	23500
9.	12 to 13	25200
10.	13 to 14	26000
11.	14 to 15	26800
12.	15 to 16	27900
13.	16 to 17	28800
14.	17 to 18	29700
15.	18 to 19	30600
16.	19 to 20	31900
17.	20 to 21	33900
18.	21 to 22	35000
19.	22 to 23	36100
20.	23 to 24	37200
21.	24 to 25	38600
22.	25 to 26	39800
23.	26 to 27	41000
24.	27 to 28	42300
25.	28 to 29	44900
26.	29 to 30	46800
27.	30 to 31	48500
28.	31 to 32	50000
29.	32 to 33	51500
30.	33 to 34	53100
31.	34 to 35	54700
32.	35 to 36	56800
33.	36 to 37	60300
34.	37 to 38	62200
35.	38 to 39	64100
36.	39 to 40	66600

*This table may be extended on the same logic if it is found that drivers are getting saturated at the last level pay but have not turned age 60 years yet.

F. Vehicle Parking Facility Policy

Policy:	Reimbursement Policy
Sub-policy:	Vehicle Parking Facility Policy
Date of issue:	October 07, 2019
Effective Date:	October 01, 2019
Last revision Date:	March 06, 2025
Effective date of revision:	April 01, 2025
Version no.:	1.2

1. Objective:

The Company has its offices at various locations. At certain locations, paid-parking facility is provided by concerned Parking Facility Provider ("PFP"). To facilitate the employees working at such locations, the Company shall issue parking passes/reimburse parking expenses as per below norms:

2. Norms for employees in 'Member Development Staff' Type in the Pay Level 5 and above (hereinafter referred as "Sr. Member/s"):

- (a) A Sr. Member who regularly travels to and fro office using own four-wheeler and parks the same in the paid-parking area of the office premises, shall be provided four-wheeler parking pass, if issued by the concerned PFP or shall be reimbursed four-wheeler parking charges on monthly basis for number of 'working days' of the concerned employee.
- (b) A Sr. member who regularly travels to and fro office using two-wheeler and parks the same in the paid-parking area of the office premise, shall be provided two-wheeler parking pass, if issued by the concerned PFP or shall be reimbursed two- wheeler parking charges on monthly basis for number of 'working days' of the concerned employee.
- (c) A Sr. Member may travel to and fro office by four-wheeler on certain days and by two-wheeler on some other days. However, only one pass will be given to the member based on his/her choice.

3. Norms for Employees other than Sr. Members:

- (a) An Employee who regularly travels to and fro office using two- wheeler and parks the same in the paid-parking area of the office premises, shall be provided two-wheeler parking pass, if issued by the concerned PFP or shall be reimbursed parking charges on monthly basis for number of 'working days' of the concerned employee.
- (b) In case an employee has not been issued a two-wheeler pass and regularly travels to and fro office using four-wheeler, parks the same at his/her own expense in the paid-parking area of the office premises, then parking charges at the rate for two-wheeler shall be reimbursed. Such employee can attach receipt for four-wheeler parking pass charges paid

by him/her for claiming reimbursement of parking charges at the rate for two-wheeler.

4. General Norms:

- (a) The Company is not responsible for providing committed parking space in the parking area, including in case of issue of 'parking pass' and employees shall manage for the same on their own.
- (b) The Company is not responsible for the safety of the employees' vehicles parked in the parking area and they park at their own risk.
- (c) An Employees shall inform the vehicle number, vehicle type (four-wheeler or two-wheeler as applicable) and other requisite details to the Company and in case of changes in the same, inform the revised details immediately.
- (d) The parking pass is non-transferrable.
- (e) In case the pass is lost or damaged, then the concerned employee shall bear the charges for re-issue.
- (f) Reimbursement of parking charges shall be at actuals on monthly basis and employee shall submit duly filled, signed reimbursement claim form with parking charges receipts latest by 5th day of the next month.
- (g) No reimbursement of parking charges shall be given in case a parking pass has already been issued to the concerned employee.
- (h) An employee, in case of separation/transfer to other location, shall return the parking pass to the concerned Center Manager and obtain acknowledgement for the same before being relieved from the services of the Company or relocating to the new office.

5. Consistency Between Conveyance Reimbursement and Parking Pass Facilities:

Notwithstanding anything stated above, the below norms shall be applicable for maintaining consistency between Conveyance Reimbursement and Parking Pass Facilities-

These norms are applicable to Sr. Members. As per the Annual Reimbursement of Conveyance Expenses Policy:

"Conveyance Reimbursement up to Rs.1,20,000/- may be paid annually to *"the Sr. Member"* for her/his to and/or fro travel between *"the Sr. Member's"* official residence and MKCL office at the place of posting of *"the Sr. Member"* towards cab/rickshaw rentals. The reimbursement shall be subject to submitting valid supporting documents such as bills.

However, as per clause 2 above, the Sr. Members can avail Parking Pass facility as well. In order to make these two policies viz. the Annual Reimbursement of Conveyance Expenses Policy and the Vehicle Parking Facility Policy mutually consistent, the following norms shall be applicable to Sr. Members:

1. The Sr. Member shall choose one of the following options i.e. either

- a. a two-wheeler/four-wheeler parking pass (whichever applicable) or
- b. reimbursement for cab/rickshaw rentals.

The selected choice shall remain valid till March 31 each year.

- 2. Sr. Members opting for cab/rickshaw rental reimbursement shall return parking pass issued to them to the concerned Center Manager.
 - 3. If the parking pass is not returned and a cab/rickshaw reimbursement during the month is also claimed, then the Company will recover the parking pass charges paid to the PFP for that month from the concerned Sr. Member.
 - 4. In the month of March, each year, the Google Form link will be sent, and option can be selected for the next financial year.
 - 5. Any changes in the selected option, if requested during the financial year will be considered subject to availability of parking passes.
 - 6. In case, parking passes are not available at the time of request for a change in option, parking charges shall be reimbursed at actuals on a monthly basis. For claiming this reimbursement, the Sr. Member shall submit on a monthly basis a duly filled in and signed reimbursement claim form with supporting document such as parking charge receipts latest by the 5th day of the next calendar month.
 - 7. Any request for change in option during an ongoing calendar month will not be acceded to.
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G. Daily Allowance (DA) Policy for Domestic Official Travel

Policy:	Allowance Policy
Sub-policy:	Daily Allowance (DA) Policy for Domestic Official Travel
Date of issue:	September 06, 2017
Effective Date:	September 06, 2017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objectives:

The Company pays a reasonable sum of money as Daily Allowance (“DA”) to cover **food expenses** that an employee incurs on a domestic official travel.

The main principles of this policy are-

- Self-certification of expenses by concerned employee.
- No employee shall accept any hospitality from any Network/Channel Partner/Client/Vendor of the Company.

2. Norms:

- Employees are eligible for DA in case of travel for official work at place other than their office of posting. ‘Official work means’ activity necessary to the performance of the employee's job duties.
- To claim DA, the concerned employee shall first apply for ‘On Duty’ Leave (OD) in the Online Leave Application System for the Hours or day(s) of official travel. Preferably, OD should be applied prior to undertaking such official travel, except in case of unplanned urgent business exigencies. The official travel should be approved by the Appraiser of the concerned employee.
- The DA does *not* cover the cost of travel, local travel, accommodation and other incidental expenses, if any, which shall be reimbursed on actuals as per the Company’s norms.
- A DA of total up to Rs.650/- per day for food, water and non-alcoholic beverages can be claimed with supporting bills by an employee, for being out of office for official work up to 6 hours.
- A DA of total up to Rs.1300/- per day for food, water and non-alcoholic beverages can be claimed with supporting bills by an employee, for being out of office for official work for more than 6 hours.
- In case of employees travelling in a group, when one employee pays for himself as well as on behalf of other employee/s, then the concerned other employee/s shall not claim for the same amounts in his/their DA claim/s. The employee submitting claim on behalf of the group, shall mention the names of all the employees in the group in the claim form. Further, in case of such group sharing, the total bill amount shall be considered to be equally divided among the group members for re-imbursement of additional DA claim for

the same official travel, and total permitted limit shall be applied to each employee. e.g. An employee 'A' is OD for more than 6 hours and is travelling in a group with two other employees 'B' and 'C'. In case 'A' pays for the lunch bill Rs.876/- for the entire group, then the permitted limit of Rs.1300/- for any additional permitted expenses by A, B and C reduces by Rs.292/- (i.e. Rs.876/3) each.

- (g) Alternatively, the employees travelling in a group may pay individually and submit to the Company individual DA claims with supporting bill/s.
 - (h) Employees visiting other offices of the Company, if provided bottled water/non-alcoholic beverages/breakfast/ snacks/ lunch/dinner by the Company, should not claim for the amounts for said item/s in their DA claim and mention about the same in the DA claim form in case reimbursement claimed for other items. Permitted DA limit of Rs.650/Rs.1300 as the case may be, will be reduced to the extent paid for by the Company. The concerned Center Manager shall prepare and submit on weekly basis an excel sheet with particulars viz. the date, name of concerned employee, nature of expenses (lunch/snacks, etc.), amount of expenses to F & A Head.
 - (i) In case of availing of room service and/or restaurant service at a Hotel in which the employee is staying, for any of the aforesaid services, the same are covered under DA and therefore should not be clubbed with Hotel/accommodation expenses. Separate bills for such services should be submitted with DA claim. Further, in case breakfast/lunch/dinner is included in the Hotel package and/or fees of conference, seminars, etc. in which the employee is participating (for which the Company is bearing the expenses), then the concerned employee shall not claim for such components.
 - (j) The DA claim shall be reimbursed on submission by the employee with requisite supporting documents and recommendation by the concerned Appraiser. The concerned Appraiser shall be responsible for verification of authenticity of the DA claim.
 - (k) Any food expense incurred for an accompanying non-employee person (for official work), including Director, Advisor, Consultant, Network Partner, Customer, Advocate, Driver of the vehicle, etc. can be claimed by the employee as business expense, subject to submission of supporting bill/s. The name/s of the accompanying person/s and the business relationship should be mentioned clearly in the claim form. The upper limit of Rs.650/- and Rs.1300/- mentioned above will normally apply to the food expenses incurred for the accompanying person/s as well. Every employee shall carry some blank Cash Voucher slips of the Company and in case the vendor is unable to give a bill, the concerned employee shall fill in the details in the cash voucher and obtain the vendor's seal and/or signature with his/her name written legibly on the voucher. If it is not possible to obtain the vendor's signature, reasons for the same be mentioned, and voucher be self-certified by the concerned employee.
 - (l) The DA claim should be submitted by the employee along with other travel expenses (if any) within 10 working days from the end of employee's travel.
 - (m) This Policy is not applicable to an employee availing benefits under the 'Transfer Policy'.
 - (n) The Managing Director shall have discretion to modify the norms for specific individual cases and/or for specific events viz. Air-travel, Company Meetings/events.
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H. Official Foreign Travel

Policy:	Reimbursement Policy
Sub-Policy:	Official Foreign Travel Policy
Date of issue:	June 28, 2024
Effective Date:	July 01, 2024
Last revision Date:	----
Effective date of revision:	---
Version no.:	1.0

1. Objectives:

Reasonable travel, accommodation, subsistence, and other expenses incurred by an employee in the execution of Company's business abroad and/or attending Seminars/Conferences/Trainings /Professional events abroad as approved by the Company, will be borne by/reimbursed by the Company. Reasonable expenses are defined as those that are cost effective weighed against the purpose of the business activity. Employees should be sensitive as to what is perceived as reasonable in the current business climate. It is not possible to set out rules for every conceivable situation and so you are required not only to adhere to the express terms in this policy, but also to exercise your judgment to ensure that all claims made are within the spirit of the policy. The Company reserves the right to reject or reduce claims that are excessive.

2. Norms:

1. ON DUTY LEAVE:

The concerned employee shall apply for 'On Duty' Leave (ODL) in the Employee Portal for day(s) of official travel. ODL should be applied prior to undertaking such official foreign travel. The official foreign travel should be approved by the Appraiser of the concerned employee.

2. TRAVEL:

- (a) **Air Travel** - Eligible Classes for Air Travel is normally Economy Class. Any Foreign Air Travel shall be prior approved by the Managing Director. Such specific approval need not be obtained in case any employee is travelling with the Managing Director as per his/her directions. In exceptional circumstances, the Managing Director may authorize business class travel and the reasons for business class travel must be appropriately documented by the concerned employee.
- (b) **Fully Flexible Tickets**-To be booked in exceptional circumstances only, with the reasons appropriately documented on the travel requisition and authorized by the Appraiser of the concerned employee.

- (c) **Flight Restrictions** - More than three Senior MKCL employees travelling on the same flight is a situation that should be avoided if possible.
- (d) **Travel booking Policy** - All foreign travel bookings must preferably be made by the Company.
- (e) **Combining Official and Personal Travel** - Any non-official travel undertaken on an official trip must be prior informed by the concerned employee. The employee travelling must bear the additional costs for personal travel.
- (f) **Emergencies** - In emergencies, the normal travel policies are waived as it is accepted that, in extreme circumstances, employees may need to travel in whatever manner is possible. Extreme circumstances may include, but not be limited to, severe environmental difficulties, natural calamities, pandemic, war, civil disruption, acts of terrorism or any incident that has the potential to affect the safety and well-being of an employee.
- (g) **Local travel during official foreign tour** - Employees are required to use their judgement to select the most appropriate form of transport for journeys, considering factors such as cost effectiveness. The Company shall reimburse such expenses at actuals. Supporting documents be submitted with the reimbursement claim. If such supporting cannot be provided, then self-certified cash voucher of the Company be submitted.

3. INSURANCE:

- (a) **Medical Insurance** - The Company shall arrange for medical insurance for employees travelling overseas on official tours. Concerned employees shall ensure that they carry the requisite papers and information with them during the foreign travel and follow the guidelines incase of need. Any amounts not paid by the Insurance Company, shall be borne by the Company. Further, if medical insurance is not arranged by the Company and the concerned employee has to undergo any medical treatment, then the Company shall bear full expenses for such treatment.
- (b) **Baggage and Personal Property Insurance** - The Company shall arrange for requisite baggage and personal property insurance. If requisite baggage and personal property insurance is not arranged by the Company, then MKCL will reimburse employees for the loss of luggage and personal property necessary for the purpose of an official tour due to fire, theft or natural disaster during business travel. Losses by theft must be reported immediately to the police.
- (c) **Exclusion:** This insurance policy does not:
 - apply for the duration of any personal leave during the same trip; or
 - cover personal items such as jewelry, watches, cameras, etc. that are not required for business purposes.
- (d) **Limit:** Insurance cover is limited to maximum amount and on terms specified in the insurance policy issued by the Insurance Company.
- (e) **Insurance Claims-** Upon return to India, employees should contact HRD Officer and arrange to complete the insurance claim form. The completed form should be returned to MKCL's insurers with all relevant supporting documentation including original receipts for any essential replacement items purchased. Any items that have been purchased should not

form part of an expense claim, as the claim for reimbursement will be submitted either to MKCL's insurers or the airline.

4. VISAS, MEDICALS AND VACCINATIONS:

- (a) **Visas**- Obtaining of requisite Visa/s will be arranged and facilitated by the Company. The employee shall provide all the requisite documents and appear for interview before the appropriate authorities, if required. Employees must ensure that they obtain visas as soon as possible in order to minimize the cost to the Company.
- (b) **Medicals** - Employees who are likely to be travelling on company business are required to be medically fit to do so. It is recommended that individuals frequently making international trips, should undergo an annual medical checkup. All employees are encouraged to have regular medical checkup. Further, employees should carry the regular medicines they require and in case of medicines requiring prescription, also carry prescription from registered medical practitioner. In case any employee has undergone any surgery for metallic implant, he/she should carry the requisite certificate.
- (c) **Vaccinations**- Employees must ensure that the required vaccinations are valid for any particular country/region and it is the individual's responsibility to ensure that their vaccinations are kept up to date.

5. HOTELS AND ASSOCIATED COSTS:

- (a) **Hotel bookings** - Hotel bookings should normally be made by the Company. In case the employee is required to make the bookings, then the same should be prior approved by the concerned Appraiser. Where staff are required to attend a conference, they would usually be expected to stay in the hotel where the conference is being hosted.
- (b) **Hotel costs**- The Company will reimburse the individual travelling for all reasonable hotel expenses incurred, including laundry and dry-cleaning costs on a business trip over three days. However certain costs are usually not reimbursable by the Company and are to be met by the individual travelling which include but are not limited to hotel room mini-bar items except water or soft drinks.

6. SUBSISTENCE:

- (a) MKCL will reimburse/pay in advance as Daily Allowance (DA) towards costs incurred for food, water, and non-alcoholic beverages upto a limit sanctioned by the Managing Director. This limit will be decided considering Rules of Government of India if any for Foreign Travel. The Company shall reimburse such expenses at actuals. Supporting documents be submitted with the reimbursement claim. If such supporting cannot be provided, then self-certified cash voucher of the Company be submitted. All other norms of the 'Daily Allowance (DA) Policy for Domestic Official Travel' shall apply *mutatis mutandis* (i.e. with the necessary changes having been made).

7. PHONE CALLS

- (a) Phone calls reimbursement will be given upto the limit sanctioned by the Managing Director for calls made during this duration. Personal calls to India should ordinarily be kept to a
- (b) Reasonable level. Employees will be expected to pay for excessive personal calls.

8. ENTERTAINMENT:

- (a) The Company will not bear any expenses incurred by the employee towards personal entertainment, sightseeing, etc. However, any meal expenses incurred for business associates/prospective customers/other business-related persons shall be borne by the Company.

9. FOREIGN CURRENCY & CORPORATE CREDIT CARD:

- (a) Company will make necessary arrangements for obtaining foreign currency. Incase the employee holds a Corporate Credit Card, he may use the same for expenses allowed under this Policy and submit supporting documents to the Company.

10. IMPORTANT INFORMATION:

- (a) Before travelling to a foreign country, the concerned employee should read and be aware of the local customs, traditions, restrictions, social behavior norms, etc. of the said country and observe the same so as to avoid any unpleasant situation. The employee shall also be aware of air-travel baggage rules viz. maximum weight allowed, prohibited items, etc. The Company shall not bear any expense for additional baggage/excess baggage. The Company shall also not take responsibility for any consequences incurred due to carrying of any prohibited items by the employee. The employee shall carry international travel adapter.
- (b) The employee shall keep informed his/her family members details of travel plan, travel booking, hotel bookings, insurance policies, company contact person details incase of emergency, etc.

The Managing Director shall have discretion to modify the norms for specific individual cases and/or for specific events.

I. Corporate Credit Card Policy

Policy:	Corporate Credit Card Policy
Date of issue:	January 16, 2019
Effective Date:	January 01, 2019
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

The objective of this policy is to ensure that Corporate Credit Cards are obtained by the Company in the name of certain authorized employees of the Company and used by those employees for permitted official expenses and adequate controls are established for their use.

2. Applicability:

This policy applies to all employees authorized to hold the Company's Corporate Credit Cards.

3. Definitions:

- (a) **Cardholder:** Cardholder means an employee for whom a Corporate Credit Card has been obtained pursuant to approval of the Board of Directors of the Company ("the Board") and whose name appears on the Corporate Credit Card.
- (b) **Corporate Credit Card/s :** Corporate Credit Card means a Credit Card availed/obtained in the name of an employee by the Company from its Banker, having a predetermined credit limit as prior approved by the Board and which is used only for permitted official purposes.

4. Norms:

1. Corporate Credit Cards may be obtained from time to time by the Company in the name of specified employees pursuant to approval of the Board.
2. Corporate Credit Cards will be used for only official purposes enlisted below and as per applicable Company Policies –
 - a. Travel bookings, lodging & boarding during travels, permitted expenses during official travel, expenses related to foreign travel e.g. Visa Fees, etc.;
 - b. Expenses related to Social Media/Digital Marketing, subject to proper document and requisite approval;
 - c. Purchases of Software, hardware, IT Services like Cloud hosting charges, purchase/renewal of domain names and other purchases depending on business exigencies supported by Purchase Order or proper document duly approved and as per the Company's Finance Regulations;
 - d. Payments to Statutory Authorities for filings, fees, etc. e.g. Ministry of

- Corporate Affairs, Trade Marks Registry, Shop Act Authorities;
 - e. Tender, Bid, Request for Proposal fees (subject to requisite approval);
 - f. Online Registration Fees for attending Conference, Seminar, Workshops, Exhibition, etc. (subject to requisite approval)
 - g. Other permitted official business expenses.
- (c) The Cardholder shall not withdraw cash using the Corporate Credit Card for any purpose whatsoever.
- (d) The Cardholder shall ensure that all applicable security norms as prescribed by the Bank for preventing misuse, fraud, etc. are followed and the Cardholder shall be responsible for its permitted use.
- (e) If the Corporate Credit Card is misplaced/lost/stolen, the Cardholder shall inform the F & A Head immediately and take all requisite steps to block the card. In case of any omission on the part of the Cardholder in taking immediate steps to block the lost Corporate Credit Card, and there is misuse of the Corporate Credit Card, then the Cardholder shall be liable for such misuse and shall reimburse the Company such amounts.
- (f) The Cardholder, cannot under any circumstances use the Corporate Credit Card for personal purposes and expenditures.
- (g) The Corporate Credit Cardholder shall submit to the Accounts Team requisite supporting documents for expenses/purchases made using his/her Corporate Credit Card within 3 working days of receipt of credit card statement by him/her to avoid any late payment charges. The Accounts Team shall also ensure timely payment of Corporate Credit Card Bills to the Bank and ensure that no penalty for late payment is charged by the Bank.
- (h) In case, in any month, the Credit limit gets exhausted or is nearing exhaustion before the completion of billing cycle, then the Cardholder may submit requisite supporting documents of expenses made and request for payment of those amounts to the Bank. The Accounts Team, after scrutiny of the submitted documents, on being satisfied, shall make payment to the Bank so that the original credit limit of the Cardholder is restored.
- (i) The Accounts Team shall scrutinize the monthly expenditure made by each Cardholder based on the credit card statement received along with the requisite supporting documents. Any expenses which appear to be unreasonable/personal/unpermitted shall be first referred to the F & A Head who can seek clarification from the Cardholder. If the F & A Head is not satisfied by the explanations given by the Cardholder, then the matter shall be referred to the Managing Director for final decision.
- (j) In case of any issues arising out of use of the Corporate Credit Card e.g. double payment, non-credit of refunds, etc., the Cardholder shall render necessary cooperation and support to the Accounts Team to resolve the matter.
- (k) Inappropriate use of corporate credit card amounts to misconduct under the 'Code of Conduct Policy', which may result in disciplinary action.
- (l) The Cardholder shall not exceed the credit limit set on his/her card. Further, the Cardholder shall not normally use personal credit card for permitted official purposes

and may use only in case of business exigencies, if the limit of Corporate Credit Card has been exhausted/is insufficient or the Corporate Credit Card of a particular Bank is not accepted for particular transactions.

- (m) The Company may at any time withdraw the facility of the Corporate Credit Card in case of any employee.
 - (n) In case of separation from employment of the Company, the Cardholder shall surrender the Corporate Credit Card to the F & A Head preferably before the commencement of his/her notice period of resignation/termination and the F & A Head shall issue an acknowledgement of receipt of the same in writing to the Cardholder. Further, the Cardholder shall submit the details of any recurring payments/auto debits configured with the Corporate Credit Card. The F & A Head shall take immediate steps to change such recurring payments /auto debits to another Corporate Credit Card and take steps to block and cancel the surrendered Corporate Credit Card.
 - (o) Credit card limits will be reviewed annually for all card holders based on their feedback and if necessary, approval of the Board will be sought for revised limits.
 - (p) The Managing Director shall have discretion to approve exceptional cases.
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7. Performance Appraisal

A. Monthly Performance Evaluation and Appraisal Policy

Policy:	Performance Appraisal Policy
Sub-policy:	Monthly Performance Evaluation and Appraisal Policy
Date of issue:	April 16, 2018
Effective Date:	April 01, 2018
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

The Performance Evaluation and Appraisal policy aims at systematic evaluation of the performance of employees and to understand the attitude, aptitude and abilities of an employee for further growth and development. An objective and transparent Performance Review process is crucial in building trust, positivity and high team performance and morale. It is also necessary for identifying requisite skill gaps, upskilling, reskilling in this very fast changing world.

The objectives of this Policy is –

- (a) To evaluate the job performance of an employee against set goals;
- (b) To identify the strengths and areas of improvements of employees to place right resources on right job;
- (c) To assess the potential present in an employee for further growth and development;
- (d) To support Manpower Planning;
- (e) To provide a feedback to employees regarding their performance and related status.
- (f) To counsel Poor Performers and address areas of improvement;
- (g) To understand and determine individual Training and Development needs and organize training programs accordingly;
- (h) To maintain records in order to determine compensation packages, salary structure, increments, promotions, etc.

2. Applicability:

The Policy is applicable to all employees of the Company except those.

3. Norms:

- (a) Performance Evaluation and appraisal of an employee is a continuous process which shall be done by the appraiser at the end of every month.
- (b) Annual increment, if any shall be due in the month of April every year on the basis of relative ratings of the employee.

4. Process for Performance Evaluation and Appraisal:

The Performance evaluation and appraisal shall be done as follows-

- (a) **Submission of Monthly Report:** Every employee shall submit a Monthly Performance Report to his/her Appraiser **within 5 days of the end of each month**. A Day, from 01 -05 of the following month be specifically set aside for writing detail meaningful factual Performance Report of the previous Month and same be uploaded **by Day 05** in employee portal 'g10'.
- (b) **Monthly review and rating:** The concerned Appraiser shall conduct the appraisal based on the Performance Report submitted as well as the performance observed during the month and **submit the rating by 10th day of each month**.
- (c) **Personal appraisal meeting:** It is desirable that the concerned Appraiser conduct personal appraisal meeting with each Appraisee at least once in a quarter and give specific, objective and factual feedback regarding critical observations, if any as well as appreciative observations, if any. On end of every Quarter, **Day 06-Day 08** of the following month, concerned Appraisers shall have one-to-one meetings with their concerned Appraisees and have discussions regarding tasks accomplished, constraints if any, resources required, feedback, concerns, suggestions for improvements, etc. and the concerned Appraiser and Appraisee should take requisite actions.
- (d) **Quarterly Performance Plans:** If directed by the concerned Appraiser, for ensuring timely planned actions and milestones, concerned employee will prepare and upload in G10 in discussions with concerned Appraiser, quarterly Performance Plan. The Performance Report and Plan can be compared, variances identified and if necessary, corrective actions be taken.
- (e) **Monitoring systems:** The Company may implement performance monitoring systems as felt necessary and review the same from time to time. Appropriate actions will be taken based on the monitoring reports generated.
- (f) **Upskilling, re-skilling:** The Appraiser shall from time to time specify the requisite Certifications, Courses, etc. and the concerned Appraisee shall undertake and complete the same. The completion of such specified certifications, courses, etc. shall be confirmed by the concerned Appraiser to HRD in the month of March each year, considering which the Pay rise for next financial year will be given as per the ratings.
- (g) **Rating Criteria and basis of ratings:** Monthly ratings shall be given by the Appraiser to the Appraisee on the basis of his/her Performance. The Rating Criteria as applicable for the financial year to respective appraisee shall be discussed by the Appraiser with his concerned appraisee/s and mentioned by the Appraiser through the g10 login. The Rating Criteria shall be submitted by each Appraiser in the first month of the financial year or in the month in which an employee is transferred to the Program of the concerned Appraiser. Auto email is received by the concerned Appraisee regarding the Criteria-wise Appraiser Ratings, Appreciation, Critical Observations, Other Comments (if mentioned) on submission of rating by the Appraiser. It is also accessible in the Appraisee's g10 login. Once the Rating Criteria is agreed, it shall not be normally changed during the financial year. The Rating Criteria may be revised in case of change in scope of responsibilities.
- (h) **Scale of rating:** Monthly rating will be on a 10 point scale 1 being the lowest and 10 being the highest. 1-10 is absolute rating of the individual.

- (i) **Appreciation:** It is necessary to set aside some time for acknowledging and appreciating the efforts of our Colleagues. As such, on Day 03, after completing writing the Monthly Performance Report, some time be invested by writing few lines of heartfelt appreciation of Colleagues as an employee may choose. An '*Appreciation Corner*' is available on dashboard of each employee's g10 login for expressing appreciation.
- (j) **Annual Relative Rating:** HRD shall forward to the Appraiser blank Rating Sheets concerning all employees reporting to the concerned Appraiser. The Appraiser of each Program shall assign one of the following relative ratings on the scale of 1-5 to each team member based on the employee's monthly ratings during the financial year. This relative rating is comparative rating in the team. Relative rating is done to avoid bias in rating as per each appraiser perception. No Appraiser can directly give 'Outstanding Rating'/'Excellent Plus' to any employee. Points for relative rating are as below:
*Outstanding: 4.5 * Excellent Plus: 4 Excellent: 3 Very Good: 2.5 Good: 2
Poor: 0
- *The process for selection of 'Outstanding' Performers for the concerned Financial Year and for giving 'Excellent Plus' rating will be specified by the Managing Director from time to time.
- (k) **Timely completion:** This process shall be completed by all Appraisers within the specified period each year by handing over the sealed envelope of these annual relative ratings to the HRD.
- (l) **Annual Increments:** The norms regarding annual increments and level up-gradation shall be as specified in the Remuneration Policy for employees from time to time.
- (m) **Unsatisfactory Performance:** Employees constantly non-performing/under-performing will be given feed-back and necessary actions as per 'Policy to address under/non-performance' will be taken.
- (n) **Performance evidence:** The objective evidence of performance or non-performance of each employee shall be retained and documented by the respective appraiser and the appraiser shall share the same with HRD.
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B. Process for Selection of MKCL's Outstanding Performers For the Financial Years 2024-25 onwards (PSOP) Selection

Policy:	Performance Appraisal Policy
Sub-policy:	Process for Selection of MKCL's Outstanding Performers For the Financial Years 2024-25 onwards (PSOP)
Date of issue:	April 16, 2018
Effective Date:	April 01, 2018
Last revision Date:	March 31, 2025
Effective date of revision:	March 31, 2025
Version no.:	1.3

Objective:

MKCL has been consistently identifying its outstanding performers over the years through a meticulously designed and carefully implemented transparent process involving collective decision-making. This process offers an opportunity to the employees to showcase their potentially outstanding work to the senior reviewers alongside its critical assessment by them. This reflective process has enabled the participants to understand subtle nuances of their work from assessors' perspectives. The participants have also got the opportunity to see the degree of alignment of their work with the broader vision and mission of MKCL.

Over the years, the **Process for Selection of Outstanding Performers (PSOP)** is being regularly revised to enhance its effectiveness and relevance. After detailed discussions with the Chief Mentor, the PSOP has been revised for the Financial Years (FYs) 2024-25 onwards. The main purpose of revision is to decentralize PSOP by carrying out separate reviews for a Group of Pay Levels in Staff Types rather than one centralized review for junior as well as senior employees i.e. employees in all Pay Levels. This will create level playing fields to the employees at various levels of experience.

All the participating employees, **except APEX members**, shall undergo the revised PSOP w.e.f. FY 2024-25. APEX members, will continue their ongoing process for FY 2024-25. From FY 2025-26 onwards, the PSOP will be applicable as mentioned below.

Each year the schedule of PSOP will be announced by **March 01**.

1. Applicability and Eligibility for Participation in PSOP:

- a. PSOP will be applicable to the Senior Project Associate (SPA) I and II, and the Member Staff.
- b. PSOP will not be applicable to Project Trainees and Project Associates. They will undergo the regular monthly appraisal process.
- c. PSOP will not be applicable to the Managing Director and the Chief Executive Officer, being the custodians of the process.
- d. The SPA I and II, and the Member Staff will be eligible for PSOP, if they will have completed at least 12 months of service in MKCL till March 31 every year.
- e. Employees serving their notice period will not be eligible to participate in PSOP.

2. **Self-Nomination:** SPAs and Members desirous of nominating themselves for the consideration for award of outstanding rating will have to follow the process outlined

below:

Submission Method and Deadline: Send an 'Expression of Interest to Participate in PSOP' by email to hrd@mkcl.org; ceo@mkcl.org on or before March 15 every year with a copy to the concerned Appraiser.

- a. HRD will send an acknowledgement to the applicant with a cc to CEO and the respective Appraiser.
- b. **Subject Line:** The email should include the subject line: *"Self-Nomination for Selection as Outstanding Performer for FY 20XX-YY"*.
- c. There is no upper limit on the number of self-nominations from any Program.
- d. Prior approval of the Appraiser is not required for self-nomination by an Appraisee.

3. Encouragement by Appraisers

If an Appraiser considers some of her/his Appraisee/s suitable for consideration in PSOP, s/he may encourage the concerned Appraisee/s to self-nominate within the deadline.

4. Two Stage Reviews: The PSOP review process will be conducted in two stages:

- a. **Stage I Review:** All nominees will participate in the initial review conducted by the Review Committees constituted by the Managing Director.
- b. **Stage II Review:** Only the nominees shortlisted in Stage I will proceed to Stage II Review by another Review Committee constituted by the Managing Director.

5. Groups of Pay Level/s in Staff Types for Stage I Reviews: The Groups for Stage I Review are shown in the Table below:

Group	Pay Level/s and Staff Type
1.	Nominees in All Pay Levels of Facilitation Staff Nominees among the Senior Project Associates I and II in Facilitation Staff
2.	Nominees in All Pay Levels of Support Staff Nominees among the Senior Project Associates I and II in Support Staff
3.	Nominees among the Senior Project Associates I in Development Staff
4.	Nominees among the Senior Project Associates II in Development Staff
5.	Nominees in Pay Level 1 in Development Staff
6.	Nominees in Pay Level 2 in Development Staff
7.	Nominees in Pay Level 3 in Development Staff
8.	Nominees in Pay Level 4 in Development Staff
9.	Nominees in Pay Levels 5 to 10 in Development Staff

6. Review Committees: For the Stage I Reviews, the Managing Director shall constitute two separate Review Committees for each Group of Pay Levels – one for Technical Category and the other for all Categories other than Technical.

These Review Committees shall review the performance of all the eligible nominees in the respective Groups and shortlist the nominees based on their performance and recommend them for the review by the Stage II Review Committee for consideration of the award of outstanding rating.

The Managing Director shall constitute the Review Committees as follows:

Stage I Review Committee:

- a. **For Technical Category Nominees:** The Review Committee will consist exclusively of members from the Technical Development Staff.
- b. **For Management, Business, Academic, and Artistic Category Nominees:** The Review Committee will consist of members from Management / Business / Academic / Artistic Development Staff.

Stage II Review Committee:

For all the nominees shortlisted in Stage I, Stage II Reviews will be conducted by a common Review Committee constituted by the Managing Director. The performance of all the nominees shortlisted in Stage I will be evaluated and rated by every member of the Stage II Review Committee, regardless of the nominee's staff type and category.

The Managing Director may invite external experts also on the Review Committees.

7. **Finalization of Eligible Nominees by HRD:** After receiving self-nominations, the HRD will finalize the list of nominees for participation in the Stage I Review. The finalization of the list will include the following steps:
 - a. **Preparation of Final List:** HRD will compile the list of eligible nominees based on the nominations received and after ascertaining their eligibility.
 - b. **Communication with Nominees:** Nominees will be informed of their eligibility or otherwise by the HRD by **March 20**, every year.
 - c. **Group-Wise Classification:** HRD will prepare Group-wise lists of nominees, categorized according to the Pay level/s and Category (i.e., technical or others).
 - d. **Submission to Review Committees:** The Group-wise lists will be forwarded to the respective Stage I Review Committees constituted by the Managing Director.
8. **Submission of Presentation and Write-up by the Eligible Nominees:** Each nominee is required to email a presentation and a write-up titled "My Potentially Outstanding Accomplishments in FY 20XX-YY" to hrd@mkcl.org and ceo@mkcl.org, with a copy to their respective Appraiser, by **April 10, every year**.

This email must adhere to the following guidelines:

- a. **Email Subject Line:** "PSOP Document of [Name of the Nominee] – FY 20XX-YY"
- b. **Two Mandatory Attachments:** 1. Presentation - .pptx file; 2. Write-up - .docx file
- c. **Attachment Files - Naming Convention:** "[Name of Nominee] PSOP FY 20XX-YY.Applicable Extension"
- d. **Presentation and Write-up:** Must include valid supporting evidence for each accomplishment
- e. **Optional Audio / Video Submission:** Nominees may optionally share Microsoft One Drive link/s of high-quality audio / video file/s (all files together of maximum 10 minutes duration) highlighting their potentially outstanding accomplishments.
- f. **Content and Structure of the Presentation & Write-up:** The presentation and write-up must be structured around the following 6 criteria. Each criterion should be presented in a separate slide, with the criterion clearly mentioned in the *Heading/Title*. Failure to include a slide for any criterion will result in a 'Zero' rating for that criterion by the Review Committees.
 - 1) Verifiable, demonstrable, and potentially outstanding accomplishment/s.
 - 2) Specific individual contributions for the accomplishment/s.
 - 3) Initiatives taken beyond expected / assigned responsibilities and efforts made for such

- accomplishments in response to emerging organizational priorities and exigencies
- 4) Specific contributions to enhance productivity / quality / profitability / sustainability / etc.
- 5) Positive impact of the accomplishments, innovations, initiatives, or problem-solving efforts.
- 6) Engagement in Appropriate use of AI / New Learnings / Skills Enhancement / Knowledge Upgradation / Certifications / Patents / etc.

Nominees must ensure their presentations and write-ups are accurate, verifiable, and free from exaggerated or routine claims to avoid deductions

- g. **No Reminders:** HRD will not send any reminders for submission of the presentation and write-up.
 - h. **No Late Submissions:** Submissions received after the deadline will not be considered, and the nominee will automatically exit the PSOP.
9. **Presentations Before Stage I Review Committee:** Each nominee will deliver a 10-minute presentation to the Review Committee, either in person or via Google Meet/MS Teams Meet, as per the schedule communicated by HRD. Normally, the presentations shall be scheduled between **April 20 to 23, every year.**

Guidelines for the Presentation:

- a. Participation in Stage 1 Review is mandatory.
 - b. Non-participation will result in the nominee's automatic exit from the PSOP.
 - c. Content: The presentation must be identical to the one previously submitted to HRD.
 - d. Interaction: The presentation will be followed by an interaction with the Review Committee.
10. **Recommendations of the Stage I Review Committee:** After presentation of and interaction with each of the nominees, Members of each of the Stage I Review Committee will:
- a. Note the upper limit on number of nominees that can be shortlisted should not exceed 10% of total staff count in their respective Group as specified by HRD,
 - b. Rate Individually and independently the performance of each of the nominees based on the criteria enlisted in 8(f) above,
 - c. Share their individual ratings with all other Committee Members and deliberate,
 - d. Recommend by consensus the names of unanimously shortlisted nominees for the Stage II Review by observing the upper limit specified by HRD as per 10(a) above. The review committee shall deliberate collectively to determine the nominees' ratings. All members will engage in discussions and reach a consensus on the proposed ratings after completion of the Stage I Reviews. The Chairman, after ensuring consensus, will finalize the ratings. In case consensus cannot be achieved unanimously, then the decision by the Chairman of the concerned Committee will be final and binding on the nominee participants as well as all the Members of the Committee.
 - e. Digitally sign the soft copy of the Review Report in a format prescribed by HRD along with the transcript of the Committee's observations about the nominees reviewed,
 - f. Submit the duly signed Review Report through the Chairman of their Review Committee by email to md@mkcl.org and ceo@mkcl.org with a cc to hrd@mkcl.org **by the end of the day on completion of the Stage I Reviews.**

11. Scheduling of Stage II Review by HRD: Based on the Reports of the Stage I Review Committees, HRD will:

- a. compile the final list of Stage II nominees,
- b. schedule the Stage II presentations in consultation with the Managing Director, and
- c. communicate the schedule and allied details of Stage II Review Presentations to the Stage II Review Committee Members as well as the shortlisted nominees.

12. Presentations before Stage 2 Review Committee: Each nominee will deliver a 10-minute presentation to the Stage II Review Committee, either in person or via Google Meet, as per the schedule communicated by HRD. Normally, the Stage II Reviews may be conducted between **April 25 to 27, every year.**

Guidelines for the Presentation:

- a. Participation in Stage II Reviews is mandatory.
- b. Non-participation will result in the nominee's automatic exit from the PSOP.
- c. Content: The presentation must be identical to the one previously submitted to HRD.
- d. Interaction: The presentation will be followed by an interaction with the Stage II Review Committee.

13. Recommendations of the Stage II Review Committee: After presentation of and interaction with each of the nominees, Members of the Stage II Review Committee will:

- a. Rate Individually and independently the performance of each of the nominees based on the criteria enlisted in 8(f) above in the Rating Sheet Template provided by HRD,
- b. Submit the duly completed and digitally signed soft copy (in PDF and Excel formats) of the Rating Sheet by email to md@mkcl.org, ceo@mkcl.org with a cc to hrd@mkcl.org immediately upon conclusion of the presentations.

14. Rating Guidelines for Stage I and Stage II Review:

- a. **Positive Marking:** Nominees will be rated on a scale of **0 (lowest) to 5 (highest)**. The score may include whole numbers or decimals, such as 2, 5, 3.5, or 4.1, reflecting the Reviewer's evaluation of the nominee's accomplishments.
- b. **Negative Marking:** Nominees should note that negative marking may be applied for the following reasons:
 - Claims of accomplishments that are not substantiated with valid verifiable evidence,
 - Mention of wish-lists, plans, ideas, proposals, dreams, etc. for the future and / or the accomplishments in the past years before the performance year under review,
 - Highlighting mundane or routine tasks that fall under expected day-to-day responsibilities devoid of exceptional outcomes,
 - Exaggerated or misleading claims, overstated achievements, misleading information, or undue use of pictures / videos that misrepresent the facts,
 - Presenting someone else's accomplishments as one's own.
- c. **Scoring for Negative Marking:** Negative marks will be assigned as whole numbers (either 0 or 1) for each identified issue. These deductions will be subtracted from the Total Rating Score derived from positive marking.

- d. **Custodian of PSOP:** The Managing Director will serve as the custodian of sanctity of PSOP, ensuring its transparent, fair, and unbiased implementation, with the support of the Chief Executive Officer.
 - e. **Review of Ratings:** If necessary, the Managing Director may seek explanations or justifications for the ratings provided by any of the Stage I or Stage II Review Committee Member/s.
- 15. Compilation of Ratings Given By the Stage II Review Committee:** HRD will verify the validity of all rating sheets received from the Members of the Stage II Review Committee. Upon validation, HRD will compile the ratings for each of the nominees and compute the average score for each nominee.
- 16. Preparation of Group-wise Merit List:** HRD will prepare a merit list for each Group by arranging the average scores of nominees in each Group in the descending order of their average scores.
- 17. Declaration of Outstanding Performers:**
- a. **Quota for Outstanding Performers:**
 - The quota for Stage I shortlisting is 10% of the total staff in each Group.
 - The quota for Outstanding Performers in each Group will be decided by the Key Management Team each year considering the total number of employees in each Group. However, the aggregate should not exceed 5% of the Total Employee strength.
 - In case above percentages result into fractions, HRD shall carry out appropriate rounding-up.
 - If no nominees or fewer nominees are selected from any Group(s), the unused quota will not be reallocated to other Groups.
 - b. **Preparation and Review:**
 - HRD will present the Group-wise merit list, along with the applicable quota for Outstanding Rating for each Group to the Managing Director.
 - The Managing Director, in consultation with the Chief Executive Officer, will determine:
 - Average Score Cut-Off 1: To identify nominees in each Group to be declared as Outstanding Performers for FY 2024-25.
 - Average Score Cut-Off 2 (if applicable): To assign an Excellent+ Rating to nominees in each Group who exceed this threshold but do not qualify as Outstanding Performers.
 - c. **Final Declaration:**
 - Nominees above Cut-Off 1 will be declared as *Outstanding Performers*.
 - Nominees above Cut-Off 2 (but below Cut-Off 1) may be awarded an *Excellent+ Rating*.
 - Both the lists will be communicated to the employees in alphabetical order of the first names of the selected nominees preferably by **May 03, every year**.
 - d. **Discretion of the Managing Director:**
 - The Managing Director reserves the right not to assign Outstanding or Excellent+ Ratings to any of the nominees in a Group, if deemed appropriate after reviewing the average ratings.
 - e. **Finality of Decision:**
 - The Managing Director's decision regarding the assignment of Outstanding and Excellent+ Ratings shall be final and binding.
 - No communication or correspondence regarding this decision will be entertained.

18. Sharing of Scores and Rankings:

To ensure transparency and provide a benchmark for performance improvement, HRD will share their own Individual Score, Average Rating, and Group Ranking with all nominees who participated in the Stage II Review. This sharing will be done preferably by **May 03, every year**.

C. Policy to address under/non-performance

Policy:	Performance Appraisal Policy
Sub-policy:	Policy to address under/non-performance
Date of issue:	April 16, 2018
Effective Date:	April 01, 2018
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective :

MKCL is a learning organization and provides sufficient resources, opportunities, support and guidance to employees to perform and prove their ability and capability. The Company has established periodic Appraisal and rating system. Termination of the employment would be the last resort and a regrettable decision in case of employees who are not able to continuously perform. Therefore, the objective of this policy is to rectify and/or improvise the performance wherever possible and accordingly take action.

2. Norms:

- (a) Every employee whose monthly rating for any financial year is below 5 continuously for 12 months shall fall under the category of under/non- performing employee. Also, employees not performing as expected, or constantly non-performing/under-performing /dissatisfactory performing may fall under this category. Such employees will be given timely feed-back in writing.
- (b) On the basis of such feedback, corrective actions should be taken by the employee to work upon it and improvements on the same should be shown during the specified period.
- (c) In spite of all the possible efforts taken and opportunities given, if no significant improvement is noticed, and the rating does not improve, then the concerned Appraiser and Program Head r should make appropriate recommendations to the HRD and Key Management Team (KMT).
- (d) The KMT shall take suitable actions regarding the concerned employee/s on the basis of objective evidence of continuous non-performance, including termination of services.

8. TRANSFER POLICY

A. Temporary Transfer Policy

Policy:	Transfer Policy
Sub-policy:	Temporary Transfer Policy
Date of issue:	April 13, 2017
Effective Date:	April 01, 2017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objectives :

The objective of a Temporary Transfer policy is to have clear norms for effecting transfers as and when required in the overall interest of the organization.

The main objectives of temporary transfer may be -

- (1) To meet organizational needs/exigencies ;
- (2) To groom the employee for later advancement and promotion;
- (3) To provide creative and challenging opportunities to deserving employees.

2. Norms:

(a) Temporary Transfer:

A temporary transfer refers to lateral movement of employees within the same level, but at a different physical/geographical location for a period upto three months (which may be extended for a maximum of additional three months by Managing Director), which does not involve relocation with family. A transfer letter shall be issued to the employee by the HRD, clearly specifying the terms of temporary transfer. Prior to transferring an employee, his personal and other constraints and/or difficulties, if any, should be understood by the Company. Ideally, the transfer should be by mutual consent. However, the MD has final discretionary powers to decide about the transfer and the concerned employee shall abide by the decision. In case, the employee does not abide by the decision of the MD , MKCL reserves the right to terminate his/her services with one month prior notice.

This policy is not applicable and no entitlements shall accrue -

- (a) in case of transfer to meet the request of an employee;
- (b) to employee transferred within the same city/municipal limits of original posting, but to a different office.

(b) Definition of Family:

Notwithstanding anything stated anywhere in other MKCL's policies, for this policy, 'family' includes spouse residing with the employee (need not be dependent); legitimate children (upto two) and stepchildren, residing with and wholly dependent on the employee; Parents, stepmother, unmarried/widowed sisters and minor brothers, residing with and wholly dependent on the employee.

(c) Allowances, reimbursements:

The following amounts, reimbursement of charges shall be paid to the employee for temporary transfer -

a) Temporary Transfer Allowance The Company shall pay the employee a “Temporary Transfer Allowance” (“TTA”) for the number of days of the temporary transfer excluding the joining and returning travel days, at the rate of Rs.10000 (Rupees Ten Thousand Only) per 30 days. This TTA will be paid by the Company in addition to the salary as per letter of appointment. The Company will not pay any ‘Daily Allowance’ and/or reimburse for daily local travel from the place of temporary residence to the place of Temporary Transfer Posting.

b) Travel fares Travel fares (from original posting to temporary transfer posting) for self for journey by railway/roadway/waterway/air way shall be reimbursed on actuals or paid by the Company as per below eligibility:

Category	Travel Entitlements (On actuals)
(a) Program Leaders, Senior Program Coordinators, Program Coordinators	Economy Class by Air (prior intimation to MD)/AC first Class or below by railway (or waterway)/Any type of road public transport (including air-conditioned)/AC Taxi/ Cab/other Private mode by road.
(b) Employees other than (a) above.	AC II Tier Class or below by railway (or waterway) /Any type of road public transport (including air-conditioned)/ other Private mode by road. Economy Class by Air to be prior justified, recommended by concerned Appraiser and prior approved by concerned Sr. Program Coordinator vide email.

c) Mobile and internet charges The employee shall be reimbursed Mobile and internet charges on actuals as per limit set by the concerned employee’s appraiser during the temporary transfer period.

d) Food expenses The employee shall be reimbursed as per “MKCL’s Daily Allowance policy” of his daily expenses incurred on Food (Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner) in case s/he is expected to occasionally travel to Project office (other than the office of his temporary transfer posting) or to a different location (other than her/his temporary transfer posting), for official work.

(d) Transit Leave:

The employee shall be allowed three working days as ‘Transit Leave’ to make arrangements for movement and to settle down at the new location. This Transit Leave of three days excludes actual travel time (from original posting to temporary transferred posting). This leave may be taken immediately either pre or post arrival at Transferred Location. This leave cannot be carried forward.

(e) Accommodation:

The transferred employee shall be reimbursed accommodation expenses at his Temporary transfer posting after obtaining prior approval of the concerned appraiser and F & A Head for the said expenses.

(f) Daily local travel :

No re-imbursements shall be made by the Company to the employee for daily local to-fro travel from place of temporary residence to office of temporary transfer since 'Transport Allowance' is paid by the Company as part of her/his Remuneration package. In case of travel to a different location (other than his temporary transfer posting), for official work, reimbursement shall be made on actuals as per MKCL's applicable norms for such travel.

3. Claim Procedure:

1. All claims must be submitted within 15 days of joining at the new location.
2. The Claim details must be filled in accurately and submitted along with reimbursement or advance settlement form, travel expense report if stayed in hotel, all bills/receipts in original, delivery challan for goods, etc. The claim form shall be authenticated by the concerned appraiser and forwarded to the F & A Head. The claim shall be settled within 30 calendar days of receipt of the claim by Accounts Program.

4. Handing over / Taking over on transfer:

1. In all cases of transfers, it is extremely important to have a proper handing over / taking over, to ensure smooth transition and continuity of work. It shall be the responsibility of the transferred employee to prepare a "checklist" of roles and responsibilities. It is important that this "checklist" is updated mentioning the current tasks and activities at hand, as also the activities planned for future, duly signed/approved by his appraiser and Program Head. This "Checklist" will be provided to the employee who takes over from the employee being transferred or his manager, as practically possible in the given situation. Also, wherever applicable proper asset handover to the Appraiser should be done by the employee.
2. The concerned Program Head is responsible for handing and taking over process. He should ensure that the process of handing and taking over is properly documented, authenticated and all concerned officers are informed.

5. Re-transfer to original place of posting:

On re-transfer from temporary transfer posting to original place of posting, the provisions regarding re-imbursement of travel fares and 'Transit Leave' as mentioned above, shall apply *mutatis mutandis* (i.e. the necessary changes having been made).

6. Dispute:

Any unsettled claims/disputes shall be referred to the MD and decision given by MD shall be final and binding.

B. Transfer (exceeding 3 months) Policy

Policy:	Transfer Policy
Sub-policy:	Transfer (exceeding 3 months) Policy
Date of issue:	April 13, 2017
Effective Date:	April 01, 2017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objectives :

The objective of Transfer policy is to have clear norms for effecting transfers as and when required in the overall interest of the organization.

The main objectives of transfer are -

- (1) To meet organizational needs/exigencies.
- (2) To meet the request of an employee.
- (3) To optimize the services of an employee.
- (4) To suit the age and health of an employee.
- (5) To groom the employee for later advancement and promotion.
- (6) To provide creative and challenging opportunities to deserving employees.
- (7) To correct erroneous placement.
- (8) To absorb the workforce of one branch/office with that of another, when one is closed down.

2. Norms:

1) Transfer:

A transfer refers to lateral movement of employees within the same level, but at a different physical/geographical location which may involve relocation with family with all household and personal belongings. A transfer letter shall be issued to the employee by the HRD, clearly specifying the terms of transfer. Prior to transferring an employee, his personal and other constraints and/or difficulties, if any, should be understood by the Company. Ideally, the transfer should be by mutual consent. However, the MD has final discretionary powers to decide about the transfer and the concerned employee shall abide by the decision. In case, the employee does not abide by the decision of the MD, MKCL reserves the right to terminate his/her services with one month prior notice.

This policy is not applicable and no entitlements shall accrue -

- (a) in case of transfer to meet the request of an employee;
- (b) to employee transferred within the same city/municipal limits of original posting, but to a different office;
- (c) in case the transfer is permanent/exceeding three months, may be outside the city/municipal limits of original posting, but not requiring the employee to relocate his/her residence and/or shift his/her family;

(d) to new employee joining at one location with the understanding that s/he will have a different place of posting (only eligible travel fare shall be reimbursed/paid by the Company).

2. Definition of Family:

Notwithstanding anything stated anywhere in other MKCL's policies, for this policy, 'family' includes spouse residing with the employee (need not be dependent); legitimate children (upto two) and stepchildren, residing with and wholly dependent on the employee; Parents, stepmother, unmarried/widowed sisters and minor brothers, residing with and wholly dependent on the employee.

3. Allowances, reimbursements:

The following amounts, reimbursement of charges shall be paid to the employee for shifting his/her residence to the new place of posting incase employee is transferred for period exceeding continuous three months-

- (a) a composite amount equal to one month's basic pay as Transfer Allowance ("TA");
- (b) actual fares for self and family for journey by railway/roadway/waterway/air way;
- (c) cost of transportation of personal effects from residence to residence; and
- (d) cost of transit Insurance for personal effects
- (e) cost of transportation of conveyance possessed by the employee

(a) Transfer Allowance (TA) A composite amount equal to one month's basic pay as on date of transfer shall be paid as TA to an employee transferred for period exceeding continuous three months. This TA will be paid by the Company in addition to the salary as per letter of appointment.

(b) Travel fares Travel fares (from original posting to transferred posting) for self and family for journey by railway/roadway/waterway/air way shall be reimbursed on actuals or paid by the Company as per below eligibility :

Category	Travel Entitlements (On actuals)
(a) Program Leaders, Senior Program Coordinators, Program Coordinators	Economy Class by Air (prior intimation to MD)/AC first Class or below by railway (or waterway)/Any type of road public transport (including air-conditioned)/AC Taxi/ Cab/other Private mode by road.
(b) Employees other than (a) above.	AC II Tier Class or below by railway (or waterway) /Any type of road public transport (including air-conditioned)/ other Private mode by road. Economy Class by Air to be prior justified, recommended by concerned Appraiser and prior approved by concerned Sr. Program Coordinator vide email.

In addition to the above, the employee will be entitled for an additional fare by the entitled class for self for both onward and return journeys, if s/he has to leave her/his family behind due to non- availability of accommodation at the new place of posting or other compelling reasons, and later shift them to the transferred posting.

(c) Transportation of Personal Effects: The Company shall also reimburse the actual transportation expenses for personal effects subject to a maximum of one container load by rail or one truckload by road on submission of bills and payment receipts. The employee must obtain at least two quotations for transportation, packing, loading unloading etc. from different parties and the total transport cost estimate must be prior approved by the F & A Head.

(d) Transit Insurance for personal effects: The Company shall also reimburse the actual costs of transit insurance (subject to prior approval by the F & A Head) for the personal effects of the employee and her/his family, on production of insurance receipt. Employees are responsible to ensure that the personal effects are insured properly. In case of any loss/damage in transit, the Company shall not be directly and/or indirectly responsible for the same.

(e) Transportation of Conveyance: The Company shall reimburse the actual transportation expenses for transporting a car/two wheeler owned by the employee, either by rail or by road. The vehicle shall be comprehensively insured by the employee at her/his own cost. The employee must obtain at least two quotations for transportation, packing, loading unloading etc. from different parties and the total transport cost estimate must be prior approved by the F & A Head.

4. Transit Leave:

The employee shall be allowed three working days as 'Transit Leave' to make arrangements for movement and to settle down at the new location. This Transit Leave of three days excludes actual travel time (from original posting to transferred posting). This leave may be taken immediately either pre or post arrival at Transferred Location. In case the employee alone moves first, utilizes the Transit Leave fully and shifts the family later, then no additional leave will be granted later. The employee may choose to utilize the Transit Leave in parts e.g. may utilize later some part for shifting family.

5. Accommodation:

The transferred employee shall be allowed up to a maximum of 7 nights stay in a hotel at the place of posting for self. The charges shall be reimbursed subject to prior approval of the room tariff by the concerned appraiser and the F & A Head.

The Company may provide accommodation in the form of one furnished room with an attached toilet at the Transferred Location. In case, the Company provides such accommodation facility to the transferred employee at the place of transferred location and in case the employee avails such a facility, then Rs.4500/- (for a Non-AC Room) or Rs.5000/- (for an AC room) per month as applicable ; or House Rent Allowance ("HRA") whichever is lower shall be recovered as room-rent by way of deduction from the concerned employee's monthly salary. The electricity charges, municipal taxes, society maintenance charges and daily room cleaning expenses shall be borne by the Company.

Alternatively, the employee can also make her/his own accommodation arrangements at his own cost. In such case, no deductions from the salary shall be made by the Company and the employee will continue to draw full HRA (subject to applicable taxes).

3. Claim Procedure:

1. All claims must be submitted within 15 days of joining at the new location.
2. The Claim details must be filled in accurately and submitted along with reimbursement or advance settlement form, travel expense report if stayed in hotel, all bills/receipts in original,

delivery challan for goods etc. The claim form shall be authenticated by the concerned appraiser and forwarded to the F & A Head. The claim shall be settled within 30 calendar days of receipt of the claim by Accounts Program.

4. Handing over / Taking over on transfer:

(a) In all cases of transfers, it is extremely important to have a proper handing over / taking over, to ensure smooth transition & continuity of work. It shall be the responsibility of the transferred employee to prepare a “checklist” of roles and responsibilities. It is important that this “checklist” is updated mentioning the current tasks and activities at hand, as also the activities planned for future, duly signed/approved by his appraiser and Program Head. This “Checklist” will be provided to the employee who takes over from the employee being transferred or his manager, as practically possible in the given situation. Also, wherever applicable proper asset handover to the Appraiser should be done by the employee.

(b) The concerned Program Head is responsible for handing and taking over process. S/he should ensure that the process of handing and taking over is properly documented, authenticated and all concerned officers are informed.

5. Re-transfer to original place of posting:

All the norms for transfer shall apply *mutatis mutandis* (i.e. the necessary changes having been made) to re-transfer to original place of posting.

6. Dispute:

Any unsettled claims/disputes shall be referred to the MD and decision given by MD shall be final and binding.

C. Rent Recovery Policy

Policy:	Transfer Policy
Sub-policy:	Rent Recovery Policy
Date of issue:	April 01, 2017
Effective Date:	April 01, 2017
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objective:

To facilitate an employee who has been either newly posted or transferred to any location, the Company may provide accommodation in the form of one furnished room with an attached toilet. Providing of such facility is at the sole discretion of the Company.

2. Norms:

In case, the Company provides such accommodation facility to the employee at the place of posting/ transfer and incase the employee avails such facility, then Rs. 4500/- (for a Non-AC Room) or Rs.5000/- (for an AC room) per month as applicable or his/her House Rent Allowance ("HRA") whichever is lower shall be recovered as room rent by way of deduction from his/her monthly salary. The electricity bill and municipal taxes as well as society maintenance charges and daily room cleaning expenses shall be borne by the Company.

Alternatively, the employee may make his/her own accommodation arrangements at his/her own cost. In such case, no deduction from the salary shall be made by the Company and the employee shall continue to draw full HRA.

D. Inter Associate Company Deputation Policy

Policy:	Transfer Policy
Sub-policy:	Inter Associate Company Deputation Policy
Date of issue:	June 28, 2024
Effective Date:	July 01, 2024
Last revision Date:	----
Effective date of revision:	----
Version no.:	1.0

1. Objective:

The Company may depute any of its employee to its Associate Companies due to organizational need. Deputation may also be considered if requested by an Associate Company and/or by an employee for personal reasons. The objective of this policy is to have clear norms for effecting inter-company deputations as and when required in the overall interest of the organization.

2. Norms:

Following norms are applicable in case of deputation of an employee by MKCL:

- (a) Any deputation shall be effected only subject to atleast one month prior intimation to the concerned employee. The said minimum period of intimation can be curtailed if agreed to by the concerned employee.
- (b) Prior to deputing an employee, his/her personal and other constraints and/or difficulties, if any, should be understood by the Company. Ideally, the deputation should be by mutual consent. However, the Managing Director has final discretionary powers to decide about the deputation and the concerned employee shall abide by the decision.
- (c) In case of inter associate company deputation, new employee number and PF number shall be allotted by the associate company deputed to.
- (d) For the purpose of eligibility under the Gratuity Act, the concerned employee's period of service in MKCL prior to deputation to any of MKCL's Associate companies, shall also be considered while calculating the number of years of continuous service. Further, incase such employee is repatriated to MKCL then her/his period of service in MKCL's Associate company shall also be considered while calculating the number of years of continuous service. If s/he is re-deputed to more than one Associate Company, then the entire period of service with the Associate Companies shall be considered while calculating the number of years of continuous service. The said norms are applicable only regarding MKCL's Associate Companies registered in India.
- (e) Incase of deputation to Associate Company registered outside India, laws of the concerned country shall become applicable. As such, incase the concerned employee is eligible to receive gratuity, MKCL shall make payment for the entitled gratuity before the employee takes charge in the Associate Company. Further, the employee's period of service with the

Associate Company registered outside India shall be considered while calculating the number of years of continuous service, incase s/he is repatriated to MKCL (except for gratuity being paid for prior period). In case of transfer to Associate Company registered outside India, the Provident Fund may be withdrawn by the concerned employee.

- (f) All the norms are subject to applicable provisions of the Gratuity Act. In case any of MKCL's norms being contrary or differing to the provisions of the Gratuity Act, then the provisions of the said Act shall supersede such norms.
 - (g) Incase of deputation, the remuneration shall be paid by MKCL or the Associate Company as mutually agreed between them. Incase new employee number and PF number is allotted by the Company deputed to, then remuneration shall necessarily be paid by the Associate Company.
 - (h) An employee who is on deputation exceeding six consecutive months, shall be provided requisite computing and other infrastructure by the Associate Company and shall not carry any asset (including laptop, internet dongle, digital signature dongle, pen drive, etc.) belonging to MKCL. He shall handover all the said assets if any to his appraiser prior to taking charge in the Associate Company. The Appraiser shall handover the received assets to the IT Infrastructure Program Head.
 - (i) The Associate Company shall keep MKCL regularly informed about the deputed employee's pay package, appraisal ratings, and other information as requisitioned by HRD of MKCL from time to time, incase the deputed employee's remuneration is being paid by the Associate Company. This is necessary to ensure that at the end of the deputation period, the deputed employee's resuming of service in MKCL is smooth and as per MKCL's applicable norms.
 - (j) Normally, when an employee is appointed on deputation, her/his services are placed at the disposal of MKCL at the end of the tenure. However, as and when a situation arises for premature reversion, her/his services could be so returned after giving advance intimation of reasonable period to the Associate Company and the employee concerned.
 - (k) In case of appointments on deputation, an employee shall not be appointed to a designation/grade and/or pay package lower to her/his existing one in MKCL.
 - (l) Incase an employee on deputation rejoins MKCL for any reason whatsoever, s/he shall rejoin on the terms and conditions (including those of grade, remuneration, perquisites, facilities) as per prevailing norms of MKCL, which may or may not partially or wholly be favorable to the employee. This could happen due to different norms, policies followed by the concerned Associate Company.
 - (m) The period of deputation at a time shall be subject to a maximum of five years. Thereafter it can be extended as felt appropriate by the MD, subject to each extension not exceeding a maximum of five years at a time.
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9. SEPARATION POLICY

A. Separation Policy

Policy:	Separation Policy
Date of issue:	April 01, 2019
Effective Date:	April 01, 2019
Last revision Date:	June 28, 2024
Effective date of revision:	July 01, 2024
Version no.:	1.1

1. Objectives:

To ensure

- that separation of employee from services of the Company is complete in all respects,
- that continuity of smooth implementation of ongoing projects is accomplished,
- that implementation of projects in the pipeline is not adversely affected,
- that proper 'Knowledge Transfer' has been completed in all respects,
- that the succeeding employee is adequately equipped to take over the responsibilities from the separating employee for ensuring smooth continuation of business operations,
- and that sufficient protection of Company's Intellectual Property has been taken care of.

2. Applicability:

This revised policy is applicable to all employees of the Company.

3. Types of Separation:

Separation of employee from the services of a Company can occur in any of the following ways-

- Voluntary Resignation by the employee
- Termination by the Company-
 - On account of inadequate or dissatisfactory or non-performance
 - On disciplinary grounds
 - On account of notice by the Company for any reasons whatsoever
 - On account of unauthorized absence (absconding).
- Superannuation on reaching the age of retirement.

(a) Voluntary Resignation:

- 1) Any employee desiring to leave the services of the Company shall notify his/her immediate Appraiser and HRD (hrd@mkcl.org), in writing vide email as well as signed hard copy (with subject line 'Notice of Resignation') of his/her intention to leave the services of the Company by stating the reasons for the same. The Notice of Resignation shall be submitted on a working day and before 5.30 p.m. If Notice of Resignation is submitted on a holiday/weekly off day/after 5.30 p.m., then the next working day shall be considered as the date of receipt of Notice of resignation by HRD.
- 2) The resigning employee shall serve mandatory notice period as below-

- (a) in case the resigning employee is in 'Technical Category' - 90 (ninety) days from the date of receipt of Notice of resignation by HRD
- (b) in case the resigning employee is in any of the other categories viz. Management, Business, Academic, Artistic Creations - 30 (thirty) days from the date of receipt of Notice of resignation by HRD.

Resigning employee should ensure to obtain an acknowledgement from his/her appraiser and HRD of the email giving notice of resignation.

- 3) A Notice period of 90 days has been specified for employees in 'Technical Category' because
 - (a) As compared to other categories, it takes considerably longer time for proper completion and documentation of ongoing projects in case of technical domain.
 - (b) As compared to other categories, it takes considerably longer time for proper 'knowledge transfer' in case of technical domain.
 - (c) In view of greater complexities and dependencies involved in knowledge transfers in technical domain, the succeeding employee ought to get reasonable time to be absolutely comfortable and confident to perform new responsibility. Excessive or undue time pressure on succeeding employee is unjustifiable. His/her performance rating should not get adversely affected due to the unduly hurried knowledge transfer process.
 - (d) The pre-planned leaves of succeeding employee overlapping the notice period of separating employee need due consideration.
 - (e) It may also take considerably longer time to recruit a suitable individual for replacement, if none of the current employees is fully/partially free to take over the responsibilities of separating employee. Such a newly appointed person may require training before s/he becomes ready for knowledge transfer.
 - (f) Further, in a currently fast changing technological world, in order to ensure that our technical employees remain equipped with industry's state-of-the-art skills, MKCL has been making substantial investments in skilling, re-skilling, up-skilling of technical employees (especially those with less than 3 years experience) and is, therefore, justified in expecting and ensuring at least partial returns on its investments (RoI) from separating employees as well. In view of his/her recently acquired specialized skills, initiating afresh and completing certain crucial projects with critical involvement of a separating employee after receiving his/her notice of resignation also becomes essential. Such an RoI endeavor should get adequate time.

It is ideal that an employee completes the full mandatory notice period. However, for any reasons whatsoever, incase, an employee requests for 'short notice period' (i.e. non-working for partial/full mandatory notice period), and the same is recommended by the concerned Appraiser and approved by the Managing Director, then the employee shall be liable to the Company for –

- (a) a 'payment in lieu of notice' i.e. compensation at an amount equal to that an employee would have earned as salary by working through the whole mandatory notice period;
- (b) an amount also of Rs.1,00,000/- (Rupees One Lac) as 'knowledge transfer cost'/'training costs'/'recruitment cost' as applicable in case of employees in 'Technical Category'/'Techno-managerial' Role.

The aforesaid amounts shall be recovered by the Company from amounts due to the concerned employee and incase such dues are not sufficient to recover the above amounts, the employee shall make payment for the balance amount.

- 4) Notwithstanding anything stated above, the Key Management Team (KMT) shall have discretionary powers in organizational interest to *suo moto* waive partially/fully the mandatory notice period and to conclude the employment of the resigned employee effective from date as felt appropriate by the KMT. In such case, no 'Salary in lieu' of the waived notice period will be payable either by the Company or the concerned employee. The employee shall complete requisite knowledge transfer, handover and exit formalities before cessation as mentioned above. The KMT may also decide to waive partially/fully the amount of Rs.1 lac mentioned above in 3(a)(4)(b).
- 5) An employee in 'Member' category can submit 'conditional notice of resignation' citing reasons like further education, possible job change, etc. In case her/his plans do not materialize, then s/he can withdraw the 'conditional notice of resignation' at least 7 working days before the expiry of the mandatory notice period of 90 days/30 days as the case may be. An employee in 'Member' category can avail such facility only once in a period of consecutive five financial years.
- 6) On receipt of Notice (or conditional Notice as the case may be) of resignation from an employee, HRD shall communicate the last working day to the employee and the concerned Appraiser. Subject to compliance of applicable norms, the employee will be relieved on the 90th day/30th day (depending on the employee's category) on the close of office hours. In case the Notice period of 90 days/30 days concludes on a Weekly off day or on an Annual/Public Holiday, then notwithstanding the expiration/non-expiration of the Notice period of 90 days/30 days, the employee will be relieved on the next working day on the opening of the office hours/ on the close of office hours of the previous working day as decided and informed by HRD to the concerned employee.
- 7) An employee under Notice Period can avail only Sick/Half Pay Leave (SL), Weekly/ Bi-weekly off and Annual/Public Holidays as per the respective policies for the said Leaves. Notwithstanding anything stated above, in case of availing SL, the number of days availed as SL shall be added to the Notice Period and the last working day shall accordingly get automatically extended by those many number of days.
- 8) It will be the responsibility of the exiting employee to obtain the clearance of concerned officers on the 'Exit Form' in the specified template. Employee can initiate the 'Exit Form' process 5 days before the last working day and submit it to HRD who, on being satisfied will thereafter process his/her full and final settlement.
- 9) HRD will conduct an 'exit interview' of separating employee before relieving her/him from the services of MKCL and maintain the records. Necessary critical feedback should be shared by HRD with KMT for taking requisite actions.
- 10) HRD will complete the exiting employee's full and final settlement within 15 days from the last working day provided the 'Exit Form' of the employee is cleared. All such settlements will be pre-audited before the settlement is communicated to the exiting employee. In a case of recovery, the relieving letter shall be issued only on receipt of payment from the concerned employee.
- 11) Appropriate disciplinary action (including legal) may be initiated by the Company against an employee who is under Notice Period for any omission/ inadequate performance/ non-

performance/ incomplete knowledge transfer/ spreading discontent among other employees and such other actions amounting to misconduct.

- 12) Appropriate action (including legal) may be initiated by the Company against an employee leaving without tendering resignation and/or without completing the Notice Period and/or without obtaining 'Exit Form' Clearance for any reasons and under any circumstances whatsoever. Also, in such cases, applicable provisions of 'Absence from Duty' policy will be invoked and the Company will not be liable to make payment of any pending dues to such defaulting employee.

(b) Termination of Employment:

- 1) **Termination on Grounds of Inadequate or Dissatisfactory or Non-Performance:** MKCL is a learning organization and provides sufficient resources, opportunities, support and guidance to employees to perform and prove their ability and capability. Termination of the employment would be the last resort and a regrettable decision in case of employees who are not able to continuously perform. The Company has established periodic Appraisal and rating system. Those employees whose performance is dissatisfactory, shall be communicated from time to time. In the event of performance not showing any improvement, the Company will have no other option but to terminate services of such employee as decided by the Managing Director in consultation with the concerned Appraiser.
- 2) **Termination on Disciplinary Grounds:** An employee can be terminated for breach of code of conduct/misconduct, theft/ fraud/ falsifying company documents/ harassment/ violence/ discrimination/ substance abuse/ insubordination/ habitual absenteeism/unauthorized absence from duty/absconding/ breach of confidentiality/ by giving adequate reasons and with or without notice pay. All such terminations will be as per the processes specified in the 'Disciplinary Actions for misconduct' Policy of the Company. Notwithstanding anything stated in any norms, policies, the Company reserves the right to terminate the services of an employee without any prior Notice in such cases.
- 3) **Termination by notice by Company:** An employee can be terminated by the Company with/without mentioning reasons for such termination by giving him/her a notice of 30 days. Alternatively, the Company can also terminate the services of an employee without giving any Notice or by giving a 'Short Notice' on 'payment in lieu of notice' i.e. compensation at an amount equal to that an employee would have earned as salary by working through the whole notice period of 30 days.

In all the above cases, the Company can terminate the services of an employee without any prior Notice.

(c) Retirement from Services:

(i) Age of retirement:

- 1) Every employee shall retire from service of the Company on the afternoon of the last day of the month in which s/he attains the age of sixty years provided that an employee whose

date of birth is the first of a month, shall retire from service on the afternoon of the last day of the preceding month on attaining the age of sixty years.

- 2) In case an employee attains the age of sixty years on a Weekly off day or on an Annual/Public Holiday, then s/he shall retire from service on the afternoon of the previous working day.
- 3) The date of retirement shall be calculated on the basis of the Birth Certificate/SSLC Certificate/Aadhaar Card submitted by the employee while joining the Company. In case of variation of birth date in documents, the date on the Aadhaar Card will be taken as final. HRD shall inform the concerned Appraiser whenever an employee is reaching retirement at least 3 months in advance and the concerned Appraiser shall take requisite actions to ensure complete knowledge transfer, smooth handover and seamless continuation of discharge of functions by the officer taking charge, after the retirement of the employee.

(4) Withdrawal of Provident Fund after retirement:

Retirement Age for PF: The Provident Fund (PF) retirement age for pension is 58 years, while the Company's retirement age limit is 60 years.

The following steps apply based on the employee's registration under the EPFO scheme:

A. If an employee is registered under for Employee Provident Fund (EPF) with Employee Pension Scheme (EPS) facility:

- (a) If an employee is registered for EPF with EPS, according to the EPFO Scheme, the Company will stop deducting the pension amount from the Employer's PF contribution once the employee completes 58 years of age.
- (b) The entire 12% of the employer's PF contribution will be deposited into the employee's EPF account only.
- (c) After the employee turns 58, the EPFO system will automatically send alert and instruct to update the end date of the EPS contribution. The employee will remain in service up to the age of 60 years. In such cases, Company will indicate "Still in Service" for EPF contribution.
- (d) The following process needs to be followed by the employee who has completed the age of 58 years:
 - **Monthly Pension Eligibility:**

After completion of age of 58 years, the employee is eligible for a monthly pension. This process must be completed by the employee using his/her UAN login on the EPFO member portal by using personal UAN ID and password.
 - **Submission of Monthly Pension Online Form:**

The employee must submit Form 10D for monthly pension through the EPFO Member Portal. For this process, PF documents KYC is mandatory, i.e., Aadhaar, PAN, and Bank details.

- **Bank Account Details:**

If the bank account details in the UAN account differs from the one where the employee wants his/her pension deposited, he/she needs to add the new bank account details. Employee to ensure that the new bank account is linked to the Aadhaar card and KYC verified on EPFO Portal.

- **Pension Payment Branch:**

Pension is payable through any branch of certain banks, depending on the state where the pensioner wants to receive the pension by credit to the S.B. account of eligible pensioner. Hence, the S.B. account should be opened only in the designated bank. Necessary guidelines have been provided to all branches of these banks to open an S.B. account for the pensioners. The applicant may approach any branch of the designated banks to open the account.

- **Designated Banks:**

These banks are State Bank of India, Punjab National Bank, Indian Bank, Allahabad Bank, Union Bank of India, Bank of Baroda, HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, Axis Bank, and Kotak Mahindra Bank.

- **Nominee Details:**

The employee must provide details of their nominee for receiving the Return of Capital through the EPFO Member UAN Portal. If any of the above processes are pending, the employee will not be able to proceed with the EPS application.

(e) **Exit Date for EPF Contribution:**

After the completion of retirement exit process and final settlement, the Company will mark the employee's exit date for EPF contribution through the EPFO employer portal: <https://unifiedportal-emp.epfindia.gov.in/epfo/> using the Employer's Code number and password.

(f) **Online EPF Claim:**

The employee can then apply online using Form No. 19 to withdraw the EPF funds for the entire service period through the EPFO Member portal.

B. If an employee is registered under Employee Provident Fund (EPF) without Employee Pension Scheme (EPS) facility :

(a) After the completion of retirement exit process and final settlement, the Company will mark the employee's exit date for EPF contribution through the EPFO employer portal: <https://unifiedportal-emp.epfindia.gov.in/epfo/> using the Employer's Code number and password.

(b) Then the employee can apply online claim Form No 19 to withdraw the EPF funds for whole service period by using above EPFO Member portal.

(5) Gratuity Settlement after Separation (including Retirement)

(a) Processing of Gratuity payment by Company:

The following steps will be followed to verify and recommend Gratuity Settlement of an employee after his/her separation from the Company:

- (a) The eligibility of employee for receiving gratuity payment on separation will be verified at the time of full and final settlement of that concerned employee by HRD and will be sent to Pay Administration with remarks accordingly.
- (b) The total years of service will be calculated to determine the eligibility of applicability of gratuity for the concerned employee.
- (c) Total number of years of service of the said employee will be calculated from the date of applicability of gratuity as per offer letter issued to that employee to the separation date.
- (d) As per the Company policy, if the employee has availed benefit under 'Half Day Work from Home/at Office Policy for women' and/or has proceeded for long or extraordinary leave, then such leaves or days will be deducted from the calculation of service period.
- (e) If the employee completes continuous service period of 180 days or more in the previous year, then it will be considered full year of service. For example, If any employee completes service period of 19 years and 190 days, then gratuity will be calculated for 20 years of service.
- (f) The number of years will be rounded off as per provisions of Gratuity Acts and Rules, and Calculation of Gratuity amount will be done as per the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972. Gratuity is computed on the basic pay of the employee on last working date of service and number of service years, by using formulae as $“(Number\ of\ years\ served\ by\ the\ Employee * 15 * Basic\ Pay\ on\ last\ working\ date\ of\ service) / 26”$.
- (g) The gratuity settlement internal note will be prepared with details of name, date of joining, date of separation, years of service, basic salary and requisite approvals obtained.

(b) Processing of Gratuity Claim by LIC:

- (a) The Company will submit requisite documents for gratuity claim to LIC.
- (b) LIC will calculate the gratuity settlement amount, reconcile it with the Company and transfer the amount to the 'HDFC Trustees Employees Group Gratuity Account' within 7 to 8 working days.
- (c) After receipt of gratuity amount from LIC, income tax will be deducted from the gratuity amount wherever applicable, and balance amount will be paid to concerned employee's Bank Account.

- (d) Notification regarding disbursement of gratuity amount will be sent vide email to concerned employee's personal email id. Details of income tax deduction will be communicated to the concerned employee, if deducted.

(6) Withdrawal of Resignation:

- (a) An employee who has submitted a Notice of Resignation, may request vide email to his/her appraiser and HRD to allow him/her to withdraw it any time atleast 7 days before the last working day. The concerned Appraiser shall give recommendations regarding allowing or disallowing the withdrawal of resignation. The Appraiser shall consider the below points while making the recommendations-
- Program/Project requirement
 - the monthly ratings preferably to be above 5 points
 - Past performance track record
 - Attendance record, leave record
 - Conduct of the employee
 - Domain Skills, knowledge
 - Learnability
- (b) HRD shall place the request for withdrawal of resignation and concerned Appraiser's recommendations before the Managing Director for consideration and decision. The decision given by the Managing Director shall be final and binding.
- (c) Incase the withdrawal is allowed by the Managing Director, the Organization Performance Linked Award (OPLA) for the concerned financial year if declared by the Company and applicable, will be kept on hold and paid to the concerned employee withdrawing the resignation on completion of uninterrupted diligent services of 12 months from the month of such withdrawal and provided he/she is still in the services of the Company and not serving a notice period of resignation/termination at that time.
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